FRIDAY, NOVEMBER 13, 2026

The Indian EXPRESS

JOURNALISM of COURAGE

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बिहार है तैयार

पवित्रता से आरंभ, आस्था का त्योहार
छठी मैया की कृपा से, जीवन हो साकार

सूर्य उपासना एवं लोक आस्था के
महापर्व छठ के प्रथम अनुष्ठान

नहाय-खाय
की
हार्दिक शुभकामनाएँ

सम्राट चौधरी
मुख्यमंत्री, बिहार

PR.NO_015421(I&PRD)D.2026-27

सूचना एवं जन-सम्पर्क विभाग, बिहार

THE INDIAN EXPRESS

The World

FRIDAY, NOVEMBER 13, 2026

Mississippi elects Colom, first Black senator since the Reconstruction era



Scott Colom is the first Democrat to win Mississippi since 1982

Washington: Democratic challenger Scott Colom defeated incumbent Republican Cindy Hyde-Smith in the Mississippi election for the US Senate, media projected on Wednesday, making him the Southern state's first Black senator since the Reconstruction era that followed the US Civil War.

The result was a stunning upset in the heavily Republican state and expanded on the national drubbing the Democrats delivered to President Donald Trump's Republicans in the November 3 midterm elections.

The Mississippi Senate race was one of the final races to be called after the elections. Colom at times led the vote count by only a few dozen votes.

Colom, a 43-year-old district attorney, became the first Democrat to win a Mississippi Senate seat since John Stennis in 1982. **REUTERS**

KUSHNER AND WITKOFF HEADED FOR DUBLIN TO MEET ZELENSKYY

US envoys meet Putin in Moscow, explore peace

European nations seek a place at the negotiating table

Harriet Morris
Moscow, November 12

US ENVOYS met Thursday with Russian President Vladimir Putin in the Kremlin and then left for Ireland to talk with Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelenskyy as Washington sought new momentum in its peace efforts.

Kushner and Witkoff met with Putin in a meeting that lasted about two hours. They then headed for Dublin for talks with Zelenskyy as the conflict stretches toward the five-year mark.

Europe seeks a place at the negotiating table Kushner said one of the goals of the meeting with Putin was to get the Russian leader's blessing for European representatives to be part of the talks, which are looking at the continent's broader security arrangements.



Russian President Vladimir Putin meets US special envoys Steve Witkoff and Jared Kushner at the Kremlin on Thursday. REUTERS

The US and Zelenskyy want Europe to appoint a single person to negotiate with Moscow. Russia, meanwhile, doesn't want European countries involved in the direct negotiations, complaining they are financing and supplying Ukraine's military effort.

The Europeans are concerned about Russia's conduct and broader intentions on the continent.But Washington and European capitals have sometimes seemed at odds in their diplomatic efforts.

Trump has repeatedly sided with Putin, last month waiving sanctions and striking a deal to import Russian diesel, in moves that dismayed Ukraine and European leaders.Kremlin spokesman Dmitry Peskov argued that for Europe to join peace talks, it first must name a representative. "The Europeans squabble like spiders in a jar. If someone takes the initiative to establish contact with the Russian side, such people are facing ostracism." The Russian and Ukrainian delegations in Abu Dhabi "agreed on many of the principles, but are still apart on some of the ways to accomplish" peace, Kushner said in Moscow.

Putin reaffirmed to the US envoys that any European troops sent to Ukraine after a ceasefire would be "absolutely unacceptable" and Russia would regard the deployment as a security threat and legitimate targets. "In other words, the war would resume immediately," he said.He also said Russia regards its border with Ukraine to be sealed by a prospective peace deal as now extending to cover the four Ukrainian regions that Moscow annexed in 2022 but never fully controlled. **AP**

THE JENSEN HUANG AFFAIR

Romance can be a long game in Beijing's spying operations

Lily Kuo
November 12

AT THE height of the Cold War, a top official in China's intelligence agency said that his country would never use seduction to entrap a person.

Such tactics might be for the CIA or the KGB, the official named Kong Yuan, of the Central Investigation Department, told a group of agents in training in April 1960, but China was guided by principles. He looked at the few female comrades in the audience. "Rest assured, we will not be asking you to go run beauty traps."

Despite that pledge, captured in a 2010 memoir by a former Chinese diplomat, China's intelligence services have for decades used romantic entanglements to compromise or extract information from prominent people. American officials say that China's Ministry of State Security, which runs intelligence operations today, recruited a Chinese businesswoman to collect intelligence on Jensen Huang, the chief executive of Nvidia and one of the most powerful figures in the artificial intelligence boom.



Alice Huang with Jensen Huang

The use of relationships or seduction in the world of espionage is not new or unique to China. The tactic was made infamous by East Germany's "Romeos," male Stasi agents tasked with seducing the clerks of Western officials, and by the Soviet Union's longtime use of sexual blackmail, among other examples.

What is unique about China's use of the tactic is the amount of time invested, according to Nicholas Eftimiades, a retired senior American intelligence officer who writes about China's espionage operations.

"They play this long term," he said. "These are long-term relationships, sometimes marriages."

Perhaps the most famous example involves Shi Peipu, a Peking Opera singer whose two-decade relationship with Bernard Boursicot, who worked on French diplomatic missions in Beijing and Ulan Bator in Mongolia, drew Mr. Boursicot into spying for China. Both were arrested in France, at which point Boursicot learned that his lover was a man. In 1986, they were convicted of espionage. Their story inspired the play "M. Butterfly" by David Henry Hwang.

More recent cases include Christine Fang, or Fang Fang, who was believed by counterintelligence officials to be a Chinese spy and who was in a physical relationship with former U.S. Representative Eric Swalwell between 2012 and 2015.

In 2003, an FBI agent, James J Smith, who worked in Chinese counterintelligence, admitted that he had an affair for nearly 20 years with a Chinese American businesswoman suspected of being a Chinese double agent. The woman was found to have given classified US government information to Beijing. **NYT**



The 120th Congress

Newly-elected members of the 120th US Congress gather for a group photo on the steps of the House of Representatives at the Capitol in Washington on Thursday. AP

Israeli strike on a Gaza hospital kills 6 people, including surgeon

Reuters
Cairo, November 12

AN ISRAELI airstrike on southern Gaza's main hospital overnight killed at least six Palestinians including a surgeon and a teenage boy, medics said, the latest Israeli attack to undermine a year-old ceasefire in the war-shattered territory.

The strike hit a building containing surgery wards at Nasser Hospital in Khan Younis. Israel's military said it targeted a senior Hamas commander and accused the militants of using the hospital complex to plan attacks, which the group denied.

Medics and witnesses said two missiles crashed through the roof of the five-storey building, causing extensive damage. The surgery department, which serves half of Gaza's 2 million people, was knocked out of service. Twenty others were wounded.



Medical staff collect medical equipment at Nasser Hospital after it was hit by an Israeli airstrike in Khan Younis on Thursday. AP

US President Donald Trump's Board of Peace, which oversees the ceasefire agreement and a broader peace plan, called on both Israel and Hamas to honour the deal, in a rare response to an individual attack.

Ayman Abu Obeid, a doctor who was injured in the attack, said he was on an overnight shift in the hospital when an explosion ripped through the room where he and others were sleeping.

"All of a sudden the world turned upside down. It went dark all at once," he said from a hospital bed. Near him, piles of mangled furniture and medical equipment could be seen covered in dust from blown-out concrete. Torn wires hung down from the ceiling.

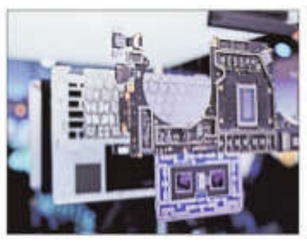
Fearing curbs from US, Chinese AI firms rush to access Nvidia chips

Reuters
Beijing, November 12

CHINESE AI companies are trying to rent Nvidia-powered computing capacity outside China, worried that the scandal involving the US chipmaker's CEO Jensen Huang could spur Washington to tighten restrictions on their remote use of advanced processors, three people familiar with the matter said.

Washington restricts exports to China of Nvidia's most advanced AI chips. But Chinese companies can access such processors remotely by renting computing power at data centres overseas.

The current move to secure rented capacity points to growing concern among Chinese technology companies that the gap in US export controls may now be closed. A major Chinese cloud provider has discussed internally whether to lock in overseas Nvidia chip capacity, while some companies have contacted data-centre operators about reserving it, the people said.



The motherboard of a Surface Laptop Ultra containing Nvidia's new RTX Spark chip

Smaller AI labs are considering similar steps, including approaching major providers of rented computing power in Southeast Asia, two of the people said.

The companies fear the controversy surrounding Huang could add political momentum to the Remote Access Security Act, or RASA, a US bill that would give the Commerce Department authority to regulate remote, cloud-based access to restricted technology, the people said. The House of Representatives passed the bill in January by a 369-22 vote, and it awaits Senate action.

Singapore says US not helpful on Megaspeed investigation

Singapore: Singapore's government said Thursday the US had provided little help in its probe into Alice Huang, the woman at the center of a spy plot that has led to the investigation of Nvidia's CEO, Jensen Huang.

Singaporean authorities held Alice Huang's passport to prevent her from leaving the country from June 2025 until February over "potential false declarations" in relation to her company, Megaspeed, the government said in a statement.

She was ultimately released with a "stern warning" and barred from re-entering Singapore. According to the timeline in the statement, Singaporean authorities had been holding Huang's passport well after President Donald Trump was briefed last fall about her relationship with Nvidia's CEO and the belief that she was a Chinese intelligence asset.

The statement said that it had sought information from an American server maker and close Nvidia business partner, Supermicro, but that the company was uncooperative. **NYT**

Not Iran, Trump now directs Vance to focus on domestic issues

Reuters
Washington, November 12

PRESIDENT DONALD Trump said on Thursday the US does not need a deal with Iran and directed Vice President JD Vance, who has played a role in efforts to resolve the war, to focus "his complete and total attention" on alleged crime and corruption in Democratic-run cities and states.

Trump's directive came a day after the *Wall Street Journal* reported that Vance was considering face-to-face peace talks with a hardline Iranian security official and a week after the V-P blamed the costly war with Iran for Republicans' midterm elections drubbing.

Trump's comments marked a shift in tone. "We don't need a deal with Iran. Those days have long since passed. We've got their money, Hundreds of Billions of Dollars, and we've got their Strait!" Trump wrote on social media.

Trump said he asked Vance to focus instead on a domestic issue: Leading an effort targeting alleged fraud in Democratic-run cities and states throughout the US. "Our Budget could be quickly BALANCED with the correction of this large-scale criminal activity. CORRUPTION is in the Democrat Leadership's blood!" Trump wrote.

4 tankers struck by explosions in Strait of Hormuz

FOUR OIL Tankers were hit by explosions in the Strait of Hormuz, Iran's military said on Thursday, adding that the vessels had ignored warnings and entered what it considers restricted areas of the strategic waterway. Tankers are still facing attacks across the strait, despite a rebound in traffic and expectations of a de-escalation in the war between the US and Iran that have been reflected in falling oil prices. Iran's Revolutionary Guards Navy said two supertankers were disabled by explosions on Wednesday after they ignored warnings against using what it said was an "unauthorised route". **ENS**

Shooter kills 1, injures four, then turns gun on self near White House

Jonathan Ernst
Washington, November 12

ONE PERSON was killed and four others were shot and wounded when a gunman opened fire inside a gym before barricading himself inside an apartment building in Washington, DC, on Thursday morning, police said.

The suspect holed up inside a seventh-floor unit, where police negotiators were able to open a dialogue, Metropolitan Police Interim Chief JW Carroll told reporters. After about an hour, police heard a gunshot and forced their way into the apartment, where they found the suspect with a self-inflicted gunshot wound.

The suspect's condition was not immediately clear, but *NBC and Fox News* reported he had died, citing unnamed law enforcement sources. Carroll said police believe he lived in the apartment and was a member of the gym where the attack began.



Law enforcement and medical services respond to reports of an active shooting, Thursday. AP

The shooting began just before 8 am and officers arrived within 30 seconds, where they discovered an adult male shot. Police were clearing a nearby apartment building when gunshots rang out on the seventh floor where the suspect had barricaded himself, Carroll said. Police did not identify either the suspect or the deceased victim. One of the four wounded people is in critical condition, Carroll said.

The shooting drew a massive police response, with large numbers of officers in tactical gear flooding the area in the Logan Circle neighborhood, about 1.6 km northeast of the White House. **REUTERS**

Taiwan 'reunification' must happen as history can't be stopped, says Xi

Reuters
Beijing, November 12

THE TIDE of history cannot be stopped, Chinese President Xi Jinping said on Thursday, while urging peaceful "reunification" with Taiwan and making no mention of using force.

China views democratically-governed Taiwan as its own territory, despite Taipei's strong rejection of that claim, and has repeatedly offered a "one country, two systems" model of autonomy not supported by any major Taiwanese political party.Resolving the Taiwan question is an "unwavering historical mission" of China's Communist Party, Xi said in a speech in Beijing's Great Hall of the People. "The tide of history cannot be stopped," Xi added. "The complete reunification of the motherland must be realised, and it will certainly be realised.

"Taiwan's government dismissed the remarks.Its Mainland Affairs Council said neither the government nor Taiwan's people could accept "one country, two systems," which would ultimately mean submitting to the Communist Party's authoritarian rule.

"As for the wording on Taiwan unification, it isn't much different from the past," council spokesperson Liang Wen-chieh told reporters. Xi's comments came in a speech on the 160th birthday of revolutionary hero Sun Yat-sen who helped lead a 1911 revolt that ended centuries of rule by emperors and empresses and ushered in the Republic of China. Xi said China adheres to "peaceful reunification and the policy of 'one country, two systems'" and is willing to talk to Taiwan while upholding the "one-China principle".

BOTH OF HER SONS GREW UP IN THE U.S. & KNEW THEY WERE 'ADOPTED' BUT WERE UNAWARE OF THE SHADOWY HISTORY DURING THE PINOCHET DICTATORSHIP

After 40 yrs, Chilean mother reunites with her 'taken' children

Nayara Batschke
Santiago, November 12

FOUR DECADES after a brutal separation, Teresita de Jesús Padilla was able to embrace two of her children again, after they were taken from her native Chile by hospital workers in one of the thousands of illegal adoptions under the late Gen. Augusto Pinochet's dictatorship.

"God gave me back my children, whom I thought I had lost forever," Padilla said moments after meeting Tim Rolnick and Travis Murdoch, 41 and 37, respectively, during their reunion in Santiago, Chile's capital. The brothers, along with Travis's twin, were taken from their biological mother while she was still in the hospital. Their case is part of one of Chile's darkest chapters when child-trafficking coincided with many other human rights violations during Pinochet's 17-year reign. During the dictatorship, at least 3,095 people were killed or forcibly disappeared, according to government figures, and tens of thousands more were tortured or jailed for political reasons.

Both of Padilla's children grew up in the United States. They knew they were adopted but were unaware of the shadowy history behind their origins.

"It felt almost like I've known Teresita my whole life. I just felt a connection," Rolnick said after reuniting with his biological mother. "It's definitely something I will remember for the rest of my life."



Teresita Padilla, 66, kisses the hand of her son Tim Rolnick while holding the hand of Travis Murdoch

Rolnick discovered in 2020 that he had an entire family in Chile who never stopped thinking of him. He also learned he had two brothers living just a few hundred miles from his home in Maryland.

"It all started when I was trying to find out about my medical history" through a MyHeritage DNA test, he explained.

Soon after, distant cousins and social organizations dedicated to investigating and reuniting families who had been illegally separated began contacting him. "And then it was like opening up Pandora's box."

As he continued searching for answers, Rolnick discovered not only that he and his two brothers had been trafficked to the United States, but that he also had another sibling who remained in Chile. Four years after Rolnick was illegally taken from his mother's arms, his brothers, twins Travis and Chris, suffered the same fate and were also adopted by an American couple. Rolnick decided to reach out.

"I always wanted a brother, so I got three!" he said.

Today, the brothers share a close bond. Murdoch recalled being nervous and wondering whether his brother would show up. "Then we met and he looked just like me and I was, like, this is super weird, very surreal," he added. "We started talking and getting to know each other and we clicked pretty quickly. Hanging out with him now feels like we've known each other for our entire lives." **AP**

'Show respect': Soldier tells Hegseth at Tomb of the Unknown Soldier

Mack Liederman
November 12

SECRETARY OF War Pete Hegseth was scolded on Wednesday at the Tomb of the Unknown Soldier by an Army sentinel after laughter broke out among a group that accompanied him.

Hegseth, his wife and some advisers had been posing for pictures and chatting in front of the tomb, also called the Tomb of the Unknown Soldier, a solemn memorial at Arlington National Cemetery for military members who were killed in battle and remain unidentified.



The soldier who was guarding Tomb of the Unknown Soldier

Video recorded by reporters showed the sentinel guarding the tomb turning to face Hegseth's group shortly after audible laughter from a woman among them. **NYT**

The Editorial Page: Celebrating the voter in the age of SIR — a modest proposal 10

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Happening today

● **PRIME MINISTER** Narendra Modi will visit Karnataka, during which he will launch the Pink Line Metro, a Vande Bharat train and inaugurate four redeveloped railway stations under the Amrit Bharat Station Scheme.

● **LEADING 2-0 IN** the five-match series, India will face New Zealand in the fourth match.

● **THE 45TH EDITION** of the India International Trade Fair kicks off under the theme 'Vikas aur Virasat' with over 3,500 exhibitors and 11 countries set to participate.

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EXPRESS INVESTIGATION

COST OF 1,500 MEGAWATT TARALI PUMPED STORAGE PROJECT REVISED FROM Rs 5,675 CRORE TO Rs 56.75 CRORE

Adani slashes its Maharashtra power project cost by 99%, its forest dues plummet; Centre orders probe

Asked to deposit Rs 227 cr for wildlife fund, Adani Green Energy now commits only Rs 2.27 cr; company says project on 'no forest' land

Chandan Haygunde
Patan (Satara), November 12

ADANI GREEN Energy Ltd, a renewable energy company owned by the Adani Group, has sought to sharply revise downwards the cost of its 1,500 megawatt hydropower project in Maharashtra's Satara district to Rs 56.75 crore from Rs 5,675 crore, according to documents and records reviewed by *The Indian Express*.

This reduction in cost to a one-hundredth matters because it also proportionally reduces the money Adani Green Energy has to deposit towards wildlife sanctuary conservation and protection to just Rs 2.27 crore as against Rs 227 crore. The proposal to revise the project cost estimate to Rs 56.75 crore was accepted by the Maharashtra forest department recently, and the company accordingly deposited Rs 56.75 lakh (1% of Rs 56.75 crore) into the bank account of Sahyadri Tiger Reserve, with the balance to be deposited after the National Board for Wildlife (NBWL) clears the project.



Project site near Tondoshi village in Maharashtra's Satara district. CHANDAN HAYGUNDE

Following a complaint by Rohan Bhate, Honorary Wildlife Warden, Satara district, registered on October 30 with the Prime Minister's grievance redressal portal and to the Chief Minister of Maharashtra through the state government's Aaple Sarkar grievance redressal portal, alleging "incorrect cost of the project", the Union Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change (MoEF&CC) has

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

ANNOUNCEMENT BY BOARD

Affairs with 'spy' and V-P outed, Nvidia chief resigns

Interim CEO named, Nvidia shares fall, Trump wants Tim Cook to take over





Jensen Huang with Alice Huang in Taiwan in 2025; (right) Kimberly Powell, Nvidia's vice president of healthcare. AP, REUTERS

Aditya Soni & Anhata Rooprai
Bengaluru, November 12

NVIDIA CEO Jensen Huang stepped down on Thursday after revelations of two extramarital affairs, including one involving a suspected Chinese spy, plunged the chipmaker into crisis and sent shockwaves across an AI industry he helped bankroll.

Huang's exit caps a tumultuous week for Nvidia, one of the major engines behind the AI boom, and could have far-reaching consequences for US chip export policy and the broader AI ecosystem, given the ex-CEO's push to preserve access to the Chinese market, as well as his close ties with US President Donald Trump.

The crisis has threatened to implicate some Trump administration members, including Commerce Secretary Howard Lutnick, who is facing growing questions over the administration's oversight of chip sales to China, particularly as both he and Huang pushed for relaxing those sales despite scrutiny from longtime China hawks in both parties. The Commerce Department did not immediately comment.

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AS HUANG QUITS, A TEST LOOMS FOR AI BOOM PAGE 14

WALL STREET RECOVERS, NVIDIA WOES DEEPEN PAGE 15

ROMANCE CAN BE A LONG GAME IN CHINA'S SPY OPS THE WORLD

EXPRESS exclusive

CHARGESHEET DETAILS BREACH

IAF officer shared war plans, deployment details with Pakistani agent, police tell court

Sakshi Chand
New Delhi, November 12

A WING Commander of the IAF, arrested five months ago and booked under provisions of the Official Secrets Act, allegedly shared classified operational information including war-plan documents, drone capabilities, military deployment locations, movements of frontline combat aircraft and coordinates of sensitive installations with a suspected Pakistani intelligence operative.

Detailing this in a chargesheet filed in a Delhi court, police said the disclosure of such information potentially compromised critical military assets, exposed operational vulnerabilities and put national security at risk.

According to the chargesheet, information about the strength and structure of a secret drone unit, its operational capabilities, locations earmarked for deployment during hostilities and the movement of combat aircraft were also passed on to the suspected Pakistani operative.

The Wing Commander, according to police, had been in communication over WhatsApp with the suspected operative from January 12 to April 1 this year when he was stopped and checked for carrying a smartphone to the office.

The officer, according to the police chargesheet, "uploaded" a page of a "secret

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2



INSIDE PAGE 6

GOVT ABSORBED OIL PRICE HIKE HEAT TO PROTECT FARMERS, SAYS PM



Upbeat for summit

Union Commerce Minister Piyush Goyal, Andhra Pradesh Chief Minister N Chandrababu Naidu and Deputy CM Pawan Kalyan ahead of the inaugural session of the 31st CII Partnership Summit in Visakhapatnam, Thursday. PTI

Owaisi and Aazad launch UP poll front, invite SP & Congress to join

Lalmani Verma & Maulshree Seth
Lucknow, November 12

THE ASADUDDIN Owaisi-led AIMIM and Chandrashekhar Aazad's Azad Samaj Party (Kanshi Ram) Thursday announced they would contest next year's Uttar Pradesh Assembly polls together as part of the "Samajik Parivartan Morcha" (Social Change Front). Aazad, the Nagina MP, invited other Opposition parties such as the Samajwadi Party (SP) and the Congress to join them in ousting the BJP from power, but received a guarded response from SP chief Akhilesh Yadav,

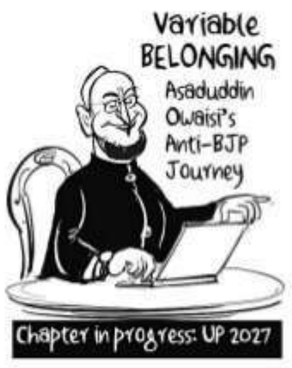
Aazad announced the tie-up in the presence of Owaisi, the Hyderabad MP, at a press conference in Lucknow. He dismissed the characterisation of the alliance as a "third front",

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2



AIMIM chief Asaduddin Owaisi and Azad Samaj Party (Kanshi Ram) president Chandrashekhar Aazad in Lucknow. VISHAL SRIVASTAV

Business as Usual
By EP UNNY



POLITICS PAGE 6

GOVT WEIGHS SPECIAL SESSION BEFORE HOUSE WINTER MEET

J&K: Bullet-riddled bodies of two SPOs found; LeT terrorist attacked CRPF men

Arun Sharma, Bashaarat Masood & Mahender Singh Manral
Jammu, Srinagar, New Delhi, November 12

LESS THAN 24 hours after two Special Police Officers were reported missing, their bullet-riddled bodies were found near a nullah Thursday morning in Kishtwar district of J&K.

The SPOs, Rashpal Kumar (45) and Bobby Chand (57), were posted at Kiyar village in the higher reaches of the Dachhan area. Official sources said the killings of the two SPOs was the first such incident in the area in 26 years — terrorists had killed eight members of a village defence group in the region on August 1, 2000.

Meanwhile, security agencies have identified Mohammed Latif Bhat alias Latif





Bobby Chand and (right) Rashpal Kumar

Ahmad Bhat, a local commander of the Lashkar-e-Taiba (LeT) and its proxy The Resistance Front (TRF), as the man who carried out Wednesday's attack on a security checkpoint, leaving three CRPF personnel injured, in the Akhran area near Mir Bazar in Kulgam district Wednesday.

On the Kishtwar incident, officials said the bodies of the two SPOs were found in the

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

Quad summit likely in Manila next week on margins of regional meets

PM will attend India-Asean, East Asia summits

Shubhajit Roy
New Delhi, November 12

A SUMMIT of the Quad leaders is expected to take place in Manila next week where Prime Minister Narendra Modi will be attending the ASEAN-India and East Asia summits.



Security near the venues for ASEAN summit in Manila. AP

US President Donald Trump, Japanese Prime Minister Sanae Takaichi and

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

EXPLAINED

Summit that wasn't

Leaders of the Quad grouping last met in Atlanta in 2024. India was to host it in 2025, but that never happened. Scheduling issues were cited as the reason, but by the latter half of that year, India-US ties had taken a knocking over Trump's actions.

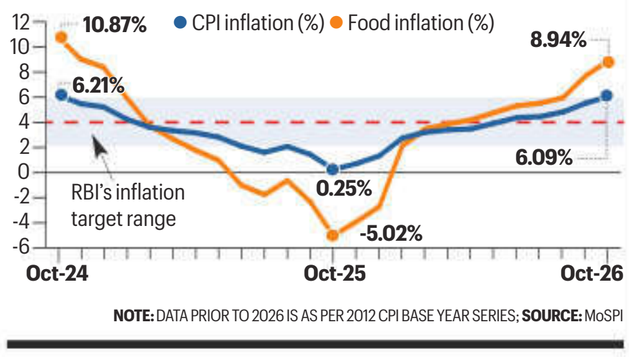
First time in 2 yrs, retail inflation over 6%, RBI may hike rate again

Siddharth Upasani
New Delhi, November 12

INDIA'S RETAIL inflation rate increased for the 12th month in a row in October as an unfavourable base effect and rising food prices pushed the main headline number past 6% for the first time in two years, likely cementing another interest rate hike by the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) early next month. Data released by the Ministry of Statistics and Programme

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

● THE TWO-YEAR RIDE



NOTE: DATA PRIOR TO 2026 IS AS PER 2012 CPI BASE YEAR SERIES; SOURCE: MoSPI

● CONTROVERSY HEATS UP INDIAN OLYMPIC ASSOCIATION ELECTIONS

Usha gets a lifeline via Ice Hockey Federation, takes on Anju, Olympic medallists

Nihal Koshie & Mihir Vasavda
New Delhi, Mumbai, November 12

ELECTIONS TO the Indian Olympic Association (IOA) are turning out to be a race to watch.

The arena is set for sprint queen P T Usha to face off against another track and field star, Anju Bobby George, and a number of Olympic medallists in the race for the IOA president's post.

With allegations of external pressure and questions over the transparency of the electoral process, Usha's re-election bid suffered a setback three days ago when she failed to secure a place among the eight sportspersons of merit (four men and four women) elected to the General Assembly of the IOA. But she is back in contention now after the Ice Hockey Federation of India nominated her to the General Assembly.

PAGE 1 anchor

Elections will be held for nine IOA office-bearer posts, besides positions on its executive council. Under the IOA Constitution, an eligible presidential candidate must either be elected to the General Assembly by the Sportspersons of Outstanding Merit (SOM) or be nominated by a National Sports Federation.

Usha's return, however, does not necessarily set up a straight contest with the other star from Keralam, Anju, with several other Olympic medallists also potentially in the fray.

The voting on Monday, conducted by 80 current SOMs, saw Anju emerge as one of the early frontrunners. The former long jumper, the only Indian woman to win a World Championships medal in athletics, secured 53 votes, followed by former hockey captain Rani Rampal (50), archer Dola Banerjee (45) and shuttler Saina Nehwal (43). Usha finished fifth with 40 votes.





P T Usha and Anju Bobby George are in the race for the post of IOA president. PTUSHAOFFICIAL/INSTAGRAM, ANJUBGEORGE/INSTAGRAM

Usha, the IOA's first woman president who had initially expected a relatively smooth re-election, now faces the prospect of a contest involving not just Anju but also Olympic medallists Gagan Narang, Saina Nehwal, boxer Vijender Singh and wrestler Yogeshwar Dutt.

The process leading up to Monday's vote has been mired in controversy after eight male and five female candidates pulled out of the SOM elections. According to sources, Usha, who had strained relations with members of the IOA executive committee during her tenure, was also asked to withdraw but refused. Usha subsequently wrote to the International Olympic Committee (IOC), seeking a probe into possible government interference or external pressure in the SOM elections.

Anju, meanwhile, believes her experience as an athlete and administrator puts her in a position to contribute to the IOA, though she declined to comment on whether she was interested in succeeding Usha as president.

"I have been a senior vice president of the Athletics Federation of India for two terms. This group of the IOA will work for the 2030 Commonwealth Games. As an elite former athlete and as an administrator, I feel I can contribute immensely and be performance-oriented. This is not a sudden jump by me into sports administration. I worked with AFI for so many years. It is a big opportunity to be part of the IOA," Anju said.

The 2003 World Championships bronze medallist said her biggest learning from her time as an AFI vice-president was the importance of taking everyone along. "What I have gained

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Nvidia chief resigns

Huang's departure threatens to disrupt an AI ecosystem that he helped shape by pouring Nvidia's cash pile back into cloud providers, suppliers and the industry's biggest labs. The surge in AI computing demand drove a seven-fold increase in Nvidia's shares through early October, pushing its market value at one point to nearly $6 trillion.

Chief Financial Officer Colette Kress will take over as interim CEO as Nvidia looks for a permanent successor, considering both internal and external candidates, the company said on Thursday. The departure has also ignited speculation over who will ultimately lead the company, long associated with Huang, who co-founded Nvidia more than three decades ago. Kress and longtime Nvidia engineer Ian Buck had emerged as the leading internal candidates among investors and analysts even before Huang's departure.

Nvidia shares were down about 4.8%, paring earlier losses on Thursday. Shares of rivals AMD and Broadcom rose about 6% each.

Huang, Nvidia's fourth-largest shareholder with a 3.61% stake, will also leave the board. Nvidia named former Synopsys CEO and longtime director Harvey Jones as its first board chair.

"The Board, Estaff (executive staff) and I recognize ☒that this has been an extraordinarily difficult period," Kress wrote in a memo to employees, adding that the company will host a meeting on November 18. Kress was gathering Nvidia's executive team at its headquarters on Thursday, CNBC reported, adding that Huang had agreed to testify before Congress before Thanksgiving. The company has not commented beyond its statement announcing Huang's resignation.

Pressure had been mounting on Huang in recent days after reports said the 63-year-old, who is married, had an affair with a Chinese businesswoman whom US authorities suspect of spying for Beijing. The New York Times also reported Wednesday that Huang had an extramarital affair with a senior company executive who reported to him.

While Kress offers investors a familiar hand after 13 years as CFO, analysts have pointed to Buck as a potential longer-term candidate because of Nvidia's reliance on technical leadership. The veteran engineer helped develop its crucial CUDA software platform and now leads its hyperscale AI products.

"The risk is not that Nvidia suddenly loses its technology roadmap ... that roadmap is largely visible for the next several years. The risk is execution. Jensen has been the chief conductor of an extraordinarily complex system," said Michael Feldman, portfolio manager at ClearBridge Investments. "In a world with real bottlenecks, that coordination is a competitive advantage in itself."

Investor sentiment toward AI stocks has already been shaky as soaring cash burn and rising debt at traditionally cash-rich tech giants fuel doubts over whether the AI boom will pay off.

Trump weighs in

Trump said on Sunday that Huang had "done an amazing job for our country" and that the Nvidia chief had told him he had no idea the Chinese woman he had an affair with was a spy.

On Thursday, the US President suggested former ☒Apple CEO Tim Cook should take over as Nvidia's CEO. Regarding Lutnick, a White House official said he still had confidence in the Secretary. US House Speaker Mike Johnson said it was "critically important for a right successor to be chosen to replace Huang", noting there was a growing consensus in Congress on limiting exports of semiconductor chips to China.

Rock-star status

For years, Nvidia was best known to gamers chasing top-tier graphics. But its chips' ability to perform many calculations at once has made them the oil of the AI boom and a strategic prize in the US-China race to dominate the technology. It also made Nvidia the world's most valuable company.

That turned Huang into a rock-star CEO, mobbed by fans in Taiwan and South Korea who ask him to sign books, posters and sometimes even their bodies. The scandal preceding Huang's departure unfolded over more than a year, beginning with *The New York Times* report in October 2025 linking him to Alice Huang, a former executive at Singapore-based Megaspeed, a coveted official Nvidia cloud partner with priority access to its chips. Subsequent reports said US intelligence officials believed Alice Huang was acting on behalf of Chinese intelligence. Beijing has denied she is a spy.

Washington has also investigated Megaspeed over suspicions it helped China obtain advanced AI chips restricted under US export controls, according to media reports.

Separately, *Bloomberg News* reported on Thursday that the US Justice Department was investigating Alice Huang over whether entities linked to her were involved in efforts to smuggle Super Micro Computer products to China, citing a person familiar with the matter.

Earlier this month, Nvidia's board launched a probe, led by independent directors with outside legal counsel, into whether Jensen Huang had been targeted by a foreign intelligence operation. It also expressed confidence in him at the time.

The controversy escalated on Wednesday when *The New York Times* reported Huang also had an affair with Kimberly Powell, Nvidia's vice president of healthcare, who reported to him. REUTERS

Retail inflation

Implementation (MoSPI) on Thursday showed inflation based on the Consumer Price Index (CPI) rose to 6.09% last month from 5.54% in September.

It's not only retail inflation which has been rising — wholesale inflation surged to 11.39% in September. Data for October will be released by the commerce ministry on Monday.

The RBI's inflation target, spelt out in terms of CPI inflation, is 4% in a band of 2-6%. However, not only is this the fifth month in a row that inflation has come in above 4%, it has also breached the 6% upper limit for the first time since October 2024 and will likely force the central bank to increase interest rates again next month.

According to Tanay Dalal, an economist at Axis Bank, inflation is likely to stay above 6% until June 2027.

In October, the RBI had raised the policy repo rate for the first time in nearly four years, by 25 basis points (bps) to 5.5%. A higher repo rate usually leads to banks raising their lending rates, which makes borrowing money more expensive and dampens demand for goods and services.

A range of factors, such as sub-par rains and the war in West Asia, have pushed up prices in recent months, with producers passing on higher costs to consumers. For instance, dining in restaurants and cafes was 10.09% more expensive in October as compared to the same month last year. In February, before the war began and commercial cooking gas prices were raised, inflation for this category was less than 3%.

Food inflation continued the higher trend in October, rising to 8.94% from 7.74% in September. Aditi Nayar, chief economist with rating agency ICRA, warned that it would remain above 8% in November, too, due to higher milk, sugar and onion prices. Earlier this week, both Amul and Mother Dairy announced a Rs 2-4 per litre increase in milk prices.

"Moreover, the deficient monsoon and inadequate replenishment of reservoir levels have heightened concerns regarding the rabi crop outlook and food inflation," Nayar said.

Some of the food items that recorded the highest inflation rates in October were onion (116%), garlic (61%), ginger (48%) and lemon (47%).

The latest inflation number reflects the "continued broadening of inflationary pressures and the transmission of global shocks, amid seasonal increases in clothing prices and higher car prices," said Axis Bank's Tanay Dalal.

At a regional level, headline inflation was under 4% in only five of the 36 States and Union Territories: Andaman and Nicobar Islands, Meghalaya, Mizoram, Nagaland and Delhi. It was over 6% in 11 States/ UTs, with Puducherry heading the list at 7.96%.

Not only did inflation — which measures the change in prices compared to the same month last year -- increase in October, but prices also rose on a month-on-month basis. In October, overall prices were 0.5% higher as compared to September, with food prices almost a full percentage point higher.

As such, month-on-month, or sequential, changes are watched closely by policymakers as they are indicative of the price momentum.

"With headline inflation yet to peak, compounded by an unfavourable base effect, the central bank's quarterly projection is likely to be revised higher. The data reinforces our expectation of a second successive rate hike in December," said Radhika Rao, senior economist at DBS Bank.

The RBI's six-member Monetary Policy Committee, headed by Governor Sanjay Malhotra, is scheduled to meet from December 2-4. As per its latest forecast, CPI inflation is expected to average 6% in October–December, 5.7% in January–March 2027, and 5.6% in April–June 2027.

Pressure is mounting on the RBI to keep increasing interest rates, particularly in light of the economy continuing to grow robustly. In April-June, GDP growth printed at an unexpectedly high 7.8%. Economists are predicting a similar high number in July-September, data for which will be released at the end of the month.

According to economists Rahul Bajoria and Smriti Mehra of BofA Securities, GDP growth in the second quarter of 2026-27 is expected at 7.7%, well above the RBI's forecast of 7.2% and the Ministry of Finance's 7.35%. Risks to the growth outlook are seen from outside India: geopolitics and their impact on oil prices, and the El Niño.

"A new headwind for GDP growth resilience is the nascent tightening cycle RBI has started pursuing, and we see the central bank hiking interest rates by another 75 bps in the next six-nine months, which will re-price credit higher, and also potentially soften consumer demand at the margin," Bajoria and Mehra said in a note on Tuesday.

Quad meet likely in Manila

Australian Prime Minister Anthony Albanese — the other leaders in the grouping – are expected to attend the East Asia summit and the Quad gathering is expected to take place on the sidelines.

The last Quad summit took place in September 2024 when then US President Joe Biden hosted it in his hometown, Wilmington in Delaware.

India was supposed to host the summit in 2025 and 2026 but that did not materialise. While scheduling of the Quad leaders' visits have been cited as the reason, the strained ties between India and US over tariffs, visa curbs, deportations and Washington's close ties with Pakistan's military have come in the way of Trump's visit to India in the last two years.

Quad Foreign Ministers have met thrice this year — in Delhi in May, Manila in July, and Atlanta in October when External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar travelled to the US city for a meeting of the G20 Foreign Ministers.

US Secretary of State Marco Rubio hosted the Quad Foreign Ministers hours after assuming office in January 2025.

The grouping, which was revived in 2017 under the Trump administration's first term to counter China's aggressive behaviour in the Indo-Pacific region, has faced challenges in recent years. And Trump's outreach and engagement with China's President Xi Jinping has raised some concerns about the impact on the grouping. Beijing has always opposed Quad, calling it a "small clique" which promotes bloc confrontation and destabilises regional peace and stability.

On Thursday, the Ministry of External Affairs announced the Prime Minister's visit: "At the invitation of Ferdinand R. Marcos Jr., President of the Republic of the Philippines, Prime Minister Narendra Modi will visit Manila, Philippines, from November 16 to 17."

During the visit,the PM, the MEA said, will participate in the 23rd ASEAN-India Summit and the 21st East Asia Summit , being hosted by the Philippines as the ASEAN Chair for 2026 on November 17.

"The visit comes as India and ASEAN are celebrating 2026 as the ASEAN-India Year of Maritime Cooperation, and will commemorate 35 years of Dialogue Relations and five years of our Comprehensive Strategic Partnership in 2027," the MEA said.

Secretary (East) Rudrendra Tandon said the ASEAN-India Summit will review progress in the implementation of the Comprehensive Strategic Partnership, including the ASEAN-India Plan of Action 2026–2030, and chart the future direction of cooperation.

The East Asia Summit will provide an opportunity to exchange views on matters of regional and global importance with ASEAN and other participating countries, he said.

Asked about the Quad summit and bilateral meetings on the sidelines, Tandon declined to confirm, saying meetings are being worked out and are developing.

Owaisi and Aazad

claiming it could be a strong political platform for the deprived, oppressed, and marginalised sections of society. "People have been calling it a third front, but it is not a third front. It is the Samajik Parivartan Morcha. If you understand its depth, you will realise that it is the first front," said the Nagina MP. The two parties are scheduled to address a public rally in Lucknow on November 26. The SP is also scheduled to unveil its poll manifesto the same day.

Aazad said the alliance should not be viewed by bigger Opposition parties such as SP and Congress as BJP's B-team, a charge often levelled at AIMIM in the past. "If contesting elections independently makes a party the BJP's B team, why did the Samajwadi Party contest 70 seats in MP, 54 in Uttarakhand and 20 in Jammu?" he asked. Aazad questioned why the Congress and the TMC contested against each other in West Bengal, and why the Congress and the AAP fought separately in Delhi and Haryana.

"I can say with confidence that this will be a strong alternative in Uttar Pradesh to stop the BJP from coming to power for the third time," Owaisi said, adding, "I am happy to announce that our brother Chandrashekhar Aazad will be the chief president of the SPM and its chief ministerial candidate in Uttar Pradesh."

Sources in both parties said the seat-sharing arrangement would be announced after the November 26 rally and that the parties might exchange seats based on local caste and community equations.

Responding to Aazad's remarks, SP president Akhilesh Yadav welcomed the alliance, but added the caveat that "real success will come only when the 'Political Change Front' is active".

The SP chief said a genuine political coalition against the BJP could cost the ruling party "another 2-3%" of votes and leave it "with virtually nothing". But he emphasised it could only happen if such a coalition was a genuine one.

"The public understands those whose sole purpose is to create a political buzz through mere words and statements," Akhilesh wrote in a post on X. "The truth is that such fronts strengthen democracy further, provided they are driven by a genuine intention to work for the welfare of their own community and not by some third party's sinister agenda. If someone ends up becoming a political puppet, the electorate can even ensure that they forfeit their election deposit. Hopefully, the practice of political parties claiming a monopoly over communities' votes will come to an end, and everyone will work sincerely for the interests of their respective communities."

Extending his best wishes to the new front, the SP chief said people who seek a change in government would turn to whoever has the larger core vote and that there was simply no alternative bigger than his party's 'PDA'" coalition, referring to the Pichhda (Backward), Dalit, Alpsankhyak (minorities) social groups that the SP is trying to bind together.

Apart from the combined strength of Dalits and Muslims — who account for around 21% and 19% of Uttar Pradesh's population, respectively — the alliance hopes to draw the support of the Other Backward Classes (OBCs) and other marginalised communities to build a broader social coalition. If the alliance gains traction, it could potentially harm the SP, which is also banking on its PDA strategy to expand its social reach and unseat the BJP from power.

The success of Mayawati-led Bahujan Samaj Party's (BSP) in 2007 is the template before the Social Change Front. "With the consolidation of Dalits and Muslims, and additional support from OBCs and Brahmins, the BSP had formed a government in 2007. If a majority of both communities come together, OBCs will also support us, and that will bring this alliance to power. Even if the alliance fails to get that support, it will still dent the votes of the SP-Congress alliance and the BSP," said an AIMIM leader.

Dismissing the new front, SP spokesperson Faizan Kidwai said people from all sections "had made up their mind to support Akhilesh" and that "people are aware that Owaisi has an understanding with the BJP".

A senior Congress leader, however, said the alliance could not be dismissed as just another pre-election formation. "We have been closely watching Aazad's rallies. While Owaisi is trying to create a narrative by pointing out how INDIA bloc partners do not give Muslims adequate political space, Aazad has been attracting crowds. Together, they will certainly draw attention. Sometimes in politics, people contest to win, while others contest to spoil the game," the leader said.

Congress working president Imran Masood said political alliances were a matter of democratic choice. "In a democracy, everyone is free to form an alliance. Whoever is coming together is free to do so. We will assess the situation and work according to our own strategy," he said.

BJP leaders said the alliance could work in their party's favour. "Owaisi, in his speeches in Uttar Pradesh, is raising issues concerning Muslims, while Aazad is focusing on Dalits and Muslims. If the AIMIM-ASP (K) alliance succeeds in splitting the Muslim vote, and non-Jatav Dalit votes that shifted from the BJP to the SP-Congress alliance in the 2024 Lok Sabha elections move towards it, the INDIA bloc would be weakened," he said.

Officer shared war plans

war plan" after receiving "a nude picture" from the suspected Pakistani operative and "even stated that for each nude pic he will provide a new page of (the) war plan".

The chargesheet stated that the officer disclosed the strength and organisational structure of a secret drone unit, details of drone trials, the endurance of the weapon system and its targeting mechanisms.

The suspected operative, police said, sent malware applications which could have provided access to sensitive information stored on the officer's devices and communications with his chain of command.

The officer "fulfilled the task... to install some specific malwares/spywares in the ICT devices of his five subordinates, deployed in the unit under him," police said.

The chargesheet also stated that the Wing Commander disclosed information related to the deployment of fighter aircraft in Leh and a military exercise at the Mahajan Field Firing Range in Suratgarh.

The chargesheet details the extent of communication between the officer and the suspected operative. "From the analysis of the WhatsApp PMP data, it is revealed that a total of 3,008 text messages (chats), 65 images, 65 reactions, 42 voice calls, 4 video calls, and 6 URLs were exchanged" between the officer and the suspected Pakistani officer.

Usha takes on Anju

through the AFI will hold me in good stead in the IOA," she said.

Asked about Usha's allegations of external pressure, Anju said: "That is for the IOA to take care of and it is not our cup of tea. Those in charge of conducting the elections must look at it."

Usha did not respond to text messages and phone calls on Thursday.

The allegations of pressure have also come from candidates who withdrew from Monday's vote. Ronjan Singh Sodhi, an Asian Games gold medallist in shooting and one of the 13 candidates to withdraw, told *The Indian Express* that he had received requests from fellow athletes and accomplished sportspersons to pull out.

"I am very new to this entire thing. I didn't know much about how to go about it. It is a learning process for me, too. I wasn't forced to withdraw. I got multiple requests from athletes, accomplished names, especially from other sports, to withdraw. I didn't understand why. Nobody told me why I should pull out, or on whose request they were telling me to withdraw. All they said was that there was no point in competing amongst each other. By the end of it, I got fed up," he said.

"I didn't aspire to do this for any particular reason. I just wanted to do something good for Indian sport. It is important to be a part of the system to change it. But what happened wasn't good. If somebody has filed his nomination, so let it be. I never called anybody, asking them to withdraw. I would have called other athletes to support me, not ask them to withdraw," Sodhi said.

He also questioned whether the process had been followed as laid down. "The process was defined. But whatever was defined, it should be followed like that. The code of conduct specifically says you can't be canvassing. If you don't stick to it, then there's no point," Sodhi added.

On Wednesday, former sprinter Ashwini Nachappa had also alleged external pressure after withdrawing from the SOM elections. "I was asked to pull out. All those who withdrew were asked to withdraw under external pressure. It wasn't voluntary, I can say that much... that speaks volumes about transparency," she had told PTI.

J&K

Nand nullah area between Dachhan and Marwah, and their weapons were missing, officials said. Police were conducting searches to track down the assailants, officials said.

While no senior police officer has declared this to be a terror attack, sources said the fact that an INSAS and a .303 rifle, which the SPOs were carrying, were missing indicated the possible involvement of terror groups.

J&K CM Omar Abdullah expressed "profound grief and anguish" over the killings. In a post on X, the CMO said, "Strongly condemning the cowardly act of violence, the Chief Minister extended his heartfelt condolences to the bereaved families and prayed for strength and courage to bear this irreparable loss."

J&K LoP Sunil Sharma, said the SPOs were kidnapped by terrorists. He is the BJP MLA from Paddar in Kishtwar district.

"The incident shows that terror elements, despite being close to elimination, are still attempting to make their presence felt... The remnants of the ecosystem supporting terrorism still exist in the area." Sharma said that he, along with Kishtwar MLA Shagun Parihar, was heading to Dachhan.

Police said Kumar and Chand were residents of Kiyar village. While one of them was hit in the head, the other sustained a bullet injury in the neck, sources said, adding that the bullets appeared to have been shot from a distance.

According to a senior police officer, Kumar and Chand were on their way from the village to a Temporary Operation Base (TOB) of the Rashtriya Rifles at Dharna in Marwah to accompany troops for area dominance and search operations.

Sources said that while passing through the Kiyar forests, which is known as a "shadow zone'' for its lack of mobile phone connectivity, contact with the SPOs was lost.

Around the same time, gunshots were heard in the area, a police officer said, adding that nearly 40 bullets were reportedly fired. "This means the SPOs, too, retaliated before being killed," the officer said. After the SPOs did not reach the operational base by afternoon, an alert was sounded, prompting police and the troops to launch joint searches in the area. No terror outfit has, so far, claimed responsibility for the killings.

In Kulgam Wednesday, the attack took place around 2.15 pm when Bhat, a local commander of the LeT and its proxy TRF, showed up at a checkpoint where three CRPF personnel were on duty. Two personnel were standing and the third was seated when Bhat opened fire on them. The CRPF personnel returned fire and chased him although they were injured.

"One of the injured personnel sustained bullet wounds in his abdomen and spine and was reported to be undergoing surgery. The other two personnel sustained injuries to their arm and leg," a CRPF officer said.

The statements of the injured CRPF personnel were recorded and they identified Bhat from the photographs shown to them. According to the officer, Bhat killed Head Constable Ashiq Hussain Qureshi in Anantnag on July 22. Bhat has been operating in the Valley alongside Pakistani terrorists.

Adani cuts project cost

directed the state forest department on November 6 to investigate the matter on priority.

The state forest department has also initiated a probe.

The 1,500 megawatt Tarali Pumped Storage Project (PSP) is proposed on the Tarali dam reservoir and is spread over 150.74 hectares of non-forest land in Nivade, Tondoshi, Kalambe and Jalu villages in Patan taluka of Satara district. According to the state forest department, the project passes through the buffer/ deemed Eco-Sensitive Zone (ESZ) of Koyna WildLife Sanctuary in Satara, which is part of the Sahyadri Tiger Reserve (STR).

The Indian Express visited the project site near Tondoshi in Patan taluka where work is currently underway.

When asked about complaints of incorrect project cost, an Adani Group spokesperson said, "All the Tarali PSP elements are within private land ownership across three revenue villages in Patan taluka and have no Forest land. PSPs do not have any adverse impact on the downstream ecology, environment, forest, or wildlife in the area during operations. In fact, the smaller ponds that are created from moving the same water between two reservoirs, have a positive impact on the local ecology as there shall be water content/ humidity in air surrounding the pondage helping/ supporting the flora and fauna around it all throughout the year." The spokesperson did not respond to the specific question on the revised project cost.

Adani Green Energy had made the request for revising the cost to Rs 56.75 crore in a notarised affidavit to the Maharashtra forest department on September 8 this year. In the letter of the Union Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change dated February 11, 2025, which recommended grant of prior Environment Clearance to the project, the cost is clearly mentioned as Rs 5,675 crore.

After the Environment Clearance, the State Board for Wildlife met on February 23, 2026, to consider the proposal. It laid down 15 conditions, one of which required the company to make a deposit of 4% of the project cost to the bank account of Sahyadri Tiger Reserve for wildlife sanctuary conservation.

A senior forest officer, who did not wish to be named, said, "The ESZ of Koyna Wildlife Sanctuary has not been notified yet. As per the Supreme Court directions, a 10 km radius area around the sanctuary is considered as deemed ESZ. The Tarali PSP is located within the deemed ESZ. As per existing norms, private companies setting up projects in ESZ are asked to deposit up to 4% of the project cost for forest conservation and protection. Accordingly, Adani Green Energy Limited was told to deposit Rs 227 crores to STR."

Maharashtra's Principal Chief Conservator of Forest (Wildlife) and Chief Warden for Wildlife M Srinivas Reddy first wrote to the company in March 2026 asking it to deposit Rs 227 crore and submit an affidavit confirming it would fulfil all other 14 conditions. After this, the project proposal would be forwarded to the National Board for Wildlife (NBWL) for consideration, he said.

But then, Adani Green Energy Chief Operating Officer Naresh Telgu submitted the notarised affidavit about the project cost to Reddy. In the letter Telgu said, "As stated in the enclosed affidavit, while submitting Part IV of the proposal, the project cost was considered based on an analogous estimation. We respectfully request that project cost mentioned herein may kindly be considered for the subject proposal."

The notarised affidavit itself states: "While submitting the part IV the cost of the project is considered based on analogous estimation, we considered as INR 56.75 crore, request you to please consider the same as project cost."

On October 12, Reddy wrote again to Adani Green Energy stating that his office has agreed to the notarised affidavit listing the project cost as Rs 56.75 crore, and has submitted a letter requesting the government to present the project before NBWL's standing committee.

The letter further asked the company to immediately deposit "Rs 0.5675 crores", which is 1% of the revised project cost of Rs 56.75 crore to the STR. The remaining 3% or "Rs 1.7075 crores" should be paid after NBWL's approval, the letter said.

When contacted, Reddy told *The Indian Express*, "You should ask the company why it submitted an affidavit with a revised project cost."

Sahyadri Tiger Reserve Field Director Tushar Chavan confirmed that Adani Green Energy deposited Rs 56.75 lakh (1% of revised project cost) into STR's bank account.

In its letter to the state PCCF (Wildlife) on November 6 calling for a probe, the MoEF&CC said, "The protection, conservation and management of the wildlife, including mitigation measures, is primarily the responsibility of the State/UT government. In this context, it is requested to investigate the matter on priority and to take appropriate action. A suitable reply may be furnished directly to the applicant under intimation to this Ministry."

Following Bhate's complaint to the Chief Minister, the Deputy Director of Koyna Wildlife Sanctuary too was asked on November 5 to inquire into it and take further action as per rules.

When contacted, Bhate said that if a private project cuts through the ESZ of a notified tiger corridor, asking its proponent to deposit up to 4% of the project cost for wildlife conservation and protection, is an established procedure under the statutory laws.

"Accordingly, the State Board for Wildlife rightfully laid a condition that Adani Green Energy Limited should deposit Rs 227 crore to Sahyadri Tiger Reserve. It is shocking that the forest department accepted the company's affidavit in which it has, by placing a decimal in between, stated the project cost as Rs 56.75 crore, which is 100 times lesser than actual estimate. Even a layman would understand that such a huge power project cannot happen on such a low budget. Furthermore, giving an undue concession or discount of about Rs 225 crore, the company was asked to deposit just Rs 2.275 crore. This decision should be revoked immediately. The government should investigate the matter impartially and punish all those who are found guilty," Bhate said.

TIMELINE

FEB 11, 2025: Central government gives Environmental Clearance for Adani Green Energy's Tarali PSP 1500 MW project estimates the project cost at Rs 5,675 crore.

FEB 23, 2026: State Board for Wildlife lays down condition that company should deposit 4% of the project cost to the bank account of Sahyadri Tiger Reserve for wildlife conservation

MARCH 24, 2026: Maharashtra forest department letter asks Adani Green Energy to deposit the 4% amount of Rs 227 crore to STR.

SEPT 8, 2026: Adani Green Energy submits affidavit to the Maharashtra forest department stating project cost is Rs 56.75 cr.

OCT 12, 2026: Agreeing to the revised project cost in affidavit, the forest department tells Adani Green Energy to deposit the 4%, which now amounts to Rs 2.275 cr.

OCT 30, 2026: Complaints filed to PMO grievance redressal portal and to the Chief Minister of Maharashtra through state government's Aaple Sarkar portal.

NOV 6, 2026: Centre asks Maharashtra forest department to conduct an investigation on priority.



Longest Chhath Ghat

Chief Minister Rekha Gupta, BJP national president Nitin Nabin, Delhi BJP chief Harsh Malhotra and Minister Parvesh Sahib Singh during the inauguration ceremony of the 11-km-long Chhath Ghat along Munak Canal, in New Delhi on Thursday. AMIT MEHRA

Snags in Lakshmi Yojana wallet route: Only 53 paid, govt turns to FDs until Jan '27

Devansh Mittal
New Delhi, November 12

ONLY 53 women have received money in their Central Bank Digital Currency (CBDC) wallets under the Delhi government's Lakshmi Yojana, nearly three months after the flagship scheme's launch, *The Indian Express* has learnt.

According to official sources, fixed deposits have been created in the names of 4,488 beneficiaries – taking the total number of beneficiaries for whom payments have been processed to 4,541.

With the CBDC-based payment mechanism running into technical and operational hurdles, the Delhi government has now decided to deposit the entire monthly assistance of Rs 2,500 in fixed deposits until January 2027, instead of splitting the amount between CBDC wallets and FDs, according to a response from a Delhi government spokesperson to questions from *The Indian Express*.

Multiple sources in the Women and Child Development (WCD) Department and the Revenue Department confirmed that technical issues have delayed the transfer of money to beneficiaries' digital wallets.

Beneficiaries across five districts also confirmed that despite having opened digital wallets linked to their bank accounts, they had not received any amount in them.

The scheme, one of the BJP's key promises during last year's Delhi Assembly elections, was launched on August 26, with the first payments scheduled to begin on September 1. It provides eligible women from low-income households with financial assistance of Rs 2,500 a month.

Under the scheme, notified by the WCD Department in August, beneficiaries can choose between two payment options. Under the first, Rs 1,000 is credited every month to a CBDC wallet linked to the beneficiary's bank account, while Rs 1,500 is deposited in a recurring or fixed deposit account. Under the second, the entire Rs 2,500 is deposited in an RD or FD account, subject to a lock-in period until July 31, 2029.

IN NUMBERS

Women expected to benefit (govt estimate)	17 lakh
Applications received (till Oct 4)	7.51 lakh
Applications approved (Aug-Oct)	39,274
Beneficiaries paid so far	4,541
Paid via Central Bank Digital Currency wallets	53
Paid via fixed deposits	4,488
Approved in Oct, sanction orders due	34,786

The beneficiaries

Roopa Saini, 40, runs a small tailoring shop in south west Delhi's Palam. She attended the launch hoping the money would let her put aside something for emergencies. Her husband is a contractor, but work has been irregular. "I earn Rs 12,000 every month from my shop, of which Rs 8,000 goes towards its rent. The rest is spent on household items," she said.

Saini has received an HDFC Bank message stating: "Dear sister, Rs 1,500 for September in DLY has been deposited into an FD as per the prescribed procedure. The remaining amount of Rs 1,000 will be deposited once the Aadhaar-linked CBDC wallet is activated."

She said she had already activated her wallet while applying. "I remember very clearly because I paid Rs 100 to the cyber cafe person to activate the wallet," she said.

The numbers

According to figures shared by the government, 231 applications approved in August were credited in September, including 53 through CBDC wallets. Another 4,257 applications approved in September were credited in October, with the entire Rs 2,500 deposited in FDs, as the CBDC route faced hurdles.

34,786 fresh applications were digitally approved last month, with sanction orders expected to be issued by Friday, and the entire Rs 2,500 for these beneficiaries to be deposited in FDs.

Over these three months, the government has approved a total of 39,274 applications.

The delays are not limited to the payment mechanism.

The government also acknowledged that the earlier tendering process for engaging a Project Management Unit (PMU) for the scheme could not be successfully concluded.

The department is now undertaking a fresh tendering process, it said.

In the interim, scrutiny, verification and approval of applications are continuing at various levels, with the assistance of Anganwadi workers wherever required. Additional manpower is also being engaged temporarily to expedite the process until the PMU is finalised and becomes operational.

Daulat Ram suspends asst professor over complaint of sexual harassment

Express News Service
New Delhi, November 12

A 55-YEAR-OLD Assistant Professor at Delhi University's Daulat Ram College (DRC) has been suspended following a complaint of alleged sexual assault and harassment by a woman student.

Mukul Gupta, chairperson of the governing body of DRC, said, "He has been suspended and debarred from entering the college premises."

Officials familiar with the development said the matter was being examined by the Internal Complaints Committee (ICC)."Earlier this week, the ICC recommended the suspension of the Assistant Professor, following which the governing body forwarded the recommendation to the Vice-Chancellor (VC) for approval on Tuesday... VC Yogesh Singh approved the suspension and sent it to the college...," a senior official from DU administration said.

Earlier, the college had placed the Assistant Professor on leave and a show cause notice issued in the wake of the complaint by a woman student who alleged that professor had been harassing her for three months by sending her inappropriate messages.

The complaint was filed on October 29, two days after the alleged incident took place on the college premises. It is learnt that the complainant in her complaint mentioned several accounts of sexual harassment, inappropriate conduct, coercion and molestation.

Rejecting the allegations, the professor had earlier this month told *The Indian Express*, "I am being framed and harassed. I found out about the complaint. I have been served a show cause notice in the matter and placed on leave. The college has not mentioned that till now but I will soon submit my response..."

SEWER DEATH

Parents' DNA samples taken, DJB official gets notice

New Delhi: The Delhi Police has collected DNA samples from the parents of a four-year-old boy who fell into an open sewer in West Delhi's Nangli Vihar, to establish the identity of the remains recovered from a sewage treatment plant, an officer said.

The remains of Imran were recovered on Wednesday from a treatment plant nearly 7 km from the spot where he had fallen into the sewer.

Meanwhile, the Delhi Police has issued a notice to a Delhi Jal Board official, asking him to join the investigation and explain his position in connection with the incident. The sewer is located on a DJB site. PTI

TRUCK HITS AUTORICKSHAW IN NORTHEAST DELHI

2 killed, woman miscarries on way to hospital to give birth

Pragynesh
New Delhi, November 12

IT WAS around 3.30 am on Thursday when 25-year-old Rakhi Singh woke up with a sharp pain in her abdomen. Pregnant and expecting to deliver soon, she needed to get to a hospital.

Her husband Raja Singh (32) rushed out of his in-laws' home at Loni in Ghaziabad — the couple had been staying at Rakhi's family home ahead of the delivery — looking for transport.

After struggling to find a vehicle, Raja finally managed to get her into a shared autorickshaw. There were seven others inside.

But the couple never made it to the hospital.

Around 5 am, a dumper truck coming from the opposite direction rammed into the autorickshaw on Pushta Road in Northeast Delhi's Sonia Vihar, overturning it. While Raja and Rakhi survived, their unborn child did not.

Two men, one of whom was identified as Satbir — aged around 30-32 — were also killed in the accident, while several others, including a six-month-old baby, sustained injuries, police said.

Hours later, at Sanjay Gandhi Memorial Hospital, Rakhi lay unconscious, her face bruised and stitched in places, a breathing mask covering her nose and mouth. Beside her stood her sister-in-law Reena.



Satbir, one of the victims in the accident. EXPRESS

"Raja doesn't yet know that the child is no more. He doesn't even know her condition is this serious. We have not allowed him to see her," Reena said.

Raja, too, had suffered injuries. "His lips had been stitched and he was complaining of a severe headache. So, we sent him home," she added.

At Jag Pravesh Chandra Hospital, too, Satbir's family was trying to keep the news of his death from his wife, 26-year-old Moni.

Lying in a stretcher outside the X-ray room, her lips stitched, Moni did not know that Satbir was among the two men declared dead on arrival at the hospital.

As she gestured for her relative Dharambir to come closer, she murmured something. Dharambir bent down to listen before stepping aside.

"Their child is safe, and now she has calmed down. I can't tell her right now that he is no more," he said.

Satbir, who worked at a plastic factory in Northeast Delhi, had been returning with his wife and their six-month-old daughter from their village in Uttar Pradesh.

"They had reached Anand Vihar early Thursday, taken transport to Khajuri and boarded the auto to reach their home in Chauhan Patti," Dharambir said.

According to Delhi Police and Delhi Fire Services (DFS), the autorickshaw was carrying eight persons when the dumper truck hit it near 5, Pushta Road in Sonia Vihar.

A three-year-old girl escaped unhurt, while seven others were taken to hospital. They included Moni, her daughter, Rameshwar Dayal (45), Raja, Rakhi and Akshay Sharma, police said.

While police are yet to identify the other man who was killed in the accident, relatives present at the hospital identified him as Chaurasiya, an autorickshaw driver. His friend Akshay, also an autorickshaw driver, lay injured on a stretcher.

"They both drove autorickshaws and used to drink together. They had a fight some days ago as well. Then last night, Chaurasiya came and took him along," Akshay's younger brother Deepu said.

"I don't know who was driving the autorickshaw last night," he added.

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Three men die inside chemical tank, pvt firm's management booked in Gurugram

Abhimanyu Hazarika
Gurugram, November 12

THREE EMPLOYEES died while working inside a tank allegedly containing poisonous chemicals and gases at a private company's unit in Gurugram on Monday. Police have booked the company's management for negligence.

The deceased were identified as Naresh Yadav, 56, Anil Jha, 46, and Mohammad Arif, 21. Police registered the case at Bhondsi police station following a written complaint from Yadav's son against the officials of Sandhar Technologies Limited.

As per the complaint, the three employees were sent inside a safety tank at the company's Dhumaspur (near Bhondsi in Gurugram) unit to carry out work. The complainant alleged that the management did not provide them with any safety equipment.

The three workers lost consciousness inside the tank. Other company employees subsequently pulled them out and rushed them to a nearby hospital, where doctors declared them dead on arrival.

"Bhondsi police station received information on November 11 that three persons had been brought dead to a hospital. A police team reached the hospital, where a written complaint was submitted," said Gurugram police spokesperson ASI Sandeep Kumar.

"We have registered an FIR for sections relating to death by negligence. Post-mortem examinations of the deceased will be conducted," Kumar said.

Kin allege negligence

Yadav's family however alleged a two-hour delay before they were informed about the incident. Yadav had left home for duty around 8:30 am on Wednesday.

"My father left home at 8:30 am like he did every single day. He had been working there as a welder since 2021-22 and was the pillar of our household," Yogesh, Yadav's son said. "The incident happened around 9:30 am, yet nobody informed us until 11:30 am. When I rushed to a private hospital near Malibu Town around noon, the company's HR head was standing there, but he left the hospital the moment I started questioning him."

"The plant head and maintenance head sent my father and the other two men into a tank full of poisonous gas without any protective gear. Their negligence has destroyed three families, and we want strict legal action against them, along with the HR head and the company owner," Yogesh alleged.

Meanwhile, families of the other two victims, both hailing from Bihar and living in rented rooms in Gurugram, struggled to come to terms with the loss. "Arif was only 21 years old. He had left our village in Muzaffarpur and taken a rented room in Bhup Singh Nagar in Dhumaspur only to earn a living and support us," said Arif's father, Jaududin. "His whole life was ahead of him. We sent him to Gurugram hoping he would build a future, never imagining he would be pushed into a chemical tank without basic safety gear," he added.

Anil's father, Sadanand Jha, said the 46-year-old was the sole breadwinner for his family. "He lived in a rented room in Shiv Colony in Maruti Kunj and worked tirelessly so his family back in Nawada could get by," Jha said. "He was an honest, hardworking man who trusted his employers with his life. Had the management provided even basic protective equipment before sending them inside, all three men would still be alive today."

Investigating Officer Sub-Inspector Rupesh Bhardwaj said Thursday that the viscera report is awaited. "We are in the process of making company officials join the investigation by first recording their statements before taking any action," he said. *The Indian Express* reached out to the company over calls and emails but did not receive a response.



Smog blankets Delhi on Thursday. GAJENDRA YADAV

AQI worsens in Delhi; crackers still account for 7% of pollutants

Biomass burning, secondary organic aerosols each account for 25% of PM2.5

Express News Service
New Delhi, November 12

EVEN FOUR days post-Diwali, Delhi continued to choke with the air quality deteriorating further into the 'Very Poor' category on Thursday. Capital's Air Quality Index (AQI) increased to 350 on Thursday, up from 313 the day before. Meanwhile, Gurugram and Noida logged an AQI of 320 and 311 respectively on Thursday.

The Indian Institute of Tropical Meteorology (IITM), which tracks pollution sources in near real time, estimated that firecrackers contributed about 7% of Delhi's fine particulate matter (PM2.5) on Thursday, four days after Diwali on November 8.

Firecracker smoke is an aerosolized mix of heavy metals, sulfur dioxide, and carbon-based fine particulate matter that can remain suspended in the atmosphere for days.

According to IITM, biomass burning and secondary organic aerosols each accounted for about 25% of Delhi's PM2.5 on Thursday. Secondary organic aerosols are not emitted directly. They form in the air when gases from vehicles, fires, and other sources react with sunlight over hours, which is why they can build up over a day or two.

Vehicles contributed about 17%, and mixed combustion, including small industries and household burning, added about 11%.

Meanwhile, as per the Indian Agricultural Research Institute (IARI) stubble burning in neighbouring states were detected totalling 339 burning events across six states on Thursday. They were recorded as 182 in Madhya Pradesh, 68 in Uttar Pradesh, 54 in Punjab, 31 in Rajasthan, and 4 in Haryana. Delhi recorded none.

IARI said on Thursday, "Cloud cover over parts of Uttarakhand, Punjab, Haryana, northwest UP, and Delhi-NCR is obstructing the satellite detection of crop residue burning".

Across all seven regions monitored, total detected paddy residue burning events between September 15 and November 12 this season stood at 10,805 — the lowest cumulative count since monitoring began, representing a 24.3% drop from 2025 (14,279) and an 88.8% from 2020 (96,622).

However, Punjab remained the sole outlier. The state reported 5,571 fires, which is 19.5% higher than last year (4,662 in 2025).

Both maximum and minimum temperatures at 30°C and 16.5°C remained close to normal on Thursday, the IMD said.

The India Meteorological Department (IMD) expects a broadly similar pattern for the next few days. From 13 to 15 November, skies will be partly cloudy, with mist or shallow fog in most places during the mornings, it said.

In its forecast for next week, IMD predicted mainly clear skies with mist or shallow fog in the mornings and northwest winds of 10 to 20 km/hr.

Night temperatures are set to rise by about 2°C over the next two days, and then fall by 3 to 5°C between November 16 and 19, with nighttime lows reaching about 13 to 15°C by November 18, it added.

Dead fish in Yamuna again: Govt says filing FIR to investigate 'fake' info, 'role' of AAP workers

Sophiya Mathew
New Delhi, November 12



Toxic foam floats on Yamuna near Kalindi Kunj on Thursday, amid preparations for Chhath Puja. PTI

A DAY after hundreds of dead fish were spotted in the Yamuna near Sonia Vihar — the second such incident in less than a month — the Delhi Irrigation and Flood Control department approached the police on Thursday seeking an FIR over social media posts alleging that chemicals were being sprayed into the river ahead of Chhath Puja on November 15 and 16.

In its complaint, the department termed the allegations "fake information" circulated with "malafide intentions" to create panic and tarnish the government's image.

"As soon as ferry services started operating on Yamuna, just a day later, officials from our department informed me that some people were dumping dead fish into Yamuna," Delhi Water Minister Parvesh Sahib Singh told mediapersons.

"The department is filing an FIR today. An investigation will be conducted to identify who these people are and whether they have any connection to AAP workers," he claimed.

The latest fish deaths were reported on Wednesday, a day after the launch of the Namo Yamuna River Safari, an electric river cruise. On October 14, large numbers of dead fish were spotted along the Burari stretch, with industrial effluents entering through drains 2 and 8 suspected to be have contributed to the deaths.

The latest incident coincided with a deterioration in the quality of raw water drawn from the Yamuna, with ammonia levels rising to around 1.3 mg/l. This had forced the Delhi Jal Board (DJB) to curtail production at its Sonia Vihar Water Treatment Plant for nearly five hours on Wednesday. A senior DJB official said that all plants had been functioning normally since Wednesday evening.

The problem of high ammonical nitrogen concentration in Yamuna during winter is not new. As the amount of water in the river drops due to lack of rain post-monsoon and during winter, the concentration of pollutants increases.

DJB's plants can treat raw water containing up to 1 ppm of ammonia. Under such circumstances, raw water in Yamuna is either diluted with fresh water from Upper Ganga Canal or Munak Canal. However, with the closure of the Upper Ganga Canal for annual maintenance, water was not available for dilution in Yamuna, affecting the plants' production capacity temporarily, officials said.

Ammonia is a nitrogen-containing compound that can enter water bodies through untreated sewage, industrial effluents, agricultural runoff and the decomposition of organic matter. As per studies, elevated concentrations and high phosphate content can be harmful to aquatic life. Ammonia can also contribute to the depletion of dissolved oxygen in water, which can stress or kill fish.

Dr Shiv Singh Rawat, a water expert and former Haryana Irrigation department engineer, said investigators should examine sewage and industrial discharges from drains 2 and 8, elevated ammonia levels, and the alleged use of polyaluminium chloride, a chemical used to reduce water discolouration, settle suspended particles and address the issue of surface foam ahead of the cruise. "Any excessive or inappropriate chemical dosing could potentially harm aquatic life," he said.

Pankaj Kumar, a Yamuna activist, said an ammonia reading of around 1.3 mg/l was not high enough to explain the scale of fish mortality. "Such mass fish deaths have not happened back-to-back in such a short period in the last 10 years," he said.

Bhim Singh Rawat of the South Asia Network on Dams, Rivers and People said, "Laboratory testing is the first essential step towards identifying the cause...," he said.

Air quality panel orders audit of burnt farmland in Punjab

Sophiya Mathew
New Delhi, November 12

THE COMMISSION for Air Quality Management (CAQM) has directed district authorities in Punjab to assess and verify areas affected by paddy stubble burning following a recent spike in farm fires. This is among a series of measures to step up monitoring, enforcement and paddy residue management.

The Indian Express reported on Thursday that estimates of burnt areas in key agricultural states, including Punjab and Haryana, remain "unverified" and "unfinalised", according to an RTI response from the Indian Agricultural Research Institute (IARI). The report also noted there was no standardised methodology to officially measure the extent of farmland burnt in these states.

The directive was issued during a high-level review meeting chaired by CAQM Chairperson Rajesh Verma on Thursday. Other directions issued to district authorities in Fatehgarh Sahib, Khanna, and Patiala include enhanced monitoring and enforcement measures, including satellite monitoring of fire hotspots.

Reviews in 3 districts

Officials reviewed paddy residue management and enforcement measures in the three districts, along with district administration and police.

During the review in Patiala, authorities were directed to undertake ground-truthing of burnt areas, monitor ex-situ utilisation of paddy straw, ensure efficient use of crop residue management (CRM) machinery, and intensify information, education and communication activities, officials said. In a post on X, the CAQM also called for zero tolerance towards violations.

In Fatehgarh Sahib, Verma directed officials to step up patrolling and satellite monitoring of fire hotspots, take strict action against violations, and provide support to farmers using CRM machinery. Closer coordination between the civil administration and police was also stressed to ensure a zero-burn season.

Verma also visited an edible oil mill in Khanna along with Punjab government officials to review the use of paddy straw as boiler fuel. The visit included an assessment of boiler efficiency and arrangements for sourcing and storing straw from farmers. Industries were urged to increase the use of paddy straw as fuel to reduce dependence on fossil fuels and prevent stubble burning.

10,466 farm fires

As per satellite monitoring data from the IARI, 10,466 paddy residue burning events were recorded across six monitored states and Delhi between September 15 and November 11, 2026, including 874 incidents on November 11 alone.

Overall farm fires across the region have declined by roughly 19.5% compared to the 13,002 events logged during the same period in 2025. Punjab, however, recorded a 22.4% year-on-year increase, rising from 4,507 incidents in 2025 to 5,517 incidents so far this season, with 515 fires detected on November 11.

In contrast, all other monitored states have seen sharp year-on-year reductions over the same window:

- Madhya Pradesh dropped 34.9% from 3,569 to 2,324 events.
- Rajasthan fell 12.8% from 1,577 to 1,375
- Uttar Pradesh declined 63.2% from 2,224 to 818
- Uttarakhand saw a 55.6% drop from 486 to 216 events
- Haryana fell 50.8% from 435 to 214
- Delhi dropped from 4 to 2 incidents

Within Punjab, the 2026 surge has been heavily concentrated in districts such as Firozpur (728 events), Tarn Taran (687), Sangrur (628), Bathinda (499), and Patiala (374), though the state's cumulative count remains far below earlier years — down from 7,029 in 2024, 23,730 in 2023, and 75,321 in 2020.

The CAQM had constituted an expert panel led by the National Remote Sensing Centre in January 2024 to standardise a methodology for mapping burnt areas using satellite imagery. However, the protocol remains under validation, with ground-truthing exercises revealing discrepancies between satellite-derived maps and observations on the ground. "Burnt area statistics are yet to be authenticated and finalized and is work in progress," the IARI said.



STUBBLE BURNING AND AIR POLLUTION

Two years after SC flag, no final protocol to measure burnt area of farm fires

Smog envelopes Lodhi Garden in New Delhi Wednesday. AMIT MEHRA

Sophiya Mathew
New Delhi, November 11

WHILE SATELLITE-BASED farm fire counts for both the kharif and rabi seasons are routinely monitored

Yet burnt-area estimates for key agricultural states, including Punjab and Haryana, remain "unverified" and "unfinalised," the Indian Agricultural Research Institute (IARI) told *The In-*

The Indian Express report published on Thursday



Station visits, lunch with cops: Delhi Police outreach after protest by personnel

Sakshi Chand
New Delhi, November 12



Delhi Police Commissioner Anurag Kumar. FILE

AN UNUSUAL protest by personnel outside the Delhi Police Headquarters earlier this month, following the transfer of two officers in the aftermath of a confrontation with lawyers, has prompted the Delhi Police to step up efforts to improve communication between seniors and those working at the grassroots level.

The initiatives include directing senior officers to visit police stations, hear grievances and interact informally with personnel. In some districts, officers have also been asked to share meals with station staff.

In East Delhi, the office of the Deputy Commissioner of Police has introduced an initiative under which the DCP and both Additional DCPs will separately visit police stations on all working days.

As per an order issued by the DCP's office, visiting officers will listen to grievances, feedback and suggestions, and ensure prompt redressal of genuine concerns. They have also been asked to share lunch or a meal with police station staff in the canteen to foster camaraderie, mutual trust and bonding across ranks.

The initiative, described as a welfare measure particularly for the constabulary, is aimed at providing personnel with a direct channel to communicate their concerns. The visits will also include inspections and reviews of police station functioning, with the SDPOs/ACPs concerned accompanying the senior officers. A roster has been prepared for visits between November 9 and 30.

In Outer North district, Police Commissioner Anurag Kumar visited the Alipur police station in the first week of November and participated in a Jan-Sunwai where he interacted with locals.

He later interacted with police personnel, acknowledging their work. He also greeted personnel ahead of Diwali and, continuing his outreach, visited policemen on the day of the festival. Other district units have also been directed to maintain regular contact with personnel.

The East District order seeks to formalise a feedback mechanism through which concerns at the police station level can be conveyed to senior officers. While formal grievance hearings allow personnel to raise service-related issues, informal interactions are intended to bring up everyday workplace concerns that may otherwise go unreported.

"For personnel working long hours, direct access to senior officers could help reduce the perceived distance between supervisory ranks and those responsible for day-to-day policing," said a police officer.

GROUND report

Patients crowd hospital, struggling to breathe

Tabshir Shams
New Delhi, November 12





Paramjit (left) and Prem Kumar wait at the Vallabhbhai Patel Chest Institute in Vijay Nagar. TABSHIR SHAMS

A COUGH breaks the silence every few seconds in the crowded OPD of Vallabhbhai Patel Chest Institute in North Delhi's Vijay Nagar. Outside Room 13, patients sit clutching prescriptions, X-rays and medical files. Every two minutes, an attendant steps out from the room and calls a number. "29, next." Then "30."

Nearby, outside Emergency Room 17, another queue has formed. Inside the room, patients sit breathing through nebuliser masks. On a bed, one is receiving oxygen support.

As Delhi's air turns toxic, the hospital is seeing a rise in the number of patients with respiratory illnesses, many of them elderly. For some, it is an ordeal that returns every winter.

Among those waiting is Ram Mohan (81), a retired BSES employee from Nirmal Vihar. With a black mask slipping off his nose, he coughs almost every 20 seconds.

"I don't like coming here at all," he says. "But every winter, for the last four or five years, I have to come when the pollution season starts. I don't have asthma or TB. Nothing shows up in my X-rays. But my cough worsens every time."

A senior resident doctor says hundreds of patients are arriving daily with respiratory complaints and the numbers are increasing every day. "Most are elderly people with pre-existing illnesses. Many need nebulisation, while some require hospitalisation," the doctor adds.

Indra Devi (62) sits waiting for nebulisation. While a red dupatta covers her mouth, a black bag containing medical files and medicines rests on her lap.

"For the last 10 days, my breathlessness has been getting worse," she says, pausing for breath. "It started with a fever. Then I had trouble walking. Last night, I couldn't stop coughing."

A retired ASHA worker from Model Town, who left the job five years ago, she once earned Rs 2,500 a month. Now, she is dependant on her daughter and son-in-law, who accompanied her to the hospital.

Nearby, Paramjit Singh (62), slowly climbs the OPD ramp with a stick. A white handkerchief covers his mouth as he waits to undergo an X-ray.

"I have had TB for five years," he says. "Pollution has worsened it. For the last three days, I have been coughing all day. It doesn't stop... I was admitted here in December last year for a week and needed oxygen to survive last winter."

His son Anmol, who runs a business in Karol Bagh, says, "He has grown weaker. We are thinking of shifting back to our hometown in Ludhiana. I can't see my father like this every year."

Outside the OPD sits Prem Kumar (56) with a portable oxygen cylinder strapped to a trolley. A tailor until five years ago, he stopped working after his health deteriorated.

Diagnosed with chronic obstructive pulmonary disease (COPD), he requires oxygen, bronchodilators and steroids. "He used to earn Rs 15,000 a month. Now, our son supports us," says his wife Nirmala, from Mangolpuri. "His condition has worsened over last week. That is why we decided to come today," she adds.

Dr Nikhil Modi, pulmonologist at Indraprastha Apollo Hospital, says elderly people are particularly vulnerable along with children, pregnant women and those with existing respiratory illnesses.

"Some patients are also asymptomatic, especially in old age... Old age weakens the lungs and increases the risk of respiratory conditions such as COPD and asthma. As people age, lung elasticity gradually decreases, and the muscles involved in breathing become weaker, reducing lung capacity," he adds.

"Children, pregnant women and people with pre-existing respiratory illnesses are also particularly vulnerable. Exposure to high pollution levels can aggravate their symptoms, leading to increased breathlessness, wheezing and respiratory distress. Even short periods of exposure can trigger complications in people with compromised lung function."

He advises those with pre-existing conditions to minimise outdoor exposure during periods of high pollution, wear N95 masks and seek medical help if they experience breathlessness, persistent coughing or wheezing. "Whenever they do step outdoors, they should wear a N95 masks," he adds.

HILL COUNCIL POLLS ON DEC 4



The Apex Body Leh launched an indefinite protest, led by its chairman Tsering Dorjay Lakrook, on Thursday. EXPRESS

'Unjustified': Ladakh bodies on police action against Wangchuk during election protest

Naveed Iqbal
Srinagar, November 12

A DAY after climate activist Sonam Wangchuk was removed from a protest site in Ladakh, Kargil Democratic Alliance (KDA) leadership strongly condemned the action on part of the Union Territory administration. Meanwhile, the Apex Body Leh (ABL) on Thursday initiated an indefinite protest led by its chairman Tsering Dorjay Lakrook.

Leh-Kargil range DIG Kaushal Sharma defended the action against Wangchuk, and said maintaining peace and public order remained police's top priority. All necessary steps would be taken within the framework of law to prevent untoward incidents during the polls to panchayats, municipalities and the Ladakh Autonomous Hill Development Councils (LAHDCs).

Terming the police action "unjustified", KDA co-chairman Sajjad Kargili said the right to peaceful protest was constitutionally guaranteed. "Under no circumstances can anyone be prevented from expressing dissent in a peaceful manner," Kargili said in Kargil, flanked by Ladakh Lok Sabha MP Mohmad Haneefa Jan and KDA co-chairman Asgar Ali Karbalai. He also accused the administration of resorting to bureaucratic high-handedness and using intimidation, threats and forms of pressure to suppress the voices of Ladakh's people. Kargili is set to join the dharna in Leh on Friday.

Lakrook said in Leh: "This dharna is about all of the pressing issues in Ladakh at the moment. We are seeking a restoration of the dialogue with the Centre, Ladakh's liquor policy as well as the timing of the LAHDC polls. Everyone should have the opportunity to participate in elections, so many of our people have already left Ladakh (due to the winters)..."

Expressing "shock" at the UT administration, Jan said while the people of Ladakh are out on streets and are not in favour of LAHDC polls, "the UT administration is not budging from its position." He said the country and the people of Ladakh normally celebrate elections but this time, they are even considering a boycott. "That is why the people in Leh have begun a protest demonstration," he said.

DIG Sharma, meanwhile, said that "peace is paramount".

Seeking a deferment of the proposed LAHDC polls on December 4, Wangchuk had attempted to lead a protest in Leh on Wednesday evening.

WITH PTI INPUTS

Six, including quantum and climate change researchers, win Infosys Prize

Express News Service
New Delhi, November 12

THE INFOSYS Science Foundation (ISF) on Thursday announced the six winners of the Infosys Prize 2026, recognising scholars in fields ranging from constitutional law, climate change and economics to quantum physics.

Constitutional law scholar Gautam Bhatia won in the Humanities and Social Sciences category for legal scholarship that, the ISF said, brings "law into conversation with sociology, political theory and moral philosophy." Bhatia, an adjunct professor at Jindal Global Law School and a Green Fellow at the University of New South Wales in Sydney, was recognised for a prolific body of writing, including five books.

The other winners include Karthik Sastry, associate professor of Economics and Public Affairs at Princeton University, for his contributions to the study of climate change, technological innovation and business-cycle fluctuations. Swarun Kumar, assistant professor of Electrical and Computer Engineering at Carnegie Mellon University, won in Engineering and Computer Science. In Life Sciences, Isha Jain, associate investigator at Gladstone Institutes and assistant professor of Biochemistry at University of California, San Francisco, was honoured for discoveries in oxygen biology.

Riddhipratim Basu, associate professor at International Centre for Theoretical Sciences of Tata Institute of Fundamental Research, Bengaluru, won in Mathematical Sciences for contributions to probability theory and statistical physics. Manoj Kumar Joshi of Singapore University of Technology and Design got Physical Sciences award for work using trapped ions to build programmable quantum machines capable of simulating complex quantum phenomena.

India Tourism Development Corporation Limited

(A Government of India Undertaking)

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Extracts of Statement of Standalone and Consolidated Un- Audited Financial Results for the 2nd quarter & half year ended 30.09.2026

(₹ In Lakhs)

Particulars	Standalone						Consolidated					
	Quarter ended			Half Year ended		Year ended	Quarter ended			Half Year ended		Year ended
	30.09.2026 Un-Audited	30.06.2026 Un-Audited	30.09.2025 Un-Audited	30.09.2026 Un-Audited	30.09.2025 Un-Audited	31.03.2026 Audited	30.09.2026 Un-Audited	30.06.2026 Un-Audited	30.09.2025 Un-Audited	30.09.2026 Un-Audited	30.09.2025 Un-Audited	31.03.2026 Audited
Total income from operations	10,683.71	8,863.37	11,715.09	19,547.08	20,356.44	52,707.64	10,817.23	9,010.38	11,848.97	19,827.61	20,623.8	53,266.52
Other Income	1,064.61	754.56	702.26	1,819.17	1,308.61	3,091.88	1,023.86	714.41	661	1,738.27	1,226.09	2,991.93
Total Income	11,748.32	9,617.93	12,417.35	21,366.25	21,665.05	55,799.52	11,841.09	9,724.79	12,509.97	21,565.88	21,849.89	56,258.45
Net Profit / (Loss) for the period (before tax, Exceptional and/or Extra Ordinary Items)	2,449.28	1,427.20	2,399.65	3,876.48	3,689.76	11,137.25	2,389.14	1,368.65	2,361.24	3,757.79	3,613.21	10,987.06
Net Profit / (Loss) for the period before tax (after Exceptional and/or Extra Ordinary Items)	2,449.28	1,427.20	2,399.65	3,876.48	3,689.76	11,137.25	2,389.14	1,368.65	2,361.24	3,757.79	3,613.21	10,987.06
Net Profit / (Loss) for the period after tax (after Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items#)	1,888.01	994.30	1,676.50	2,882.31	2,696.12	8,139.04	1,819.55	939.23	1,634.84	2,758.79	2,609.43	7,974.47
Total Comprehensive Income for the period [Comprising Profit / (Loss) for the period(after tax) and Other Comprehensive Income(after tax)]	2,055.13	929.10	1,637.48	2,984.23	2,699.93	8,348.13	1,991.60	878.96	1,592.23	2,870.57	2,605.93	8,206.43
Paid up Equity Share Capital	8,576.94	8,576.94	8,576.94	8,576.94	8,576.94	8,576.94	8,576.94	8,576.94	8,576.94	8,576.94	8,576.94	8,576.94
Reserves (excluding Revaluation Reserve)	-	-	-	-	-	37,320.89	-	-	-	-	-	33,434.17
Earnings Per Share (after extra-ordinary item) (of Rs. 10/- each) (for continuing and discontinued operations)- Basic & Diluted:	2.20	1.16	1.95	3.36	3.14	9.49	(0.77)	1.09	1.91	0.32	3.04	9.25

Includes Net Profit of Continued and Discontinued Operations

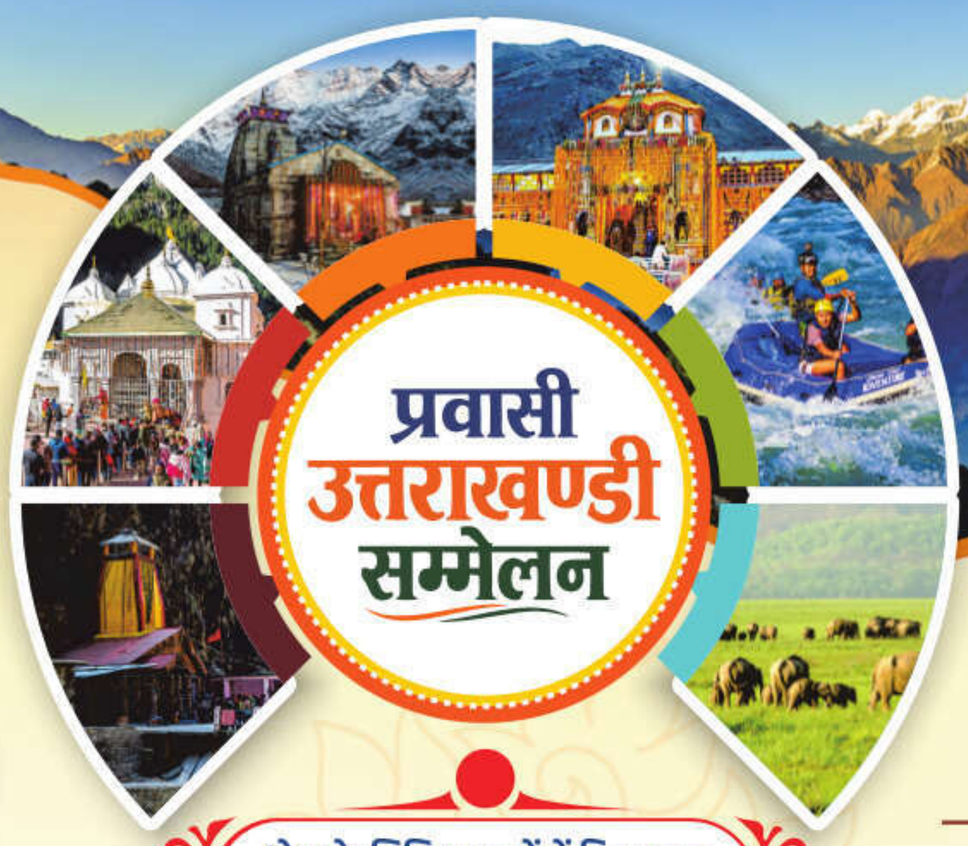
Note:

1) The above is an extract of the detailed format of Quarterly/Annual Financial Results filed with the Stock Exchanges under Regulation 33 of the SEBI (Listing and Other Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015. The full format of the Quarterly/Annual Financial Results are available on the Stock Exchange(s) Website (www.bseindia.com) & (www.nseindia.com) and on the Company's Website (www.itdc.co.in)
2) The Financial results of the company have been prepared in accordance with Indian Accounting Standards (IND AS) as prescribed under Section 133 of the Companies Act 2013 read with Companies (Indian Accounting Standards) Rules, 2015, as amended.
3) The Above Statement of Financial Results were placed before the Audit Committee and approved by the Board of Directors at the meeting held on 12th November 2026.
4) Earning per share is not annualized for the quarters ended 30.09.2026, 30.06.2026 and 30.09.2025 and for the half year ended 30.09.2026 and 30.09.2025.
5) The Figures for the quarter ended Sep 30, 2026 are the balancing figures between the figures in respect of the half financial year ended on that date and published year to date figure up to the first quarter of the said financial year.
6) Details of shareholders who have not claimed dividend for F.Y. 2025-26, 2024-25, 2023-24, 2022-23 and 2018-19 have been given in the ITDC website under Investor Corner. Further details of shareholders who have not claimed dividend for last seven consecutive years and whose shares have been transferred to the IEPF, have also been given at the ITDC website under Investor Corner. Shareholders are requested to contact immediately for claiming the unclaimed dividend and unclaimed shares, the compliance officer Mr. V. K. Jain at ITDC HQ address, Email: vkjain@itdc.co.in; Mobile No. 9650444533.
7) Figures of the previous reporting periods have been re-grouped / re-classified wherever necessary to correspond with the figures of the current reporting period.

Date: 12.11.2026
Place: New Delhi

For India Tourism Development Corporation Limited
Sd/-
Lokesh Kumar Aggarwal
Director (Finance) & CFO

उत्तराखण्ड शासन



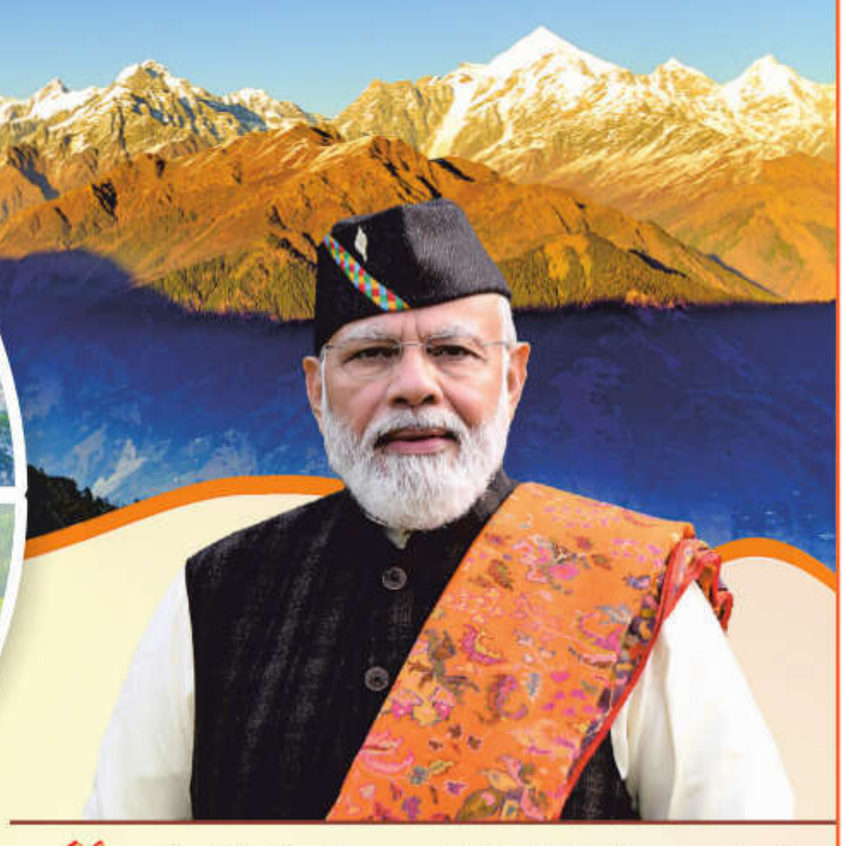


देवभूमि उत्तराखण्ड के प्रवासी नागरिकों,

यह हम सभी के लिए अत्यंत गर्व और हर्ष का विषय है कि प्रगति, समृद्धि और खुशहाली के नए कीर्तिमान स्थापित करते हुए हमारा राज्य अपनी स्थापना की 26वीं जयन्ती मना रहा है। प्रवासी उत्तराखण्डी सम्मेलन राज्य स्थापना दिवस समारोहों के एक विशिष्ट अंग के रूप में प्रतिस्थापित हो गया है। इसी क्रम में इस वर्ष हम तीसरा प्रवासी उत्तराखण्डी सम्मेलन दिनांक 13 नवम्बर, 2026 को देहरादून में आयोजित कर रहे हैं। गत वर्षों में विभिन्न प्रदेशों से प्रवासियों द्वारा उत्साहपूर्वक इस सम्मेलन में भाग लिया गया था और इस वर्ष भी हम प्रवासियों का उत्सुकतापूर्वक स्वागत करने को तैयार हैं। मा. प्रधानमंत्री जी के विकसित भारत की संकल्पना के अनुरूप हमने विकसित उत्तराखण्ड राज्य के लिए एक कार्ययोजना तैयार की है। मुख्य रूप से युवाओं के मुद्दों, उनकी भूमिका एवं उनके भविष्य पर फोकस रहेगा। हम विकसित उत्तराखण्ड की रूपरेखा एवं इसमें प्रवासियों की भूमिका पर इस सम्मेलन में चर्चा करेंगे। मुझे पूर्ण विश्वास है कि आप सभी अपने अनुभव, सुझाव और सक्रिय भागीदारी से प्रदेश के विकास को नई दिशा में ले जाएंगे।

पुष्कर सिंह धामी
मुख्यमंत्री, उत्तराखण्ड

(देश के विभिन्न राज्यों में निवासरत प्रवासी उत्तराखण्डियों का समागम)



"21वीं सदी के विकसित भारत के निर्माण के दो प्रमुख स्तंभ हैं। पहला, अपनी विरासत पर गर्व और दूसरा, विकास के लिए हर संभव प्रयास। आज उत्तराखण्ड, इन दोनों ही स्तंभों को मजबूत कर रहा है। ये दशक उत्तराखण्ड का दशक है।"

नरेन्द्र मोदी
प्रधानमंत्री

मुख्य अतिथि

पुष्कर सिंह धामी
मुख्यमंत्री, उत्तराखण्ड

दिनांक: 13 नवम्बर, 2026 | समय: प्रातः 09:30 बजे
स्थान: नित्यानन्द ऑडिटोरियम,
दून विश्वविद्यालय, केदारपुरम, देहरादून

केवल आमंत्रण द्वारा प्रवेश

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In Search

MAHARASHTRA CONGRESS leader Atul Londhe Patil is ensuring that Sonia Gandhi's memoir '*Belonging: A journey of love*' reaches senior leaders of all allied parties in the state. Londhe struggled to find copies of the book the day it was released, and when he finally did at a bookstore inside the Mumbai airport, he bought all 15 copies kept there. Since then, he has visited senior leaders of INDIA bloc allies, including Sharad Pawar, Uddhav Thackeray and Sanjay Raut, and gifted them the book.

Nutan Varsh

AMID A strong buzz of something big waiting around the corner — be it a Parliament Special Session or a Cabinet reshuffle — Prime Minister Narendra Modi is scheduled to visit the Ambaji temple in Gujarat over the weekend. After a packed schedule in Karnataka on November 13, Modi will visit the temple, which is one of the 51 revered Shakti Peethas dedicated to Goddess Durga. He will perform a puja around noon on November 14, seeking blessings for Nutan Varsh or the Gujarati New Year.

PM: In farmer interest, Govt hiked diesel price by just Rs 7, not Rs 50

'First decade since Independence with more than 4% growth in agri'

Vikas Pathak
New Delhi, November 12

PRAISING HIS government for shouldering the burden of the crude oil price rise due to the West Asia war, Prime Minister Narendra Modi said on Thursday that when oil prices increased, his government hiked the diesel price by just Rs 7 per litre instead of the required increase of Rs 50 per litre in the interests of farmers.

"The government is bearing a loss of Rs 14,000 crore a month," he said, adding that in neighbouring countries, the prices soared by 40-50%. The PM was speaking at the India Today Group's 'Kisan Tak Agriculture Conference' months before Uttar Pradesh and Punjab go to the polls.

In an oblique attack on the Congress, he said intoxicated by power even when in opposition, some people who carry the Constitution in their pockets "think that Indian democracy and the Constitution are in their pocket".

Recalling the time when the Congress-led UPA was in power, Modi said Gujarat stood first in one of the media rankings when he was the Chief Minister. "The agency that ranked Gujarat first was named after a former Prime Minister. Those in power did not like Gujarat's praise, and they told the researchers to seek permission before publishing any report. Those very people preach tolerance today," he said.

He said Viksit Bharat could not become a reality without smart farming and empowerment of farmers, adding that while previous governments had ignored farmers, his government was focusing not just on surplus production in agriculture but also on empowering farmers.

Modi said that a recent World Bank study showed that 50 crore people in India have come out of poverty in just 12-13 years and small farmers were among the beneficiaries. He underlined that agriculture has shown an average 4% growth for the first time in a decade since Independence. "Those who ran governments for decades were satisfied that farmers filled godowns. But what did the farmers get? Filling godowns alone isn't enough." Farmers needed to be empowered. It was in the last decade, he said, that effective steps were taken in this direction.



Prime Minister Narendra Modi with Defence Minister Rajnath Singh, Union Home Minister Amit Shah and BJP national president Nitin Nabin at the party headquarters in New Delhi on Thursday. PTI

Modi said the growth in agricultural exports has increased the income of farmers. He said India was No. 1 in the production of milk, rice, jute, and No. 2 in the production of wheat and fish. He also said that India topped the world in the production of millets. "These show how the abilities of the Indian farmer have grown."

He said the government was also focusing on crop diversification. India's milk production has increased by 70%, egg production (90%) and fish production doubled in the last decade.

The PM recalled his efforts to improve the condition of farming and farmers as Gujarat CM, adding that the experience helped him a lot when he became the PM. He underlined that the number of soil testing labs increased during his tenure.

Modi said some people with outdated thinking believe that technology can't be used in villages, adding "Namo drone didis have proved them wrong. The mechanisation was bringing down the cost of agriculture."

He urged manufacturers to focus on solar-powered farming-related equipment. "We have to make our 'annadatas' agri-preneurs." The PM also called upon farmers to adopt natural farming and save the soil from damage due to excessive use of chemicals, underlining that this was the duty of people to 'Mother Earth'.

Earlier in the day, during a Diwali Milan programme at the BJP headquarters, the PM said India has fascinating achievements to share with the world and urged the media to spotlight these successes on the global stage, terming them as the 'India Story'.

Modi said that in the world of news, one thing is very important — the deadline. "Today, our country is also working toward a deadline. That deadline is the year 2047... We must work together to make India a developed nation before we complete 100 years of Independence," the PM said.

To hasten women's quota Bill passage, Centre now weighs special session route

Vikas Pathak & Liz Mathew
New Delhi, November 12

THERE IS renewed buzz in government circles about a special session of Parliament being convened before the Winter Session so that the legislative package on delimitation and the implementation of the women's reservation law can be passed.

Sources in the BJP said the Winter Session was likely to commence on either November 30 or December 4, meaning the Centre has time to fit in a short special session if it wishes to. Last year, the Winter Session had commenced on December 1.

"A special session of Parliament may be convened before the Winter Session. There is no hard and fast rule that the Winter Session must commence in the third week of November," a senior Union minister said on Thursday.

A source in an NDA constituent said there were two options to pass the legislative package, either in a Special Session or in Winter Session, adding the BJP's allies were led to believe that passage in the Winter Session was more likely. As per sources, this could be the last window to advance the implementation of women's quota to 2029, when the Lok Sabha elections are scheduled to be held.

The central piece of the legislative package on operationalising the Women's Reservation Act is a Constitutional Amendment Bill, which is bundled together with the Delimitation Bill and a Union Territories Laws (Amendment) Bill. As of November 12, the Monsoon Session of Parliament has not been prorogued for 91 days since being adjourned sine die on August 13. This means Parliament can be convened any day without the mandatory 14-day notice required before the House is called into session, government sources said.

Should a special session be convened, a Delimitation Bill will be introduced to set up a Delimitation Commission and redraw constituencies to increase the Lok Sabha's strength to a maximum of 850. A Constitutional amendment must be passed in each House by a majority of the total membership and at least two-thirds of members present and voting. It cannot be passed in a joint sitting of both Houses. The Centre burnt its fingers in April, when the Constitutional Amendment Bill to advance the implementation of the women's reservation law was defeated in the Lok Sabha for want of numbers.

The BJP-led NDA's strength in the Lok Sabha is 320 and 155 in the Rajya Sabha, as per BJP sources. In the Lower House, this number is 40 short of the required 360 for a two-thirds majority in the event that all MPs are present and voting. In the Rajya Sabha, the NDA is six short of the two-thirds mark of 161 at full strength. This means the NDA needs the backing of more parties, either through their support or through abstentions that would reduce the two-thirds mark in both Houses. For this, the Bills to be introduced should unequivocally fulfil demands of the parties opposed to it.

A senior BJP leader said, as per the calculations, the party is about 15 above the two-thirds mark, but he did not go into further detail. "We will be able to muster the numbers to pass the pending Constitution amendment Bills, as no party can oppose the delimitation exercise. What parties such as DMK need is an assurance that their state's share of representation is not changed. The Centre can do it."

EXPRESS special

Meetings, statements & much more, but no clarity on NCP merger yet

Alok Deshpande
Mumbai, November 12

A SERIES of meetings in Baramati, a cautious response from Deputy Chief Minister Sunetra Pawar, statements from leaders across both camps, and interactions between leaders of the rival factions and Nationalist Congress Party (Sharadchandra Pawar) chief Sharad Pawar have fuelled speculation about a possible NCP reunification. However, uncertainty continues to surround the prospects of a merger.

While there have been indications of informal discussions between leaders of the two factions, sources maintain that no formal merger proposal has been placed before Sharad.

The issue has also exposed differences within the NCP (SP), with MLA Rohit Pawar publicly opposing the idea. "There is no discussion of a merger at all, and when the alliance is with the BJP, the question of a merger does not even arise. The CM's statement that 'both NCP factions will not unite without us' is an expression of the arrogance of power," he said.

On November 10, CM Devendra Fadnavis had said that the merger cannot happen "without our knowledge". The NCP faction led by Sunetra, meanwhile, continues to be part of the BJP-led Maharashtra government.

Following the death of former Deputy CM Ajit Pawar in a plane crash in January, *The Indian Express* was the first to report that the merger had been finalised and was expected to take place in the second week of February. However, the proposed unification was subsequently called off. NCP leaders, including Sunil Tatkare and Praful Patel, denied any such move was underway.





While NCP chief Sunetra Pawar has adopted a cautious approach to the issue, sources close to NCP (SP) president Sharad Pawar (right) insist he has yet to receive any formal proposal on the merger

In recent days, however, Tatkare has acknowledged that the merger was indeed a reality and Ajit had been working towards it, with Tatkare himself aware of the plan. The latest round of speculation gathered momentum after senior NCP leaders met Union Home Minister Amit Shah in Delhi without Sunetra and her son, Parth Pawar.

Three weeks after the meeting, none of the leaders has publicly explained what was discussed. Reports suggested that the meeting addressed concerns over Parth's unilateral decision-making within the party. Following the meeting, Parth is understood to have agreed to consult senior leaders before taking important decisions.

The developments have added to questions over the internal functioning of the NCP and whether the leadership is considering a broader political realignment. The possibility of a merger also came into focus when NCP state president Tatkare visited Baramati around Diwali to pay his respects at Ajit's memorial. Tatkare had also met Ajit's mother and Sunetra.

Asked about the possibility of a merger, Tatkare had declined to comment, saying it would be inappropriate to make political statements at Ajit's memorial. He said Sunetra, as the party president, would take decisions on behalf of the party.

At a press conference in Baramati on Wednesday, Sunetra neither confirmed nor ruled out a merger. "I know that all of you are curious about a different topic now. However, today's topic is different. When the time comes, you will come to know about everything," she said. Her response has further fuelled speculation, although it offered no clarity on whether the party has taken a decision on the issue.

Interactions between leaders of the two factions and Sharad have also contributed to the renewed merger debate.

On November 5, NCP national working president Patel visited Sharad at Breach Candy Hospital, where the latter was undergoing treatment. A video of their conversation went viral on social media. The exchange, including a reference to sitting down for discussions after November 10, triggered speculation about a possible political understanding between the two sides.

Parth also visited Sharad's Mumbai home on two consecutive days. During the same period, several senior NCP (SP) leaders including state president Shashikant Shinde, senior MLA Jayant Patil, MP Amol Kolhe, Anil Deshmukh and Jitendra Awhad, met the NCP (SP) chief. While the meetings were linked to the possibility of a merger, the leaders concerned maintained their visits were primarily to enquire about Sharad's health.

However, sources maintain that no concrete merger proposal has yet reached Sharad. While informal discussions and interactions between leaders of the two camps are understood to be continuing, there has been no formal communication outlining the terms or structure of a possible unification. There are also unresolved questions over the leadership of a united NCP, the political position of the merged party and the future of its relationship with the BJP-led government in Maharashtra.

'Now, bulldozer is UP's brand': CM invites firms to manufacture these in state

Express News Service
Lucknow, November 12

CHIEF MINISTER Yogi Adityanath on Thursday invited industries to manufacture bulldozers in the state since the bulldozer has now become a brand of Uttar Pradesh.

"The rule of law has replaced mafia rule in Uttar Pradesh. The zero-tolerance policy towards crime and criminals, coupled with bulldozer action, has transformed the state into a major investment destination. If companies manufacture bulldozers and tractors here, their demand will automatically rise across India and abroad," the CM said.

He made the remarks on Thursday while addressing the ground-breaking ceremony of CNH Industrial's new tractor manufacturing plant in Gautam Buddh Nagar through video conferencing from Lucknow. The plant is being established in the Yamuna Expressway Industrial Development Authority (YEIDA) region at an investment of over Rs 1,200 crore.

Commending the farmers and public representatives of the Jewar region, he said, "The area, which was once notorious for crime and gun violence, has today emerged as one of India's finest investment destinations and a 'jewel' of the country. With the development of the Noida International Airport and YEIDA, the entire region is evolving into a major industrial, economic and logistics hub... Several significant projects are taking shape here."

India's envoy to Oman visits injured seafarer

Press Trust of India
Dubai, November 12

INDIAN AMBASSADOR to Oman Prashant Pise on Thursday visited the injured Indian seafarer, who was a victim of an attack on the Indian vessel MSV Quba last month, at Sohar hospital, the Indian Embassy in Muscat posted on social media.

Pise enquired about the seafarer's well-being, interacted with the medical team regarding his recovery, and conveyed his heartfelt wishes for a speedy recovery. "The Embassy stands firmly with the affected seafarers and their families during this difficult time and remains committed to extending all necessary assistance," it read.

The vessel came under attack off the coast of Oman on October 29 by an unidentified aerial object while sailing from the UAE toward Somalia. All 13 Indian crew members on board were rescued, though some sustained injuries.

Pitroda calls PM 'Gujarati friend'; Modi sends Diwali greetings to 'Sam Bhai'

Express News Service
New Delhi, November 12

PRIME MINISTER Narendra Modi on Thursday conveyed Diwali wishes to Indian Overseas Congress president Sam Pitroda in response to different compliments the technocrat sent his way.

In a media byte, Pitroda described Modi as "a Gujarati friend" whom he respected "as a person," calling him "very warm, kind, loving, and caring". He added that they "got along well at a personal level".

Pitroda said he and Modi could also have "dinner and a laugh" though he might have issues with the Prime Minister's "view of the world and ideology". "He is a Gujarati friend. I respect him as a person... My wife and I have met him. He has been very warm, very kind, very loving, caring at a personal level. Of course, he is a good orator and hard-working... and we get along well. We have no personal issues," Pitroda said.

"I have nothing against Mr Modi as a Gujarati leader, friend, well-wisher. He is very warm to me, no issue about that and I appreciate that. And equally, on my side, I have been to his house in Gujarat several times. But I may have issues with his view of the world and I have issues with his ideology — but that's a separate issue, that's not against (the) individual, it's against the idea. And these are two separate things. I can disagree with Mr. Modi and I can also have dinner with him... and a laugh," he said.

In response to Pitroda, the Prime Minister, wrote in a post on X, "Happy Diwali and Nutan Varsh Abhinandan to you Sam Bhai and to Anjana Ben. Praying for a joyful and healthy year ahead. Jai Jagannath!"

• AGAS HAVE PLAYED VARIOUS ROLES ACROSS THE POLITICAL SPECTRUM OVER THE DECADES — SEPARATIST OUTFITS TO CONGRESS, NC AND PDP — AND NOW RUHULLAH MEHDI SEEKS TO CHART HIS OWN COURSE

Straddling Kashmir divides: Why 'House of Agas' is in focus as Ruhullah exits NC

Bashaarat Masood
Srinagar, November 12

THE NATIONAL Conference (NC)'s Srinagar MP, Aga Syed Ruhullah Mehdi (50), recently resigned from both the party and the Lok Sabha over his sharp differences with the party leadership, especially Jammu and Kashmir Chief Minister Omar Abdullah. Ruhullah belongs to an influential Shia family in Budgam district, which has considerable heft in the politics of central Kashmir.

Agas are one of the two most prominent Shia families of Kashmir — with Ansaris being the other one — which have long held sway over the community's religious affairs. Also, the Aga family has had considerable influence in the political sphere across the mainstream-separatist divide in the Valley. The Aga clan's ascent is linked to the leadership of Aga Syed Yousef, who was revered by Shias as "*Boud Aga Saeb*" (bigger Aga). Yousef was said to be close to Iran's first Supreme leader Ayatollah Ruhollah Khomeini as the two had studied together at a seminary in Iraq's Najaf before the 1979 Iranian revolution.

While Yousef founded the Anjuman Sharie Shian in the 1940s in Kashmir with a focus on the Shia community's education and the Shia-Sunni unity, he stayed away from politics. However, aware of his stature among Shias, NC founder Sheikh Mohammad Abdullah would often visit Yousef. Many Shias would also prefer his office over the state courts for resolution of their disputes. When Yousef died in 1982, then Prime Minister Indira Gandhi drove to Budgam to pay her tributes. His demise led to a succession struggle in the Aga family with two members staking their claims for his position — his son Aga Fazlullah and nephew Aga Mustafa.

As per several accounts, their family row reached Iran where Khomeini purportedly backed Mustafa, who took over as Yousef's successor. The dispute led to two Shia factions: followers of Mustafa were called "Mustafais" and those of Fazlullah as "Mohammadis". In late 1980, when on Khomeini's order, Ayatollah Syed Ali Khamenei visited Kashmir and addressed people at Srinagar's grand mosque, it was Mustafa's elder son Syed Hussain, who was his interpreter.

The Aga family's engagement with politics started when Mustafa's son and the Ajuman's head Aga Syed Hassan Mosavi joined the separatist conglomerate Hurriyat Conference in early 1990s. Hassan later backed its moderate faction led by Mirwaiz Umar Farooq. Hassan's brother Aga Syed Mehdi, Ruhullah's father, was the first member of the Aga family to join mainstream politics. Seen by Shias as a "man of courage and compassion", Mehdi was known for his stand against the J&K Police's Special Task Force (STF) that was set up as an elite counter insurgency force but was accused of allegedly indulging in excesses and extra-judicial killings.



Aga Syed Ruhullah Mehdi resigned from the National Conference and the Lok Sabha on November 3. SHUAIB MASOODI

Mehdi jumped into electoral politics as a Congress candidate against Omar Abdullah in Srinagar in the 1998 Lok Sabha polls. During the campaign, then Congress chief Sitaram Kesari sent a message to Mehdi asking him to withdraw candidature. Mehdi didn't comply with Kesari's directive and lost to Abdullah.

A reference to this episode was made by Ruhullah while announcing his resignation at a rally in Budgam on November 3, which marked the 26th death anniversary of his father Mehdi. He said in comments directed at Omar that "no Sitaram Kesari is going to save you this time". In 2000, Mehdi was killed in a militant attack near Magam on Srinagar-Gulmarg road when his vehicle was hit by a landmine.

In contrast to Agas, Ansaris had made a foray into politics before the Partition. They, too, faced a succession conflict with Iftikar Hussain Ansari and Abbas Ansari emerging as the contenders for their family's legacy, adopting divergent political ideologies.

Two years after his father's death, Ruhullah was inducted into politics by NC chief Farooq Abdullah, who had visited him to persuade him to join the party. Subsequently, Ruhullah was fielded as an NC candidate from the Budgam seat in the 2002 Assembly polls, which he won. He also won from his home turf in 2008 and 2014.

His rift with the NC leadership was ignited after the scrapping of Article 370 by the BJP-ruled Centre in August 2019.

In July 2020, Ruhullah quit as the NC's chief spokesman, which was linked to the party leadership's "silence" over the Centre's abrogation move. The trigger for it was said to be an opinion piece by his colleague Tanvir Sadiq that was seen by many as the party's official line. In his article, Sadiq argued for "reconciliation" with the Centre and review of domicile laws which Ruhullah saw as resorting to "begging" before Delhi. However, the NC leadership managed to pacify him and fielded him from Srinagar in the 2024 Lok Sabha polls, which he clinched by defeating the PDP's Waheed Para.

In the 2024 Assembly polls, Ruhullah supported Omar's candidature from Budgam seat, who defeated his cousin and PDP candidate Aga Muntazir Mehdi, son of Hurriyat leader Hassan. Ruhullah was married to Hassan's daughter, but the marriage ended in divorce. Ruhullah later married an Iranian national.

The tension between Ruhullah and the NC top brass flared up in the wake of the 2024 Assembly polls when CM Omar decided to retain the Ganderbal constituency while resigning from his second seat, Budgam. The NC looked to give its ticket to Omar's confidant Nasir Aslam Wani in the Budgam bypoll and sought Ruhullah's support, but he refused to back Wani.

As Ruhullah stepped aside, his cousin Muntazir trounced NC candidate Aga Mehmood, who had been a minister in the erstwhile Farooq Abdullah government. Mehmood also belongs to the Aga clan as he is the younger brother of Fazlullah. Mehmood had won from Pattan in 1987 and Beerwah (1996). So Agas have played a range of roles across Kashmir's political spectrum, even as Ruhullah, after quitting the NC, is now seeking to chart his own course.

FULL REPORT ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

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Former J&K chief minister and National Conference president Farooq Abdullah in Jammu on Thursday. PTI

Farooq for India-Pak talks, says can't wait for guns to fall silent

Express News Service
Jammu, November 12

MAKING A strong pitch for dialogue between India and Pakistan, National Conference (NC) president and former J&K chief minister Farooq Abdullah on Thursday said that the recent terrorist attacks in Kulgam and Kishtwar indicate that threats continue to persist and concrete measures are needed to eliminate them.

"I have already said that such incidents are still happening," he told media persons here, adding that "one never knows where the next attack might take place".

Expressing concern over Delhi's claims that terrorism has ended in J&K, Abdullah said that bullets and military confrontation cannot resolve political disputes and called on India and Pakistan to start a meaningful engagement.

"*Ab aap intezaar karenge, jab tak aap sabki goliyan band ho jayengi, tab tak raat ho jayegi* (If you keep waiting for everyone to stop firing, it will be too late by the time the guns fall silent)," he said.

The former chief minister also urged Islamabad to abandon terrorism and work towards creating an atmosphere conducive for dialogue with India.

"Nothing can be achieved through terrorism. The process of dialogue must begin because a way forward can only be found through talks," he said.

Reacting to the recent twin terror attacks in Kulgam and Kishtwar districts, which resulted in the death of two Special Police Officers and the injuring of three CRPF personnel, Abdullah said that those harboring ambitions of snatching Kashmir must abandon such notions. "Kashmir is, was, and will remain an integral part of India," he said.

Citing the EU as an example of former adversaries building a common future through cooperation, the NC leader said, "We must revive SAARC so that all of us can resolve our disputes, and work towards progress and development."

Voter rolls expand by up to 3% in 9 states, UTs in first post-SIR draft

Express News Service
New Delhi, November 12

DRAFT ELECTORAL rolls published in nine states/UTs as part of the ongoing Special Summary Revision (SSR) on Thursday showed an increase in electors ranging between 0.1% to 3% from the final electoral rolls published under the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) in 2025-26.

Having deferred its regular January schedule for the SSR as the SIR was on, the Election Commission announced the SSR on October 15 for 17 states/UTs.

Of those states/UTs, draft rolls published on Thursday showed that the total number of electors had increased by 0.1% in Lakshadweep, 1.3% in Puducherry, 1.5% each in Kerala and Madhya Pradesh, 1.7% in Manipur, 1.8% each in Bihar and Tamil Nadu.

Rajasthan and Goa data showed an increase in total number of electors by 2.22% and 3%, respectively.

For the remaining states and UTs, either the publication date has been postponed to later this month or the consolidated details were not available.

Ordering the Special Summary Revision, the EC had written: "...in order to facilitate the enrolment of eligible electors with reference to the qualifying date of 1st January, 2027 along with seeking advance applications for the three subsequent qualifying dates of 1st April, 1st July & 1st October, 2027, the Commission hereby directs that the existing electoral rolls shall be revised by conducting a Special Summary Revision (SSR) under Section 21 of the Representation of the People Act, 1950".

Rajasthan and Goa saw an increase of electors by 2.22% and 3%, respectively; meanwhile, Puducherry, Keralam, Madhya Pradesh, Manipur, Bihar and Tamil Nadu recorded increase in the range of 1-2%

On November 4, the EC announced the SSR schedule in six more states/UTs.

"In States/UTs where SIR is going on or has just been completed (viz. Andhra Pradesh, Haryana, Jharkhand, Karnataka, Maharashtra, Meghalaya, Nagaland, NCT of Delhi, Tripura, and Telangana), the schedule for SSR will be announced later," the EC said on November 4.

"Also, for the 3 States/UTs namely Himachal Pradesh, Jammu & Kashmir, and Ladakh, where SIR has not been started so far, schedule for roll revision will be announced in due course of time keeping in view their weather conditions," the Election Commission said then.

Expelled Cong leader questioned for three days in Siddaramaiah sting case

Express News Service
Bengaluru, November 12

THE BENGALURU Central Crime Branch (CCB) has questioned Krupa Alva, 60, a former Karnataka Congress general secretary recently expelled over her alleged role in facilitating the alleged 2023 sting operation targeting former chief minister Siddaramaiah, over three days following her return from a foreign trip on November 7.

During a hearing for anticipatory bail at a Bengaluru sessions court on Wednesday, Alva's advocates said the CCB had issued a lookout circular (LOC) while she was abroad and served her a notice upon landing at the airport on November 7. Her counsel told the court that Alva complied with two subsequent notices and reported for questioning each time, though she fears arrest because of the LOC and repeated summons.

Alva's counsel told the court that before her foreign trip, she cooperated with the investigation by taking CCB officials to Kozhikode, Kerala, to meet the woman featured in the video, who claimed an association with Siddaramaiah dating back to 2011.

Following the woman's questioning, the CCB officially stated on October 29 that her claims were false and that she had been instructed to fabricate an association with the former chief minister.

"The statements recorded, and evidence collected during the investigation thus far do not substantiate the occurrence of any such incident as depicted in the video. All individuals appearing in the video have been identified and extensively examined," the CCB said in a statement.

"The circumstances under which the video was created, the purpose behind recording it nearly 12 years after the alleged incident, the identities and roles of those involved and their possible motives are all being investigated," it added.

The video was allegedly filmed on a hidden camera by a Power TV Kannada crew member at the direction of managing director Rakesh Shetty, who also appears in the video.

Police said Alva led the TV crew to the woman in Kozhikode to secure a Congress party ticket for the 2023 Assembly polls. However, she was reportedly unaware of the hidden camera filming.

The Karnataka Pradesh Congress Committee expelled Alva on October 27 after she failed to respond to a show-cause notice over the sting.

The investigation has expanded to examine alleged blackmail motives and how the 2023 footage surfaced online in 2026. Alongside Alva and Power TV cameraman Prashanth Kumar, MD Rakesh Shetty is under CCB investigation.

Shetty, who has also applied for anticipatory bail, presented documents to the court requesting to be treated as a witness in the extortion, blackmail, and defamation case Siddaramaiah filed on October 6.

The CCB is also probing several people linked to the Janata Dal (Secular) for uploading the footage to a YouTube channel named Karnataka Honey Trap on September 26, a move Siddaramaiah alleged was meant to defame him. Suspects under investigation include JD(S) media consultant Prajwal Prasad, social media head Chandan H S, and social media staff Mohan Gowda and Vinod Kumar.

H D Kumaraswamy alleged that Chief Minister D K Shivakumar was behind the 2023 sting against his intra-party rival Siddaramaiah, to which Shivakumar responded that "time will reveal" the truth.

All suspects in the case currently have interim anticipatory bail, and they are seeking regular anticipatory bail before the court.

Bulldozer at his doorstep, Abhishek says 'won't retreat'

Sweety Kumari
Kolkata, November 12

A BULLDOZER reached Trinamool Congress (TMC) MP Abhishek Banerjee's residence in south Kolkata on Thursday and removed a makeshift structure erected during the Trinamool government's term.

Officials from Kolkata Municipal Corporation and police were at the site early Thursday as the bamboo structure was removed. They said the structure had been occupying the footpath and causing inconvenience to the public.

Banerjee's aides said Bengal's Directorate of Security had erected the structure in the Trinamool era as part of his security arrangements. The work to dismantle the structure started on Wednesday night and was completed Thursday morning.

A commotion broke out on November 7 in front of Banerjee's house during his birthday celebrations. While the local Trinamool unit alleged that BJP workers caused trouble, BJP leaders said the dispute was because idols of Goddess Kali could not be taken through the street due to the structure.

Banerjee, however, suggested that the removal of the structure was an act of political vendetta by the ruling BJP. "No number of bulldozers can silence my voice or break my resolve. I will continue my fight. I will neither retreat nor budge an inch until my last breath."

RSS chief on crackers: 'Earlier variants used to purify atmosphere'

Ankita Kishor Deshkar
Nagpur, November 12



Mohan Bhagwat's remarks have come amid concerns over the pollution caused by crackers. FILE

RASHTRIYA SWAYAMSEVAK Sangh (RSS) chief Mohan Bhagwat said on Wednesday that earlier variants of firecrackers, made without chemical substances, helped kill insects and pests, and purify the environment, as he explained the "scientific rationale" behind several practices during festivals, including lighting diyas.

Mohan Bhagwat's remarks have come amid growing concerns over the pollution caused by firecrackers, with several cities such as Mumbai and Delhi bearing the brunt of their aftereffects post-Diwali.

Speaking at a "Deepawali Milan" programme in Nagpur, Mohan Bhagwat said there was a scientific rationale behind several traditional practices associated with festivals. He said that in the past, firecrackers were used as there was no alternative available to achieve the same purpose. "The firecrackers of earlier times were not made using chemical substances as they are today. Their smoke helped kill insects and pests, particularly around the harvest season, and in a way, purified the atmosphere," he said. Explaining the purpose of lighting ghee and oil diyas on Diwali, Mohan Bhagwat said, "When lamps fuelled by ghee or oil were lit, they created a particular kind of air in the environment. There is science behind these practices as well."

Urging people to understand the significance of traditional practices and observe festivals in their proper spirit, Bhagwat said it would benefit both humans and the environment. He also asserted that festivals and celebrations have been an integral part of society and would continue despite opposition.

"Festivals keep society alive. No matter how much anyone tries to stop them, they will not stop because they are essential to keeping society vibrant. What matters is that we observe them in the right spirit and ensure that we derive the intended benefits from them," he said. Describing Diwali as a festival that symbolises the triumph of light over darkness, Bhagwat said it was also about spreading the light of knowledge and creating a harmonious society.

He also noted that Diwali had gained international recognition, with institutions such as the US and UK Parliaments also acknowledging the festival. He said people in countries with sizeable Indian populations had increasingly begun extending Diwali greetings.

In its second Punjab list, AAP drops 'giant killers' who defeated Badal Sr and Channi

Kanchan Vasdev
Chandigarh, November 12

THE AAM Aadmi Party (AAP) on Thursday released its second list of 31 candidates for the 2027 Punjab Assembly elections, fielding two MPs, renominating two MLAs while dropping seven legislators, including a Cabinet minister and two former ministers. With this, the ruling party has declared candidates for 71 of the total 117 Assembly seats.

The party has fielded Sangrur MP Gurmeet Singh Meet Hayer from Barnala and Hoshiarpur MP Dr Raj Kumar Chabbewal from Phagwara. The two legislators who have been renominated are Saravjit Kaur Manuke from Jagraon and Amandeep Singh Goldy Musafir from Balluana.

Among the big names that failed to get a ticket, Cabinet minister Gurmeet Singh Khuddian has been dropped from Lambi constituency from where the AAP has fielded his nephew Randhir Singh Dhira Khuddian. In the 2022 Assembly polls, Gurmeet Singh Khuddian had emerged as a giant-killer, defeating Shiromani Akali Dal patron and five-time former CM Parkash Singh Badal by a margin of 11,357 votes.

The AAP has fielded Jaskanwar Singh Gill, alias Jassa Patti, from Patti Assembly constituency, a seat currently represented by jailed former minister Laljit Singh Bhullar. Two days ago, Bhullar had ruled himself out of the 2027 Assembly elections, announcing that he will not contest the polls.

Others who have been dropped include former minister Anmol Gagan Maan from Kharar, Amit Rattan Kotfatta from Bathinda Rural, Raman Arora from Jalandhar Central and Charanjit Singh from Chamkaur Sahib.

The party has fielded halqa incharges Parminder Singh Goldy from Kharar, Gopal Singh from Bathinda Rural, Nitin Kohli from Jalandhar Central and Jasvir Singh Garhi from Chamkaur Sahib, respectively.

Charanjit Sigh too had emerged a giantkiller in 2022 polls defeating then chief minister and Congress leader Charanjit Singh Channi. In 2023, the Punjab Vigilance Bureau had arrested Kotfatta in a bribery case.

In Amritsar North, the party has fielded Karamjit Singh Rintu. The seat was represented by former IPS officer Kunwar Vijay Pratap Singh who recently resigned from the Vidhan Sabha and the AAP and formally joined the BJP.

In a first for the party, a father-son duo has been nominated. While Dr Chabbewal has been fielded from Phagwara, his son Ishank Kumar Chabbewal was given a ticket from Chabbewal in the first list announced on October 31.

No Cabinet minister figures in the second list either. The party had retained all sitting MLAs in its first list of 40 candidates. However, after that list, three MLAs moved to BJP.

Announcing the list, Mann said, "Here, neither recommendations nor requests work. We have identified volunteers who have been working hard for the party. Several new candidates have also been given an opportunity."

With the candidates' list announced, the contestants would now get more time to reach out to voters and inform that of the party's many policies, he said.

Of the 31 candidates, six had contested the 2022 Assembly elections from other parties.

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Ex.mechval@gmail.com
कार्यालय आदेश

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सूचना संख्या– 01/2026-27

अभियंता प्रमुख, पथ निर्माण विभाग, बिहार, पटना के कार्यालय आदेश संख्या–328, दिनांक–30.10.2026 सह–पठित ज्ञापांक–7613(E) दिनांक–30.10.2026 द्वारा दिए गए निदेशानुसार वित्तीय वर्ष 2026-27 के लिए अधीक्षण अभियंता, राष्ट्रीय उच्च पथ अंचल, पूर्णियां अंतर्गत राष्ट्रीय उच्च पथ प्रमंडल, पूर्णियाँ एवं मधेपुरा में अत्यावश्यक/आकस्मिक प्रकार के कार्यों के त्वरित निष्पादन हेतु सामग्रियों/सेवाओं/Tools & Plants आदि के लिए आपूर्तिकर्ता/सेवा प्रदाताओं के लिए पथ निर्माण विभाग, बिहार में निबंधित कार्य संवेदकों में से पैनल बनाने हेतु मुहरबंद कोटेशन आमंत्रित किया जाता है। यह पैनल वित्तीय वर्ष 2026-27 के पूर्व से अनुमोदित पैनल के अतिरिक्त होगा।

- कोटेशन प्राप्ति का स्थान:– 1. कार्यपालक अभियंता, रा0 उ0 प0 प्रमंडल, पूर्णियाँ/मधेपुरा का कार्यालय। 2. अधीक्षण अभियंता, रा0 उ0 प0, अंचल, पूर्णियां का कार्यालय। 3. मुख्य अभियंता, राष्ट्रीय उच्च पथ (उत्तर) उपभाग, पथ निर्माण विभाग, बिहार, पटना का कार्यालय।
- **कोटेशन प्राप्ति की अंतिम तिथि एवं समय:– दिनांक–23.11.2026 को 03:00 बजे अपराह्न तक।**
- **कोटेशन खोलने की स्थान, तिथि एवं समय:**– निर्धारित कार्यालयों में दिनांक–23.11.2026 को 03:30 बजे अपराह्न तक।
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PUBLIC AUCTION/TENDER NOTICE
DISPOSAL OF UNCLEARED/UNCLAIMED IMPORTED CARGO THROUGH E- AUCTION

Container Corporation of India Ltd. shall be auctioning scrap items, empty damage containers and unclaimed/uncleared imported cargo landed at the terminals of Area 1 those containers arrived on or before 31.03.2026 through e-auction on **30.11.2026** on **"AS IS WHERE IS BASIS"**. All details **along with Terms & Conditions of auction sale & cargo details will be available on www.concorindia.co.in & www.mstcecommerce.com w.e.f. 16.11.2026.** All importers including Government Undertakings/ Departments whose containers/goods are lying unclaimed/uncleared and falling in the said list uploaded in website at respective terminals, because of any dispute, stay by Court/ Tribunal/others or any such reason may accordingly inform the concerned Area Head at Area 1 of CONCOR as well as Commissioner of Customs of the concerned Commissionaires, and file their objections/claims regarding disposal of such goods within **7 (Seven Days)** of this notice failing which the goods will be auctioned on **"AS IS WHERE IS BASIS"** without any further notice. For full details please log on to **www.concorindia.co.in** & **www.mstcecommerce.com**

Area Head, Area 1

WESTERN RAILWAY
CORRIGENDUM
Tender Notice No. Mech-TPA-2026, Dtd.: 14.10.2026 earlier Tender Submission Closing Date & Time: 12.11.2026 at 15.00 hrs. now to be read as 23.11.2026 at 15.00 hrs. All other terms & conditions shall remain unchanged. 0806
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SOUTH EAST CENTRAL RAILWAY
E-TENDER NOTICE
The Chief Workshop Manager/S.E.C. Railway, MIB/WS, Nagpur, acting for and on behalf of President of India invites E-Tender for execution of work mentioned below: **Sl.No.**1, **Tender Notice No.** : MIBW-2026-19-06-03-08, **Name of Work:** Repair and Comprehensive Annual Maintenance Contract (CAMC) for 3 years of 51 Nos. Welding Machines (MIG, TIG, ARC & Air Plasma) of different makes and capacities at Motibagh Workshop, Nagpur. **Approx Tender Value (in ₹):** 40,87,225.44 (Rupees Forty Lakh Eighty Seven Thousand Two Hundred Twenty Five and Paisa Forty Four Only), **Earnest Money (in ₹):** 81,700/- (Rupees Eighty One Thousand Seven Hundred Only), **Tenure of Contract:** 37 Months, **Cost of Tender Form (in ₹):** ₹ 0/- (Rupees Zero only); **Sl. No.** 2, **Tender Notice No.:** MIBW-2026-19-06-06-09, **Name of Work** : Up-gradation of Coach Toilets in LHB AC and Non-AC Coaches as per scope of work at Motibagh Workshop/Nagpur, Coaching Depot/Durg, Coaching Depot/Bilaspur & Coaching Depot/ Gondia. **Approx Tender Value (in ₹):** 74,45,50,130.58 (Rupees Seventy Four Crore Forty Five Lakh Fifty Thousand One Hundred Thirty and Fifty Eight Paise only). **Earnest Money (in ₹):** 1,48,91,000/- (Rupees One Crore Forty Eight Lakh Ninety One Thousand only), **Tenure of contract:** 27 Months, **Cost of Tender Form (in ₹):** ₹ 0/- (Rupees Zero only).

Pre-bid meeting for tender at Sl. No. 2 shall be held on 13.11.2026 at 11.00 hrs. at Motibagh Workshop, Nagpur. Tenderers are advised to attend the same for clarification of queries, if any, related to the tender. Bidders will be able to submit their original/revised bids up to 11:00 hrs. on 30/11/2026 for Sl. No. 1 & 2.

Manual offers are not allowed against this tender and any such manual offers received shall be rejected. Details are available on our website **www.ireps.gov.in.**

Dy. Chief Mechanical Engineer
S. E. C. Railway, Motibagh Workshop, Nagpur
PAM/68/184
South East Central Railway @secrail

MITL
Maharashtra Industrial Township Limited (MITL)
(A Government Undertaking)
Regd. Off.- 'Udyog Sarthi, MIDC Office, Marol Industrial Area, Andheri (East), Mumbai - 400 093, Maharashtra, INDIA. Tel No.: +91(022 26879956), www.auric.city, Mail Id: dgmelecpra@auric.city; CIN : U74999MH2014SGC260132

Maharashtra Industrial Township Ltd. (MITL) is currently developing AURIC, an Industrial Township spread over approximately 40 sq. km. MITL invites RFQ cum RFP bids for the "Design, Construction, Testing, Commissioning, Operation and Maintenance of Infrastructure Works at AURIC – Bidkin Industrial Area (BIA), Sector B & C on EPC Basis"

(Tender No.: MITL/SBIA/2026-27/10)

The tender details are available at **https://aitl.eproc.in, www.auric.city**. Interested applicants are requested to submit their RFQ cum RFP responses online by 1500 hrs on or before 18th December 2026. A non-refundable processing fees of INR 5,90,000/- shall be paid along with the submission through MITL's online e-procurement portal.

Sd/-
Managing Director, MITL
Mumbai, Date: 13th November 2026

बिहार सरकार
न्यायालय– बंदोबस्त कार्यालय, गोपालगंज
आम–सूचना

सर्व सधारण को सूचित किया जाता है कि निम्नांकित कॉलम–08/09/10 में अंकित बिहार मद्यनिशेद्य और उत्पाद अधिनियम के तहत जप्त वाहन के अधिग्रहण की कार्यवाही अधोहस्ताक्षरी के न्यायालय में चल रही है लेकिन कुछ वाहन मालिक का नाम, पता प्राप्त नहीं हो सका है एवं कुछ संबंधित वाहन मालिक अबतक इस न्यायालय में उपस्थित होकर अपना दावा प्रस्तुत नहीं किये है तथा कुछ मामले में दावा प्रस्तुत करने के उपरांत अधिरोपित शास्ति जमा नहीं किया गया है।

SL NO.	CASE NO.	DM CASE NO.	THANA	LTR NO	NAME AND ADDRESS	THANA/ CASE NO	REGISTRATION NO	CHASIS NO	ENGINE NO
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
1	219/2026	1206/26	गोपालपुर	1900/विधि, दिनांक 08.08.2026	उदय त्यागी सा0–C/o- Susheel tyagi, M-100, M Block, Middel circle haldi ram cannaughat place, New Delhi	गोपालपुर थाना कांड सं0–172/26	DL13CA4816	MA3EFJC1S00211478	M16AN2046401

अतः समाचार पत्र के माध्यम से उक्त जप्त वाहन मालिक को सूचित किया जाता है कि इस सूचना के प्रकाशन के 15 दिनों के अन्दर अधोहस्ताक्षरी के न्यायालय में स्वयं या अपने अधिवक्ता के माध्यम से उपस्थित होकर लिखित रूप से कारण बतावें कि क्यों नहीं कॉलम–08/09/10 में अंकित जप्त वाहन को राजसात कर लिया जाय। निर्धारित **तिथि–24.11.2026** तक पक्ष प्रस्तुत नहीं करने पर यह माना जायेगा कि संबंधित मालिक को इस संबंध में कुछ नहीं कहना है और तदनुसार अभिलेख में उपलब्ध कागज के आधार पर आदेश पारित किया जायेगा।

यदि सूची में उल्लेखित वाहन पर किसी अन्य व्यक्ति का दावा बनता हो तो वैसे व्यक्ति भी ससमय न्यायालय में उपस्थित होकर साक्ष्य सहित अपना पक्ष रख सकते है।

विस्तृत जानकारी **state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar** पर भी देखी जा सकती है।

बंदोबस्त पदाधिकारी
–सह– अपर समाहर्त्ता (लो0शि0नि0)
गोपालगंज

PR- 015346 (Revenue) 2026-27 नशे की मार, बर्बाद करे सुखी परिवार।



बिहार सरकार



बिहार है तैयार

पटना नगर निगम की राष्ट्रीय स्तर पर गौरवपूर्ण उपलब्धि

10वें स्वच्छ सर्वेक्षण पुरस्कार 2025-26 में

माननीय राष्ट्रपति श्रीमती द्रौपदी मुर्मू
के कर-कमलों द्वारा

पटना नगर निगम को पुरस्कार प्रदत्त

"स्टेट फर्स्ट स्वच्छ सिटी" पुरस्कार

माननीय प्रधानमंत्री श्री नरेंद्र मोदी के स्वच्छ भारत मिशन की परिकल्पना को साकार करने की दिशा में पटना निरंतर अग्रसर।

श्री सम्राट चौधरी
माननीय मुख्यमंत्री का संदेश

पटना नगर निगम की इस गौरवपूर्ण उपलब्धि पर सभी पटनावासियों को हार्दिक बधाई एवं शुभकामनाएँ।

PR.NO_015420(URBAN)D.2026-27

WEB EXCLUSIVE
Why must the dinosaur always be the bad guy?
— Kaushik Das Gupta
Log on to www.indianexpress.com

WORDLY WISE
There is no conversation more boring than the one where everybody agrees.
— Michel de Montaigne

The Indian EXPRESS
~ FOUNDED BY ~
RAMNATH GOENKA
IN 1932

BECAUSE THE TRUTH
INVOLVES US ALL

On Russia-Ukraine, a chance for diplomacy

ON THE face of it, the gains from two days of talks between Russian and Ukrainian envoys — with Jared Kushner, President Donald Trump's son-in-law, and Steve Witkoff, Washington's Special Envoy to the Middle East, present –– are rather modest. The two countries have agreed to a prisoner swap, the largest since the conflict began in 2022. On more fundamental issues, such as territory, duration and terms of a ceasefire and what a post-war European security architecture will look like, both sides said there was some progress. But there were no major announcements. Despite the lack of a breakthrough at Abu Dhabi, however, there is reason to believe that the diplomatic needle could move soon.

Kushner and Witkoff are in Moscow, reportedly to ask Russian President Vladimir Putin to add European representatives to the talks. A question hangs over that request: Who will represent Europe, given that there are multiple views on the continent and within the European Union on how to deal with Russia? After Moscow, the two will go to Dublin and meet Ukraine's President, Volodymyr Zelenskyy. Both sides remain seemingly entrenched in their positions: While Kyiv and its staunchest supporters in Europe want a ceasefire in place before discussions on the post-war security architecture, Moscow has sought to link a cessation of hostilities with the broader question of NATO expansion and what it sees as its sphere of influence. In other words, while one side sees the ceasefire as a precondition, the other views it as intertwined with the bigger unresolved questions. Trump's White House has leaned towards the latter.

Nearly half a decade of conflict has taken a toll — political, economic and humanitarian — on Russia, Ukraine and the wider world. That there have been no major attacks in recent days by either country is something to be welcomed, cautiously. The White House, reeling from a Republican drubbing in the midterm polls, will want to present a peace deal to the American people sooner rather than later. Russia, if a ceasefire is achieved, can act as an intermediary between Tehran and Washington. Europe, too, needs stability on its eastern front. The recent increase in defence budgets notwithstanding, the continent still relies on the American security umbrella. New Delhi's proposal for de-escalation was welcomed by Ukraine's Foreign Minister Andrii Sybiha. A cessation of hostilities would lead to the easing of the supply-chain constraints in energy and foodgrain, both essential for India's economy. In Moscow and Dublin, Kyiv and Brussels, the task now is to build trust, which can enable a good-faith negotiation and the compromise the world has been waiting for.

Respect the river, don't treat it like a quarry

SAND IS the second-most exploited natural resource after water in several parts of the world, including India. Unregulated extraction of sand is a serious environmental challenge — it deepens and widens the riverbed, destabilises riverbanks, alters natural water flow, and causes downstream erosion. The Supreme Court has pulled up state governments at least three times since 2023 for their failure to check illegal sand mining. But a nearly 40 per cent gap in sand supplies for India's burgeoning construction industry has meant that court orders remain largely unimplemented. The Central Empowered Committee, which advises the SC on forest-related matters, has now proposed a different approach. It has recommended a three-year road map to phase out sand extraction from active river channels. The CEC has also suggested alternative sources to progressively reduce dependence on this natural resource. In a report submitted to the Court earlier this month, the Committee has called for desilting of dams and reservoirs.

Sand and gravel naturally make their way to riverbeds, raising them steadily and lowering the carrying capacity of water bodies. Desilting clears these blockages and allows free flow of water during heavy rainfall. Implementing the CEC's proposal could replenish reservoir capacity. But the Court-appointed committee has rightly underlined the need for a long-term plan to implement its suggestion. Its caution is justified. Sediments do not always impair the health of rivers. They play an important role in sustaining downstream river ecosystems. In 2022, a committee headed by former Central Water Commission chairperson B K Mittal had found large-scale desilting technologically and economically unviable. Like the CEC, it recommended dredging only at specific reaches of rivers, when backed by scientific studies.

The Court-appointed committee has also acknowledged that it does not know how much sand dams in the country hold. It has asked the Jal Shakti Ministry to steward a national framework specifying reservoir-wise sediment availability, financial arrangements and environmental safeguards. The Centre and state governments would do well to read the underlying message behind the CEC's proposals. Rivers should not be treated as quarries. The challenge is to reconcile the demand for building material with the equally compelling need to keep water bodies alive.

For a good conversation, not just pink noise

THE FINE art of a good conversation, it seems, is a skill only a few are in possession of. Or, as Oscar Wilde had put it, "Conversation about the weather is the last refuge of the unimaginative." A good conversation begins with the ability to make exchanges feel effortless, especially when some can turn it into an endurance test, and the dexterity to know when to stay with a thought and when to let it wander. It needs a little structure, a little spontaneity and, above all, room to breathe.

Researchers at Dartmouth College, US, have termed this pink noise. After analysing more than 1,000 conversations, including exchanges between strangers, friends and speed-dating participants, they have found that the most satisfying ones followed a pattern of ebb and flow. Pink noise describes the sweet spot between two extremes: White noise, where thoughts scatter without much connection, and red/brown noise, where the conversation goes round in circles. The ideal exchange moves between the familiar and the unexpected. People settle into a subject, build on each other's thoughts, introduce new ideas before finding common ground again. This rhythm was associated with greater enjoyment, a stronger sense of connection.

And yet, no scientific paper can quite prescribe the ingredients of a memorable conversation. For that, a few old-fashioned essentials still hold their own. There must be listening, curiosity, a drink or two, if the occasion calls for it; and no compulsion to fill every silence. Sprinkle in some disagreement, a dose of laughter, and one has what can be termed as a cracker of a chinwag.

Celebrating the voter in the age of SIR — a modest proposal



ASHOK LAVASA

THE ELECTION Commission of India's (ECI) Voter Helpline is 1950, representing its birth that year on January 25, a day before the Indian Republic was born. Since 2011, that day has been observed as National Voters' Day (NVD) to showcase ECI's citizen-friendly initiatives and distribute Elector Photo Identity Cards (EPIC) to first-time voters.

Preparations for the NVD 2027 must be underway as the ECI also organises an international conference on January 24 for which representatives from election management bodies of different countries are invited.

What could the ECI showcase on the upcoming NVD given its preoccupation with rewinding its decisions amid hostilities over the much-touted nationwide Special Intensive Revision (SIR) exercise, its own misdirected "*shuddhi*" movement? The following could reflect its current penitent mood.

The ECI could declare this year's event as National Deleted Voters Restoration Day to demonstrate its resolve to bring back the SIR victims. This would be in keeping with its direction to compare the pre-and-post-SIR electoral rolls to identify those deleted and bring them back, like "home they brought her warrior dead".

The first exhibit could be the bringing back to life of some "dead" electors who survived the attempt to eliminate them, participated in tea parties, and accompanied petitioners to the Supreme Court (SC). The ECI claimed it removed approximately 2.8 crore "dead" Indians who "lived" in the electoral rolls due to the generous incompetence of past Commissions and that the SIR was the rite necessary to formalise their departure.

The next exhibit could showcase the innovative weapons of mass deletions, called "logical discrepancy" and "mapping". As interactive exhibits are in fashion, it could have a live demonstration of how the deadly algorithm decapitated unsuspecting twins who couldn't prove the minimum nine-month gap necessary between siblings, or those whose names were spelt differently in the present electoral roll when compared with the reference roll of 2002, and those who couldn't be "mapped" and were dropped like redundant pieces that didn't fit into a preconceived pattern. Giving them company could be harried judicial officers limping under the impossible burden put on them by an unusually friendly SC.

The members of the Appellate Tribunals in West Bengal could be shown struggling to find the wherewithal to deal with their onerous task, cheered by the thousands of electors they ordered back onto the rolls although they were deprived of their right to vote in the West Bengal election, and the lakhs who must wait up to a decade to be again eligible for the indelible ink mark on their index finger. This section could be titled "killing with kindness" in keeping with the SC's legendary observation anaesthetising their voting rights till future elections.

This could thematically harmonise with the next exhibit showing millions of "others" deleted and left languishing in fear of losing their human and civic rights because of government orders depriving them of many welfare schemes. Keeping them company could be the over 6 crore deleted as they were "absent" or marked "shifted" and are "wandering between two worlds, one dead, the other powerless to be born".

On display could be the ECI's extraordinary innovation in dividing its legally notified electorate into pre-and-post-2002/3 eras, then subdividing them by age, somewhat like classifying Indian history into ancient, medieval and modern, attaching varying degrees of credibility to available evidence.

> A giant sieve with large holes to separate the stones from the grain could symbolise the SIR, showing perfect grains rapidly passing through and being discarded as 'ineligible'. A blank exhibit could represent the 'ghuspaithiyas'

A giant sieve with large holes to separate the stones from the grain could symbolise the SIR, showing perfect grains rapidly passing through and being discarded as "ineligible". A blank exhibit could represent the "*ghuspaithiyas*", the illegal immigrants the SIR was intended to find.

The next exhibit, captioned "twice-born" or "*gharwapsi*" (homecoming), could showcase the mercy of the ECI in allowing the "rebirth" of "ineligible" deleted electors by performing the ritual of filling in Form 6, something they had gone through in their previous incarnation. Mocking each other could be the different versions of Form 6, with and without the Declaration, awaiting the SC's verdict on whether they were illegally conceived.

Grinning mischievously at Form 6 would be Form 7 in the hands of democracy's vigilante brigade, furiously filling in the names of undesirables that "needed" to be removed from the rolls. This malicious move burdened the system with unnecessary work and damaged the ECI's reputation when its indifference was deemed as complicity. Meanwhile, Form 8 would stare at them with villainous scorn as it succeeded in replacing names without leaving a trace — a method that has since been christened the Pilibhit model of purgation.

Because of limited space, the exhibition may not display the ECI's other ingenious initiatives but it cannot overlook showing how gleefully vindicated political parties seemed at its decision to share the electoral roll in a machine-readable format.

The last exhibit could be of the Special Summary Revision (SSR), resurrected recently by the ECI to "include" all "eligible" electors. A doleful SSR could be shown screaming silently that it could have achieved the objectives of the SIR had it not been kept in suspended animation.

Something significant would be missing if the ECI didn't dedicate its predicament to the SC, acknowledging its role in reaching this unfamiliar place between the devil and the deep sea. It would be equally insincere if it didn't attribute the sponsorship of this unique exhibition to *The Indian Express*, for without its revelations the ECI may not have made such inglorious somersaults.

If the ECI is sincere in regaining people's trust, it must have an exhibit of the three chosen ones apologising to the people for vandalising their voting right by violating the spirit of 1950. They followed an approach antithetical to their constitutional role and responsibility and did little to dispel the impression that the ECI's arbitrary decisions pursued an uncharacteristic agenda. If they want people to believe they did nothing wrong, they must demand the abrogation of the law that provides them lifelong immunity from prosecution. It is they who must dial 1950 and convince people that mass disenfranchisement isn't serious enough to demand their resignation.

Why wait till the NVD? They could do so before November 26, the day the Constitution was adopted and Article 324 made effective.

The writer is a former election commissioner

A charter for the republic of neglected authors



AREFA TEHSIN

AS I sat looking at my bi-annual royalty statement this week, I realised November 1 was the day of us *nacheez* authors. National Authors' Day is when the US and a few other countries celebrate great pensmiths like Mark Twain, Stephen King and Harper Lee. Those who gave us explosive books, a decent punch, left us dazzled, even aided revolutions. It made me look at the mugshot on one of my statements, put there to fill the space, and wonder if We the Authors of India should finally do what everybody else in this country does when life hands them a lemon. Form a *morcha*.

Every community worth its salt has a charter of demands and somebody's cousin in the Vidhan Sabha. What do we have? Reading glasses, a tote bag from a 2019 lit fest and a WhatsApp group that has been fighting over the Oxford comma since the Covid lockdown. It is time we organised. Comrades of the quill, let's start with our very own charter:

A Minimum Support Price for words: The farmer at least knows what her wheat will fetch. We pour three years and two relationships into a novel and the statement arrives twice a year with the seriousness of court summons to inform us that we have earned Rs 15,251.25 for six months of existence. Minus returns. The *chaiwala* on Rani Road has made more out of me last winter.

A spot on bestseller lists: Fifty per cent of all slots must go to books actually written by the person whose name is on the cover. Cricketers, film stars, swamis and CEOs who discovered their "journey" at a corporate retreat may compete in the general category, along with the ghosts who write these books and deserve a quota of their own.

No more royalty statement emails: In publishing, advance is the polite word for the last money you will ever see from a book. We demand that publishers stop sending us bi-annual emails with the royalty statement, a phrase that has caused more heartbreak than any Bollywood climax, unless there are three zeros after the royalty figure which should not start with a zero.

Protection from pedantic panels: I have just received an invitation from a lit fest to be a part of 'Interrogating the Post-Truth Anthropocene Novel'. This daunting panel consists of three people I have never read with a moderator who has no intention of reading us. I wonder how I can refuse a fest that has offered me a hard-earned session. But I would rather be talking about writing mysteries to an audience of timid readers with a 9-to-5 job who crave a bloodbath and a thrill.

The fundamental right not to be asked, "But isn't AI going to replace you soon?": Also included in it, "Why don't you give me a copy of your book?" (from acquaintances who have four parking spaces); "My son has written four books. He's just in Grade III!"; "Have you thought of making it into a web series?" and "You can use the dictation app to write more quickly". Offenders will be sentenced to read our complete works. Aloud.

A hundred compulsory reviews for each book: The time pre and post a book release is the most harrowing for us. We end up begging and cajoling readers and relatives, anyone who so much as gives us a lousy smile, to leave a review.

Inclusion in Schedule I of the Wildlife Protection Act: Having written about wildlife over the years, I can say with authority that the Indian author is as endangered as the one-horned rhino. We are solitary, nocturnal and found mostly in cafes, nursing one coffee for six hours. Not to say we can't afford two but it will drain our budget for the week. Our habitat is shrinking as every reader is converted into a reel-scroller. Project Tiger has done wonders. It's time to do a Project Writer.

A hunger strike seemed natural given that most of us are already in training. A *rasta roko* is another idea but half of us would stand there taking notes for our next novel. We can consider a *dharna* at Jantar Mantar, but every participant might insist on reading "just a short excerpt".

Even if we manage to do all of the above, the government will respond the way it always does. It will set up a committee. The committee will submit a 600-page report. Nobody will read it.

As an author in India, I know exactly how that feels.

Tehsin is a writer, most recently of The Fourth Girl

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Green jobs can fill the gaps in the growth story



SRESTHA BANERJEE

THE WORLD Bank has described India's poverty decline as among the world's fastest. Between 2011 and 2023, an estimated 496 million Indians moved out of poverty, and the share of those living in extreme poverty fell from 27.1 per cent to 2.6 per cent. The Bank points to strong consumption growth, social transfers and, above all, rising employment, with more women entering paid work. The next task is to maintain the momentum: Better jobs will carry India towards prosperity. Increasingly, those jobs will be green.

As India works towards Viksit Bharat by 2047 and a net-zero economy by 2070, new industries are taking shape in renewable energy, storage, electric vehicles, green hydrogen, recycling, and nature-based solutions that enhance climate resilience. An iFOREST assessment, *India's Green Jobs Moment*, estimates that these sectors could together support over 1.3 crore jobs by 2035.

Much of this work is spread across towns and villages and will generate local opportunities. Rooftop solar, EV repair, waste recovery and recycling are local by nature, and employment in nature-based solutions such as agroforestry and mangrove restoration is largely rural. Such opportunities are within reach of the households that have just crossed the poverty line.

More than 27 per cent of Indians are aged 15-29, and they are better educated than before. The labour market is sturdy, with the worker population ratio just 1.9 percentage points below the labour force participation rate. India also does not have to build a green workforce from scratch. About 71 per cent of thermal power roles we assessed show high or medium transferability to renewables and green hydrogen, and 90 per cent of automobile roles can move into EVs with targeted training. Many technicians are a short bridge course away from a green career.

The challenge is turning education into technical skills. Only 5.3 per cent of young people have technical education, and 5 per cent formal vocational training. Direct employment in key green sectors is projected to grow by about 4.5 lakh jobs a year, while dedicated green programmes have so far trained around 81,000 people. Even modest expansion would multiply this many times over. Skilling is largely short-term: About 43 per cent of formally trained workers have completed courses of less than six months, while advanced green roles call for deeper technical knowledge.

India's over 15,000 Industrial Training Institutes (ITIS) have more than 26 lakh seats. The PM-SETU scheme is modernising 1,000 government ITIs. We need green laboratories, trained instructors, longer-term and high-value programmes alongside short courses and apprenticeships. We need an educational continuum that runs from school through technical education and vocational training to the workplace. The Ministry of Skill Development and Entrepreneurship is revising the National Policy for Skill Development and Entrepreneurship. That can set the base for skilling India's workforce for the green economy. The next chapter in India's development story, from escaping poverty to building secure, rising incomes, can be written by green work.

The writer is director, Just Transition and Climate Change, iFOREST

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40 YEARS AGO

November 13, 1986


INDIAN EXPRESS

Tripathi, all AICC (I) office-bearers resign

Terrorists gun down 5 in Punjab

Sugarcane price to be raised

AICC(I) office-bearers resign

CONGRESS (I) working president Kamlapati Tripathi and all the office-bearers of the All India Congress (I) Committee submitted their resignations to party president Rajiv Gandhi. The stage is now set for the reorganisation of the party at the central level. The post of working president, which is not provided for in the Congress constitution and was created specially by Indira Gandhi for Tripathi, is certain to be abolished.

Five killed in Punjab

FIVE PERSONS, including three members of a family, were killed and two scooters were snatched by suspected terrorists while security forces nabbed a self-styled "general" of a militant organisation, "Tat Khalsa", during the last 24 hours in Punjab. The fifth killing took place in Kamalpur village. Chaman Lal, a shopkeeper, was shot dead by four suspected terrorists. The assailants, armed with pistols, a rifle and a double-barreled gun, managed to escape.

Delhi hospital services hit

THE DEADLOCK between the Junior Doctors Federation (JDF) and the government continues, with the JDF claiming that the government had made no further approach for negotiations since talks broke down. At Loknayak J P Hospital, the city's largest, attendance at the OPD dropped sharply from the normal 4,000 cases daily to 564. The casualty department, which normally deals with 400 cases, had only 15 serious cases.

Zia's concern

PAKISTAN PRESIDENT General Zia-ul-Haq said he had taken up with India the issue of the latter "amassing" troops on the border and had been assured it was for training purposes. "We accept their argument," Gen Zia said. "We hope there will not be any war between the two countries." He added, "But I am not saying this apologetically. Pakistan will defend its borders and every inch of the lane against any aggressor."

WHAT THE OTHERS SAY

Republicans know that the president's folly and excesses cost them the elections. That doesn't mean they're ready to challenge him. — *The Guardian*

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THE BEST OF BOTH SIDES

A weekly column, which offers not this-versus-that, but the best of both sides, to inform the debate

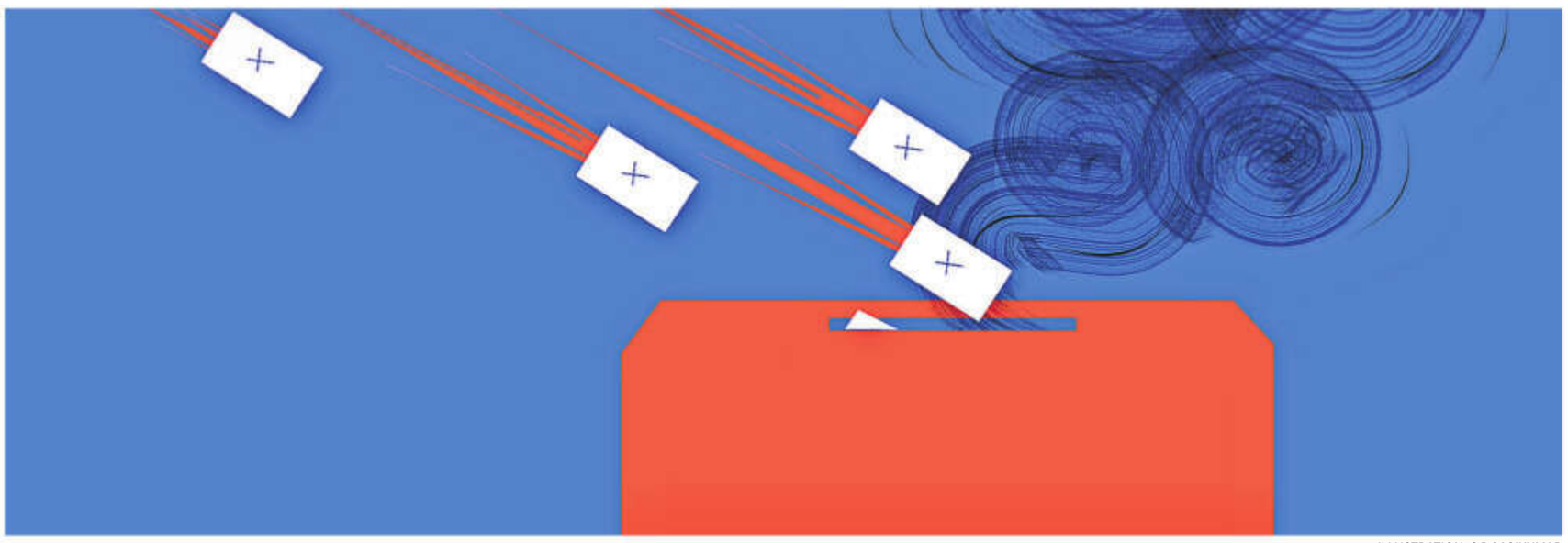


ILLUSTRATION: C R SASIKUMAR

Elections in US and Israel frame political shifts. Will they also impact the conflict in West Asia?

After elections, more pressure for peace



HARSH V PANT

THE EVOLVING political landscape in the US and Israel, coupled with the mounting economic and strategic costs of the Iran conflict, may be creating an opening for diplomacy in the Middle East. The convergence of domestic political constraints, potential leadership changes in Israel, and growing regional anxieties about prolonged instability suggests that the strategic calculus of key actors may be shifting. While the structural impediments to peace remain formidable, this moment offers an opportunity to move beyond the logic of military escalation towards a more sustainable regional security framework.

The outcome of the US midterms is a significant setback for the Trump administration. Democratic victories, widely interpreted as a repudiation of the administration's handling of the Iran war and its economic consequences, have altered Washington's political environment. A Democratic-controlled Congress will have greater leverage over regional policy. Its control over appropriations, oversight and confirmation processes, and its ability to scrutinise arms transfers and military expenditure, could constrain Washington's capacity to sustain an open-ended military campaign. This does not necessarily signal a retreat from the region. Rather, it suggests that the political costs of continued escalation are likely to rise, creating stronger incentives for the administration to explore diplomatic alternatives.

The possibility of negotiated understandings with Tehran on its nuclear programme, freedom of navigation through Hormuz, and non-aggression arrangements involving Gulf states could acquire greater relevance. For Donald Trump, diplomacy may offer an opportunity to reclaim strategic initiative and establish a foreign-policy legacy. Progress on Gaza's transitional governance and reconstruction could be an important component of this effort.

Developments in Israeli politics could reinforce these possibilities. The absence of a clear parliamentary majority after last month's elections has made coalition formation complex and could potentially reduce the dependence of a future government on Israel's most hardline political constituencies. Any change in leadership or governing arrangements would have implications beyond domestic politics. Israel's ability to translate its military advantages into durable strategic outcomes has increasingly been questioned. A government less constrained by the far right's ideological positions could have greater room to combine deterrence with diplomatic engagement and rebuild some of the international credibility eroded by the prolonged conflict.

The prospects for Saudi-Israeli normalisation are particularly significant in this context. Riyadh's insistence on meaningful progress on the Palestinian question remains a major obstacle. A more flexible Israeli government could potentially create space for movement on this front. Similarly, a stronger commitment to addressing extremist violence and improving humanitarian and political conditions in Palestinian territories would be essential to restoring international confidence in Israel.

The Iran conflict has exposed both the limits of military power and the vulnerabilities of the regional security architecture. Growing war fatigue and shared concerns over maritime security, energy flows and regional stability are encouraging greater diplomatic coordination and regional agency, reflected in emerging defence and maritime arrangements. These converging interests could provide a basis for containing Iranian proxies, stabilising Gaza, Lebanon and Syria, and advancing the Abraham Accords. However, sustainable cooperation will depend on addressing Iran-related security concerns and the Palestinian question rather than bilateral normalisation alone.

Existing initiatives, including the Trump administration's Gaza transitional framework and proposals concerning Iran's nuclear programme, maritime security and regional non-aggression, offer potential foundations for a broader diplomatic process. Their significance is reinforced by converging political pressures: A more constrained Washington, possible political recalibration in Israel and growing regional fatigue with instability. Together, these create incentives for diplomacy, but not necessarily consensus. Deep-seated mistrust, competing strategic ambitions, hardline constituencies and the Palestinian question will continue to complicate efforts.

The challenge now is to translate these pressures into a sustainable framework encompassing Iran, maritime security, Gaza's future, Palestinian aspirations and regional economic cooperation. While formidable obstacles remain, the moment offers an opportunity to recognise that lasting regional stability will depend on diplomacy rather than perpetual confrontation.

The writer is vice president, Studies and Foreign Policy, Observer Research Foundation

Poll results set a trap for all sides



SUJATA ASHWARYA

ON NOVEMBER 2, the eve of the US midterms, and after weeks of assurances that Iran would not be struck before the vote, American aircraft hit Qeshm Island. Two days later, with both Houses of Congress lost, Vice President J D Vance wrote that the Republicans had been defeated for one reason: "The reason we lost is the war." President Donald Trump called this "largely true" and said he would do it again. By the week's end, with fresh explosions reported on Qeshm, Trump summarised US policy: "We do minor strikes." The war has become an electoral liability in Washington. It has not lost its author.

In the ABC News Voter Poll, 34 per cent of House voters called the Iran war crucial to their choice. Trump said on election day that the $4 billion in annual military aid to Israel would end this year because it had become a Democratic "talking point". Whether it ends is another matter, since weapons sales continue, the memorandum runs to 2028, and Congress holds the purse. But the most pro-Israel president in modern memory now calls aid to Israel an electoral liability, and half a century of political protection around that aid has visibly eroded.

And yet, none of this binds the man who directs the US campaign. Congress, when it changes hands in January, can investigate, subpoena and withhold money; it cannot recall an aircraft carrier. Trump now says the war will end whenever he wants it to. Vance, a potential 2028 contender, appears to be distancing himself from the conflict. It changes the politics around the President. It does not change the President's hand, and a Trump with no further election to fight is obviously not a more cautious one.

Israel's election has produced a setback for Benjamin Netanyahu without producing an alternative. Gadi Eisenkot holds the mandate after 67 members recommended him against 46 for Netanyahu. But 19 of Eisenkot's 67 come from Arab-led parties most of his prospective partners refuse to govern with. He proposes a "national emergency government" that may begin as a minority administration, dependent on Arab votes. Netanyahu remains caretaker for as long as the arithmetic stays stuck. Eisenkot's programme is as security-minded as any, and he and Netanyahu both reject a Palestinian state. The question is whether a new government would accept the restraints a US agreement with Tehran would require. A PM who owes his office to Arab support that divides his own camp, and whose American subsidy has been called expendable, will be under pressure to show he is no less firm than the man he replaced.

Tehran may draw the most dangerous conclusion from all this: That time is on its side. Mohsen Rezaei has declared that neither the Strait of Hormuz nor talks will open until the US meets Iran's conditions. A nuclear proposal has gone to Washington, to be discussed only after those conditions are met. On November 8, Foreign Minister Abbas Araghchi said mediators had not travelled since the midterm "shock", and that Tehran would wait to see how long Washington took to digest the result. If Tehran reads Trump's defeat as proof that holding out will secure better terms, it will be repeating the misjudgement that has prolonged this war. Over the weekend, Iran reported tankers hitting mines in Hormuz, while US Central Command said it had disabled a vessel trying to breach its blockade. The risk of escalation has not receded.

Here is the trap the elections have set. The danger is that each side reads the other as weaker and finds another reason to wait. Washington thinks the blockade is biting. Tehran thinks the midterms have done its negotiating for it. Netanyahu's camp thinks a stalled coalition keeps it in office. An agreement requires someone to concede first, which has become politically more expensive for everyone, even as the pressure on Washington to settle has grown.

Any workable first step will have to be simultaneous and verifiable: A halt to attacks on shipping and on Iranian territory, traded for limited and reversible sanctions relief, with nuclear talks timetabled rather than preconditioned. Above all, Washington will have to say what it can and cannot restrain Israel from doing.

India cannot stand apart from this war; its casualties and its shipping have made sure of that. Tehran has exempted Indian vessels from its transit restrictions, which means New Delhi is now sailing on a permit issued by one belligerent while buying substantial volumes of LNG from the other. That hedging cannot protect India from escalation, or from a Hormuz open to Tehran's friends and closed to everyone else. India has a direct interest in a Strait open to all, and the standing in both capitals to say so. The elections have made that case easier to make. They have not made anyone in Washington, Tel Aviv or Tehran more inclined to listen unless somebody insists.

The writer is professor, Centre for West Asian Studies, Jamia Millia Islamia, New Delhi

Nvidia episode is a reminder: Technology is a battleground



SIGNAL TO NOISE

BY RAJEEV CHANDRASEKHAR

LAST SUNDAY, Nvidia chief Jensen Huang dropped a bombshell. In an email to staff, he admitted to an affair with Alice Huang, an executive of Megaspeed, a Singapore-based data-centre company US officials suspect of helping route restricted chips to China. "There is no excuse for what I did," he wrote. *The New York Times* reported that the US government identified her as working for China's Ministry of State Security, recruited to push for Nvidia's chips to reach China.

AI is a permanent shift, not a market theme. Last week, the markets showed how much rides on it: One US election wiped $2.5 to $3 trillion off AI stocks in a day, owing to fears of tighter rules for data centres. Investors were reacting to something governments grasped earlier. AI has become the geopolitical battleground of the decade, and the contest is over compute. *The New York Times* found that some Chinese firms Washington cleared to handle H200s had offices that appeared unused. Every route to this technology, whether a shipment, a model, an engineer or an executive, is now a target.

What Jensen Huang has confirmed is the relationship. It is not an aberration: If US officials are right, it is just the newest instance of a strategy decades old.

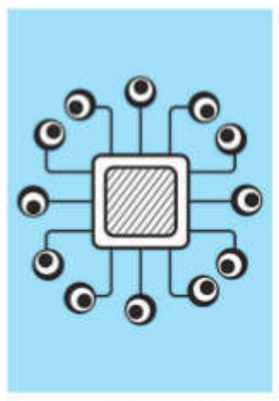


ILLUSTRATION: VIKAS AGARWAL

After this story broke, I posted, "Why invest in R&D when you can get that tech through a honey trap?" Behind the intended sarcasm was a real question. For three decades, Western democracies assumed openness would be reciprocated. They opened their markets, universities, laboratories, and talent networks, expecting China to converge towards their rules. In turn, China opened only selectively, but relentlessly harvested the West's openness.

In 2003, Cisco sued Huawei, alleging the latter's router software contained its source code, down to identical bugs. Huawei conceded in court papers that some of its code came from an outside, unauthorised source. A court-appointed expert concluded in 2004 that Cisco code had been electronically copied into the Huawei product. The case was settled on confidential terms, the code removed and there was no formal admission of liability on public record. But the record speaks for itself.

Nortel was another warning. Investigators found that hackers using seven stolen executive passwords, the CEO's included, roamed its network from at least 2000, with data flowing to Shanghai. Nortel went bankrupt in 2009 as Huawei rose. Investigators blamed the Chinese government, not Huawei; Beijing and Huawei denied involvement.

Several are allegations, which Beijing denies, but the pattern across decades and methods is the point. A senior US intelligence official told *The Times* of London that rivals, especially China, practise "social espionage", using people posing as investors, researchers and romantic partners. In the AI era, the open door is an API key, a LinkedIn request, a dinner invitation.

The strategy is not confined to software and chips. China, Pakistan and North Korea each built their most dangerous capabilities partly by obtaining, by whatever route, what the rules would deny them.

Pakistan's bomb began with a theft: In 1975, A Q Khan left the Netherlands, where he had worked for a contractor to the enrichment consortium URENCO, carrying stolen centrifuge designs. According to arms-control analyses, China gave Pakistan a nuclear weapon design and training. Khan then ran a network of front companies selling centrifuges and know-how to Iran, Libya and North Korea. China's own record is in Washington's files: The 1999 Cox Committee concluded that China obtained classified information on the US W88 warhead through espionage, a finding Beijing rejected. For us in India, this is not academic; it has created real threats, since two of the three are our neighbours.

In 2018, I argued that the future of technology must be shaped, and controlled, by coalitions of trusted partners: Nations that share values, respect rule of law, protect intellectual property and believe in innovation rather than appropriation. That architecture is only now being built. Belatedly. Pax Silica, launched in December 2025, brings trusted countries together to secure the chip, AI, and the critical-minerals supply chain. India signed the declaration in February, alongside Japan, South Korea, the UK, Singapore and others.

But is this enough, since we know that the alleged channel in the Huang case ran through a company in Singapore, itself a member? Trust must be verified, not declared. A Trust Coalition also needs shared counterintelligence. Brief executives, researchers and officials on approach tactics, flag procurement fronts, share findings. There needs to be transparency on who owns compute, with beneficial ownership of data-centre operators, resellers and chip buyers visible to every member's regulators.

The principle of reciprocity is also important. Openness for those who reciprocate, scrutiny for those who do not. Lastly, there must be penalties that deter, not fines absorbed as a cost of doing business.

None of this argues for closing the door. Open societies are strong because they are open: They attract the best talent and ideas and win by out-innovating. I'm not arguing that all of China's technology is stolen. But its tech credibility, built on exploiting others' trust, is also a violation. The answer is to open the door to partners we can verify.

The Huang story will be treated as a scandal, and scandals are noise. The signal is the pattern behind it, and a world that must now decide whether to protect what it is building.

Technology can be stolen. It must not be. Its credibility has to be earned, and only trusted partners can earn it together.

The writer, former Member of Parliament and minister of state for Electronics & Information Technology, Skills and Entrepreneurship, Government of India, is BJP Keralam state president and MLA for Nemom. He began his career as a chip designer. Views are personal

When 'wellness' runs ahead of science



RINKU GHOSH

THERE IS something uncomfortable about the way health and wellness are interchangeably sold to consumers: The more complicated the science sounds, the easier it can become to pretend-decode it — to help sell the promise of staying alive. This is the axis around which the latest row between entrepreneur Deepinder Goyal and public health expert and hepatologist Cyriac Abby Philips — The Liver Doc — has been raging.

Goyal draws on his success with the food-delivery app Zomato to claim legitimacy as the founder of a brain-health tracking tool. His wearable, Temple, sticks to the forehead and is designed to track blood-flow patterns in the brain. Goyal believes these signals can reveal how cerebral circulation changes with activity, posture and other physiological conditions, and hopes the data can map brain function and damage. Pre-orders are open at Rs 85,000, and the device has celebrity endorsers, including cricketer Shubman Gill. Philips, supported by other doctors, argues that Temple's central scientific claims have not been established in peer-reviewed studies.

This exposes how India's booming wellness economy, which lies outside the purview of the regulated medical market, is turning health anxiety into a business, selling promises before science has established what these products can deliver. Although the debate is framed as a clash between an ambitious entrepreneur out to boost R&D and a sceptical medical establishment, the real issue is that corporations, no matter how dependable, must be held accountable to the standards of science when they enter healthcare.

The controversy illustrates our faith in predictive technologies that supposedly insure us against future health crises. Sleep scores, biological-age estimates, gut-health tests, supplements, glucose monitors and brain wearables are marketed as ways to understand and optimise the body. Yet the human body is complex, and even a basic assessment may be incomplete without scientifically validated diagnostic tests. The brain's blood vessels can regulate circulation in response to posture, exercise and blood pressure. A change in a blood-flow signal does not mean brain cells are being damaged or are ageing. Such conclusions require independent validation.

No predictive tool can warn us about a brain stroke or heart attack, dependent on other factors like hypertension, diabetes, smoking, high cholesterol, stress and obesity. A consumer who registers a brain-health score may develop false confidence; an abnormal one could cause unnecessary anxiety. Neither is a substitute for a doctor.

Tracker users can become so fixated on counts that they develop health anxiety rather than awareness. Meanwhile, they may neglect preventive-health basics: Checking blood pressure, controlling diabetes, exercising, eating well, avoiding tobacco and consulting a doctor.

India has a crowded health marketplace in which modern medicine, traditional systems, supplements, and unverified social media remedies compete for public trust. It does not need pseudoscience or half-baked technology marketed as indispensable.

Sure, India needs private investment in medical research. But companies must move beyond building products that generate consumer excitement and invest in technologies that solve health problems. They can fund independent, multi-centre clinical trials, collaborate with medical colleges and government hospitals, publish transparent research and let independent scientists test their claims. Corporate ambition should be directed towards making healthcare more accessible and reducing the burden on an already stretched system.

The writer is senior associate editor, The Indian Express. *rinku.ghosh@expressindia.com*

LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

Lasting progress

A FALL in pollution is good news only if it lasts ('Needed: A sustained decline in emissions', *IE*, November 12). Reductions in fossil-fuel use are being cancelled out by forests being burnt and cleared. Rising fossil-fuel emissions need attention, but so do peat fires and cut forests. The lesson is to count everything together across sectors. Power companies need money to store and carry solar power. Villages paid to protect their trees could be India's cheapest climate investment today.

Babu Crishna, Bengaluru

CLIMATE POLICY must distinguish between temporary fluctuations and lasting progress ('Needed: A sustained decline in emissions', *IE*, November 12). A fall in emissions caused by economic slowdown cannot substitute for cleaner production and responsible consumption. India needs reliable data, stronger monitoring and a credible transition plan that protects workers and energy access. Renewable power, efficient public transport and cleaner industrial processes deserve consistent investment. Climate action will succeed only when environmental responsibility and livelihoods advance together for future generations.

A Myilsami, Coimbatore

Boost competitiveness

RESILIENT GROWTH is welcome, but headline figures matter little if businesses face high input costs and workers see limited gains ('Growth momentum has held up. Now lower costs, raise productivity, innovate, *IE*, November 12). Productivity must come from better skills, technology, reliable infrastructure and predictable regulation, not merely cost-cutting. Policymakers should strengthen manufacturing competitiveness while preserving demand and employment. Lower inflation and easier credit can help, but durable expansion requires innovation, investment and broader participation across regions.

S M Jeeva, Chennai

Mahadev app scam 'kingpin' Chandrakar sent to seven-day judicial custody

Jayprakash S Naidu
Raipur, November 12



Saurabh Chandrakar

A SPECIAL CBI court on Thursday remanded Saurabh Chandrakar, the alleged kingpin of Mahadev betting app case, to seven days of judicial custody in connection with the alleged Mahadev betting app scam.

He will remain in judicial custody till November 19.

Chandrakar's lawyer Tushar Giri said the court had dismissed the Enforcement Directorate's (ED) application seeking execution of a non-bailable warrant against his client.

ED counsel Saurabh Kumar Pandey said the agency would approach the special Prevention of Money Laundering Act (PMLA) court.

On November 4, while seeking Chandrakar's custody, the CBI told the court that it needed to identify the public servants who took "protection money" from him and others to allow the operation of the app.

The agency told the special CBI court in Raipur that hawala route was used by Chandrakar and the other accused to pay "protection money" to government officials, including police, and politicians in Chhattisgarh.

While seeking his 10-day remand, the CBI counsel alleged that Chandrakar along with co-accused Ravi Uppal, Shubham Soni and others have been making Rs 450 crore per month through the app since 2020. While around 80% of the money is kept by them, the remaining is given to the panel operators, the counsel added.

The panel operators were provided several bank accounts fraudulently opened by using genuine documents, the counsel said. These bank accounts were used to collect betting app money and send it across to the promoters, including Chandrakar, who was based in the UAE, according to the allegations.

NEW ESTIMATES AWAIT SURVEILLANCE DATA

India's TB incidence missing from 2026 report of WHO

Anonna Dutt
New Delhi, November 12

WHILE INDIA continues to account for nearly a quarter of the global TB cases, the country's estimated incidence is missing from this year's Global TB report. "Estimates of TB incidence and associated indicators are under review, pending finalisation and use of data from district-level sentinel surveillance. Estimates are expected to be updated in early 2027," the dataset says.

Significantly, India has not released its own TB report, which used to be released annually in March on the occasion of World TB Day. This report usually provides granular state-level data on various indicators.

New data available from a district TB surveillance conducted in 2025 is currently being analysed to come up with new country-level estimates.

"A population level TB disease prevalence was conducted in 2025 in 50 representative districts. But there is a process to finalise the data. We need to look at the trends and see whether the data is comparable to the previous round of national TB prevalence survey in 2020-21... Once any required adjustments are made, the estimates will be released," explained Dr Katherine Floyd, Unit Head, Monitoring, evaluation and strategic information, Department for HIV, TB, Hepatitis and STIs at World Health Organisation.

This number is important considering that the gap between the estimated incidence and the actual number of cases reported by a country is considered to be the number of undiagnosed and untreated cases who may continue to spread the infection.

India has conducted two national TB surveillance surveys, one between 1955-58 and one between 2020-21, which have served as the basis for the estimated incidence for India.

"Instead of a national surveillance, the government conducted a district level surveillance last year, where the prevalence was recorded in 50 randomly selected, representative districts. This surveillance can be repeated from time to time to provide a basis for revised estimates," said an expert in the field on condition of anonymity.

"While a national surveillance is a superior way to calculate the estimates, it cannot be repeated very often as it is very resource intensive. Even a country like China has done it only three times. A district level surveillance can be repeated more frequently," the source added.

They said that the new methodology is likely to bring down India's incidence, some of which can be attributed to the programme actually working. While the estimated incidence was missing in the current report, it did provide details on the number of TB cases actually diagnosed.

There were 25.3 lakh people diagnosed with TB under the national programme, with 2.63 lakh deaths reported due to the infection in 2025. To compare, 26.18 lakh cases and just over 3 lakh deaths had been reported in 2024.

With the reduction in the number of deaths, India has brought down the mortality by 38% as compared to 2025, achieving an important "End TB" milestone albeit five years late. One of the WHO targets was to reduce mortality by 35% as compared to the baseline of 2015 by 2020. By 2025, it should have been reduced by 75%.

"India has achieved a significant milestone in its fight against tuberculosis (TB), recording a 38% reduction in TB mortality since 2015, compared to a global decline of 35%. The progress reflects the impact of intensified interventions under the National TB Elimination Programme (NTEP), including proactive case finding including use of AI enabled X-rays, rapid diagnostics, prompt treatment initiation, differentiated TB care, and nutritional support through the Ni-kshay Poshan Yojana and Ni-kshay Mitra initiative.... India's commitment is further reflected in 96% of TB programme funding requirements being met through domestic resources," the expert added.

While the numbers globally are moving in the right direction, they remain far from the 2030 goal of eliminating the infection. Globally in 2025, an estimated 10.6 million people and 1.13 million people died from tuberculosis.

• BRIEFLY



Congress General Secretary Priyanka Gandhi Vadra during a visit to the Priyadarshini Tea Factory in Wayanad. PTI

KERALAM

In Wayanad, Priyanka regrets delay in modernising Priyadarshini tea unit

CONGRESS MP Priyanka Gandhi Vadra on Thursday expressed dissatisfaction over the delay in modernising the Priyadarshini tea factory, despite Rs 2.07 crore in CSR funds being made available for the purpose in March this year. She conveyed her displeasure at a review meeting held at the Tea Estate, attended by Collector Chelsea Sini and Sub-Collector Atul Sagar, who is the Managing Director of Priyadarshini Society, a party statement said. Vadra said it was regrettable that no progress had been made on the project even eight months after the funds were made available. Following Vadra's expression of dissatisfaction over the delay, Sagar informed the meeting that the re-tender for purchase of new machinery would be opened on November 19. He assured her that machines would be installed and the factory made fully operational by next March. PTI

Beed knife attack leaves five injured; three are arrested

THREE PERSONS were arrested for their alleged involvement in a knife attack in Maharashtra's Beed district that left five seriously injured, following a dispute over a firecracker-throwing incident, a police official said on Thursday. "Akshay Raut allegedly threw a firecracker at Sunil Khadke's daughter. Khadke's son Sarthak and four others confronted Raut, who attacked them with sharp weapons. The victims received deep wounds on the abdomen, chest and back. Akshay Raut, Rahul Shelar and Meera Raut have been arrested, two other accused are absconding, he said. PTI

Car mows down 3 fixing a puncture on Alwar highway

THREE PEOPLE, including a NHAI employee, who had stopped on Delhi-Mumbai Expressway to fix a puncture in a cab, were killed after a speeding car hit them from behind in Rajasthan's Alwar district on Thursday, police said. The accident occurred on Thursday morning near Gurjar Khora culvert that comes under Laxmangarh police station area. All three died in the accident, the police said. The speeding car overturned on the roadside a short distance away, but its driver fled the spot. Police said a woman travelling along with the deceased was missing from the accident site. PTI

CAT 2026 candidates will undergo AI-based facial recognition check

Gayathri Mani
New Delhi, November 12

CANDIDATES APPEARING for the upcoming Common Admission Test (CAT) 2026 will undergo an AI-based facial recognition check as part of their identity verification.

IIM Indore is set to introduce the service across all their examination centres, its director Himanshu Rai said. "It is being introduced for the first time for CAT. The procedure will be implemented across all examination centres," he said.

However, there will also be physical verification of candidates' admit cards like earlier. "So, students need not worry about denial of entry into the centres due to any glitches or the AI system failing to recognise the candidate's face," Rai added.

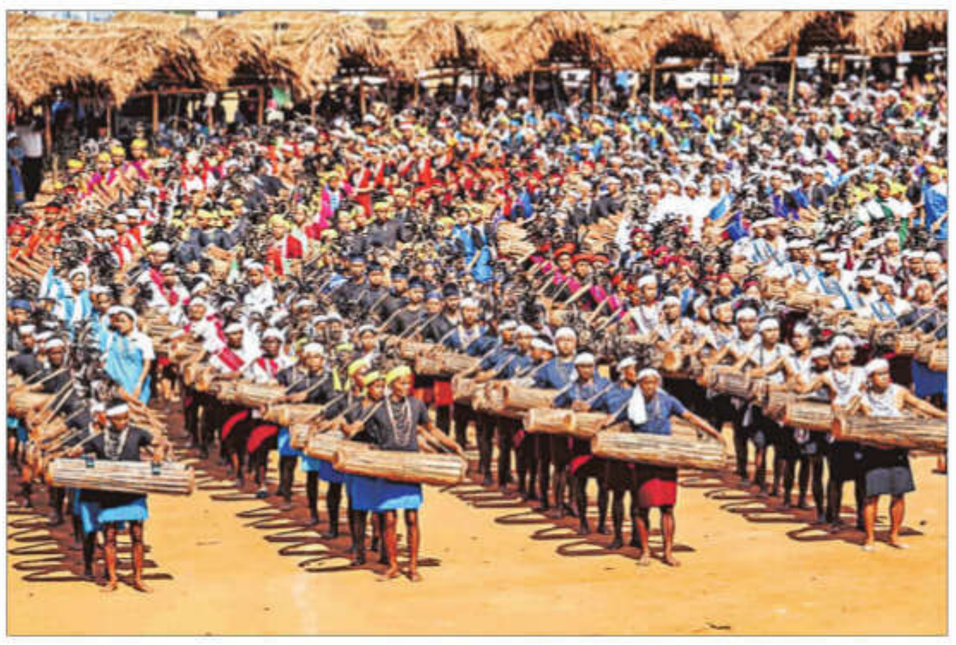
This year, IIM Indore is testing the technology to check how accurate it is and whether any modifications are necessary to improve it, the director said. He also clarified that no database of students will be stored.

"The facial recognition mechanism will be used solely to match the candidate present at the examination centre with the photograph submitted at the time of application," Rai said. "Decisions concerning the conduct, processes and technological interventions for CAT are taken by the CAT Committee...So, it is not an independent decision of a particular institution," he added.

The move is in line with IIM Indore's embracing of AI across all its domains, especially learning.

"At IIM Indore, we are progressively integrating AI into our academic framework to ensure that students are equipped to understand and adapt to the rapidly evolving technological landscape. AI has become an integral part of most courses across our programmes," Rai highlighted.

IIM Indore is conducting CAT 2026 on November 29. About 2.89 lakh candidates have registered for the exam this year.



Wangala festival

Garo tribe artistes perform the traditional Wangala dance during the Golden Jubilee edition of 1,000 Drums Wangala Festival in West Garo Hills district of Meghalaya on Thursday. PTI

Keralam NRI body chief held for forging ED letter to 'extort' popular credit society

Shaju Philip
Thiruvananthapuram, November 12

THE CHAIRPERSON of the Kerala Pravasi Association (KPA) has been arrested on charges of forging an ED letter with "the intention of fraudulently obtaining information from a prominent credit society and extorting money," police said.

KPA is an NRI-led political movement, which joined hands with the state's ruling Congress-led United Democratic Front (UDF) before the 2024 Lok Sabha elections.

Ernakulam rural police arrested Rajendran Vellapalath, a Middle-East based businessman, on Thursday. He was later sent to judicial custody.

Rajendran is also the founder of Indiafirst, a hyper local news and OTT streaming platform, based in Kozhikode.

Rajendran was booked under several Sections of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita (BNS).

Police sources said more persons could be involved in the alleged extortion racket. "We are also probing whether the arrested person has extorted money from other companies with forged ED notices. We have taken the statement of the ED officials, who said they have not issued such a notice," said an official.

The complainant in the case is Thrissur-based Indian Cooperative Credit Society Limited (ICCSL).

Police said the ICCSL general manager received a letter on October 13, purportedly sent by a senior Enforcement Directorate (ED) officer, asking the society to furnish information under the provisions of the Prevention of Money Laundering Act (PMLA).

The letter claimed that the ED had received a complaint related to money laundering and had initiated a preliminary probe. The letter sought several details including "suspicious transaction report shared with RBI, deposits and loans."

Days later, Rajendran allegedly met ICCSL chairperson Sojan V Avirachan with the offer to "settle the ED probe". Police said, "Rajendran wanted the ICCSL to make a huge investment in his company and claimed that he had settled several such ED cases with prominent companies."

"He also made me listen to certain audio clips in this regard... We had contacted the ED office in Delhi and they were ignorant about such a notice. Subsequently, we filed a complaint with the state police chief," Sojan told *The Indian Express*.

Four held for murder of history-sheeter in Jaipur over seven-year-old enmity

Express News Service
Jaipur, November 12



Accused Anish Golya, Kamlesh, Dinesh Nitharwal and Yuvraj Chaudhary in Jaipur on Thursday. ANI

FOUR MEN were arrested on Thursday for allegedly hacking a history-sheeter to death in Jaipur's Jagdamba Nagar area on Wednesday. Police said the murder was motivated by a seven-year-old enmity, with the deceased, Vijay Bajiya, allegedly involved in the killing of the father of one of the accused.

The accused have been identified as Anish Golya (21), Kamlesh Golya (23), Dinesh Chaudhary (23) and Yuvraj Chaudhary (23), of Tibaria village under Jobner police station in Jaipur Rural.

Police said the four had formed a gang and named it '7007' to avenge the murder of Anish's father, Kailash Golya, around seven years back.

DCP (Jaipur West) Prashant Kiran said police received information on November 11 that some unidentified men had attacked a person with axes near Ravana Gate in Jagdamba Nagar before fleeing. The injured man was taken to Defence Hospital in Kardhani, where he was declared dead. According to a probe, Vijay and Anish had an argument on the day of the incident, following which Anish allegedly planned the attack with three associates.

Man dies as rasgulla explodes in mouth, neighbour held for hiding bomb inside

Anand Mohan J
Bhopal, November 12

The incident took place in Dindori district in Madhya Pradesh, where the accused allegedly handed Rajendra (35) an explosive disguised as a sweet; police say such bombs are used to kill wild boars

EARLIER THIS week, Rajendra Barautiya, a 35-year-old man, was sitting around a bonfire with his family in the courtyard of his house in Madhya Pradesh's Dindori district when a fellow villager came over and handed him a rasgulla.

Moments later, the sweet exploded inside Rajendra's mouth, causing grievous injuries. He died at a hospital hours later.

Police said the accused had allegedly concealed a crude explosive device, used to kill wild boars, inside the rasgulla.

Police have arrested the main accused, a fellow villager, who allegedly handed him the explosive disguised as a sweet.

The incident took place around 8 pm on Tuesday in Padariya Chhanta village that comes under the jurisdiction of Dindori Kotwali police station.

Police said Rajendra was sitting with his family after dinner when the accused, identified as Ramabhagat Barautiya, arrived and joined him.

According to Dindori Kotwali Inspector Durga Prasad Nagpure, the two men were sitting together and talking when the accused allegedly handed Rajendra the explosive, telling him it was a rasgulla.

"Rajendra and his family were sitting in the courtyard, warming themselves around a fire. At that time, Ramabhagat, who lives in the same neighbourhood, came to his house. Both of them sat together near the fire. During their conversation, Ramabhagat handed Rajendra something to eat, telling him it was a rasgulla. As soon as Rajendra bit into it, it exploded in his mouth. It was a pig-killer bomb," Nagpure said.

The explosion left Rajendra with severe injuries to his mouth and jaw.

His family members immediately rushed him to the Dindori district hospital in an auto-rickshaw. However, he succumbed to his injuries while undergoing treatment.

The police registered a case against the accused under Section 105 of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita (BNS), which deals with culpable homicide not amounting to murder, and Sections 3 and 4 of the Explosive Substances Act.

Police are also investigating how the accused obtained the crude explosive device and the circumstances in which it came into his possession.

Pig-killer bombs, also referred to as pig bombs, are crude explosive devices reportedly used by some people to kill wild boars. Such devices can cause severe injuries or death when they detonate on contact or are triggered by pressure.

The police investigation is now expected to focus on the accused's alleged motive, the source of the explosive, and whether anyone else was involved in procuring or supplying it.

• TWO MUSLIM BROTHERS PERFORM LAST RITES OF A HINDU WOMAN; MOSQUE OPENS ITS DOORS TO A HINDU FAMILY FOR CEREMONIAL WASHING OF A WOMAN'S BODY

A mother's last rites, a neighbour's promise: 2 Keralam stories

Shaju Philip
Thiruvananthapuram, November 12

TWO MUSLIM brothers performed the last rites of an elderly Hindu woman in Wayanad, while a mosque in neighbouring Malappuram opened its doors for the pre-cremation rituals and prayers of a Hindu woman. Two incidents in Keralam this week have offered yet another glimpse of the state's longstanding tradition of communal harmony, where bonds of neighbourhood and kinship often transcend religious boundaries.

For brothers Kappan Razak and Sulaiman, whose neighbour Kalyaniamma died at the age of 85 on Monday at Chithragiri village in Wayanad's Muppainadu panchayat, it wasn't a matter of debate. Kalyaniamma had no close relatives or family members to perform her last rites, and having lived next door to her for most of their lives, they knew what to do — step into the role of sons and perform the traditional Hindu rites.

According to Razak, Kalyaniamma had relied on the brothers for years, from attending to her daily needs to accompanying her to the hospital. It was therefore natural that they be there when she passed away.

On Tuesday, Razak and Sulaiman lit her funeral pyre at a crematorium.

"We looked after Kalyaniamma like our mother, and it was her wish that we perform her last rites. Although she lived just over a boundary wall, Kalyaniamma has been living as a member of our family for years," Razak says. "From a very young age, we would call her mother. She was living in our house for the last few months."

When 52-year-old Premalatha died after battling cancer at Nannamukku panchayat in Malappuram, her husband Sahadevan and daughter Neethu, realized that the tiny rented house in which they were staying for 18 years had no facility to give a final adieu for their beloved. The house did not have a proper area for the ceremonial washing of the body of the deceased before being taken for cremation.

That's when the Khadeeja Mosque at Pallikkara stepped in, opening its doors to the family and allowing them to use the premises for the ceremonial washing of the body.

Muslim women, too, helped wash and dress the body, says Suhara Mambad, state president of Vanitha League, the women's wing of the Indian Union Muslim League.

"I saw Premalatha as my younger sister. It was our duty to take such an initiative for that family. We have done it on humanitarian grounds," says Suhara, whose husband A V Abdru is the president of the Khadeeja Mosque.

This comes months after prominent Hindu leader Vellappally Natesan drew flak for his comment that Hindus in the Muslim-dominated Malappuram district "cannot breathe freely".

Chief Minister V D Satheesan said the Wayanad incident showed what the state stood for.

"This is the Keralam I know, love, and believe in," he said in a post on X. "Razak and Sulaiman were not born to Kalyani Amma. Yet, for nearly five decades, they loved and cared for her just like their own mother. When the time came to bid her farewell, these two brothers fulfilled the 85-year-old's final wish with the deep love and dignity of her own sons. Here, a mother's love does not check religion. A son's duty does not ask about caste. And grief, like love, belongs to all of us equally."

He further said: "To me, this is what makes Keralam special. A land where love knows no religion, compassion knows no caste, and humanity brings us together. A truly heartwarming sight. We are all one. Let this grand spirit of Keralam inspire the whole of India."

Medicine meets tech: IIT Kharagpur launches PG medical programmes

Gayathri Mani & Sharanyo Basu
New Delhi, Kolkata, Nov 12

SEVENTY-FIVE YEARS after its foundation in 1951, the Indian Institute of Technology Kharagpur is set to become the country's first IIT to introduce postgraduate medical degree programmes accredited by the National Medical Commission.

Beginning with the academic year 2026–27, the institute will admit its inaugural cohort of postgraduate medical students to six Doctor of Medicine (MD) programmes at its integrated medical school and research hub, the Dr B C Roy Multi-Speciality Medical Research Centre, formally renamed the Dr Shyama Prasad Mookerjee Super Speciality Hospital in 2021.

The institute will offer an intake of 12 seats across six specialisations, with two seats allotted each to General Medicine, Radiology, Physiology, Pathology, Community Medicine, and Biochemistry. Admissions will be conducted through the NEET-PG 2026 online counselling process, where eligible candidates will need to apply in Round 2 under the listing for 'Dr B C Roy Multi-Speciality Medical Research Centre, Kharagpur, under the aegis of IIT Kharagpur'.

IIT Kharagpur director Prof Suman Chakraborty said that India's first IIT is taking a historic step toward shaping the future of medical education. "Our vision is not simply to train specialist doctors, but to create an ecosystem where clinical excellence meets engineering ingenuity, artificial intelligence and translational research. We want our medical graduates to be not only outstanding clinicians, but also innovators capable of addressing some of humanity's most pressing healthcare challenges", he said.

What's on offer?

- **Dr. B. C. Roy** Multi-Speciality Medical Research Centre, Kharagpur, IIT Kharagpur
- **Programmes:** MD General Medicine, MD Radiology, MD Physiology, MD Pathology, MD Community Medicine and MD Biochemistry
- **Total intake: 12 SEATS**, with two seats per discipline
- Academic session: **2026–27**
- Admission route: **NEET-PG 2026** online counselling

"The future of medicine will increasingly belong to those who can connect deep clinical understanding with scientific discovery and technological innovation", he added.

The initiative marks a major expansion of the IIT system into postgraduate medical education by treating medicine, engineering, AI, biomedical sciences, and translational research as an integrated discipline. Aligned with the objectives of Viksit Bharat 2047, the programme aims to deliver affordable, accessible, technology-enabled, high-quality healthcare, IIT Kharagpur said in a statement. The move marks an expansion of the IIT system into postgraduate medical education, bringing medical training within an interdisciplinary research environment that combines medicine, engineering, artificial intelligence and biomedical sciences, it said.

The institute said the programmes aim to develop an ecosystem where clinical education can be integrated with technological research and innovation.

"Students will have opportunities to engage in research areas such as AI-assisted clinical decision-making, medical imaging, computational pathology, biomedical devices, molecular diagnostics and precision medicine," IIT Kharagpur said.

"These are not merely 12 postgraduate seats. They represent 12 opportunities to become founding members of a new academic tradition within India's premier technological education system," it said.

This initiative seeks to leverage the medical research centre's expertise in bioengineering, AI, and medical technologies to nurture the next generation of physician-scientists and medical specialists, with added stress on research-driven learning and international academic exposure, the institute added.

Sharanyo Basu is an intern with The Indian Express.

Mumbai: 20-year-old woman loses arm after being pushed off train during scuffle; man held

Apoorva Agashe
Mumbai, November 12

A DISPUTE aboard a moving local train over a woman travelling in a coach reserved for persons with disabilities ended with her allegedly being molested and pushed off the train, leaving her with a severed right arm and a head injury. The 20-year-old woman's wedding, which was due next month, has been postponed indefinitely.

The incident took place on November 4 and Bhayander Government Railway Police (GRP) have arrested a 53-year-old man in connection with the same. The woman has alleged that the man touched her inappropriately and continued to molest her despite her objections, triggering an argument that escalated into a scuffle.

According to police, the woman boarded a train at Malad and was travelling towards Naigaon when she entered the coach reserved for persons with disabilities. The accused objected to her presence in the coach, leading to an argument. The two allegedly threw shoes at each other before the man pushed her off the moving train at Naigaon. She fell on the tracks and lost her right arm.

She told *The Indian Express*, "I boarded a train from Malad and was heading towards Naigoan when one uncle touched me inappropriately to which I objected. He continued to molest me and we had a verbal altercation, during which we threw shoes at each other. The uncle then pushed me off the train... I lost my arm and have a head injury."

The woman, who works as a supervisor at a private firm, said she was her family's sole earning member. "I have been left with one arm and 16 stitches on my head... it's most likely that I'll lose the means to earn. I want strict action against the accused," she said.

Her 22-year-old fiance said they decided to postpone their wedding, scheduled for December, indefinitely.

The accused has been identified as Jitendra Hirmukhe. Police said he was travelling in the coach as he was battling cancer. The FIR was registered on November 6 following the recording of the woman's statement.

Police said Hirmukhe fled after the incident. After examining CCTV footage, investigators traced him and was arrested on November 8.

He has been booked under provisions of the BNS.

Kuki-Zo woman killed, two injured in firing in Manipur village

Express News Service
Imphal, November 12

A 40-YEAR-OLD Kuki-Zo woman was killed and two others were injured in a firing incident at Taphou Kuki village in Manipur's Senapati district on Thursday morning.

The police said the incident occurred around 11 am and identified the victim as Kimneineng Chongloi, 40, a resident of Taphou Kuki village. The injured, Sehngam Chongloi alias David and Lamkhochon Chongloi, both residents of the village, sustained bullet injuries and are undergoing treatment at Kangpokpi District Hospital.

The firing reportedly took place while villagers were harvesting paddy. The gunfire sound triggered panic, forcing farmers to abandon their work and flee. Taphou Kuki village falls under the jurisdiction of Senapati police station.

Amid escalating tensions, village residents reportedly cautioned travellers against using the affected stretch of NH-2.

The incident comes days after the disappearance and killing of two Kuki youths from the same village. Paoginlal Hangsing, 20, and Tinginlun Chongloi, 20, who went missing on October 28, were found dead on November 1 during search operations. Their bodies were recovered from an area east of National Highway-2 along SP Road. The recovery of the bodies had triggered protests in Kangpokpi.

Manipur Chief Minister Yumnam Khemchand Singh had visited Taphou Kuki village a few days before Thursday's shooting amid the prevailing tensions. The circumstances surrounding the firing— source of gunfire and those responsible were not known immediately.



Elephant dies of electrocution

Forest officials and locals gather around the carcass of an elephant that died of electrocution after it came into contact with a live electric wire of 11,000 volts, in Khunti district, Jharkhand on Thursday. PTI

Burglars drill through wall, decamp with jewellery worth Rs 12 crore in MP

Bhopal: Around Rs 12 crore worth of gold and diamond jewellery was stolen from a jewellery showroom in Katni, Madhya Pradesh.

The thieves broke through a nine-inch-thick rear wall of the Kisna Jewellers showroom in Bargawan area in the early hours of Thursday. The employees arrived to open the showroom on Thursday morning and found the interiors ransacked, display counters emptied and safes broken open.

The burglars drilled a hole in the wall and used it to gain access to the premises. Investigators suspect that the operation involved prior planning, police said. Katni SP Vishwakarma said preliminary investigations suggested the burglary took place between 4 am and 7 am on November 12. ENS

20kg gold stolen from Madurai store, police say lift shaft gave access

Arun Janardhanan
Chennai, November 12

AROUND 20 kg of gold jewellery was stolen from a newly opened Tanishq showroom in Madurai, with police suspecting that a masked man entered the premises through a lift passage while construction work was under way. All the stolen items were from the display section while jewellery inside the lockers was untouched, police said.

Employees discovered the burglary when they arrived for work Thursday morning at the outlet on Bypass Road. The exact quantity and value of the missing jewellery were yet to be confirmed as staff checked the stock. "Preliminary evidence pointed to a man entering through the upper part of the building," an officer, who was part of the probe, said, adding an opening near the lift appeared to have provided access. Police have formed five teams to investigate the incident.

Civil and maintenance work, including wiring, was being carried out at the rear of the building, where scaffolding remained in place. Investigators suspect the thief used it to reach an upper level before descending through the lift shaft into the showroom. They were examining whether anyone helped him.

Parts of the showroom building were still under construction. Police are investigating how the intruder gained access despite security staff being stationed outside. Much of the jewellery, though, remained in the showroom. Police were examining CCTV footage of a person wearing a face covering and gloves and carrying a black bag and a trolley bag in the area.

They were studying the person's characteristics and collecting footage from nearby areas to trace the route taken.

Forensic experts and sniffer dogs were brought to the showroom. Employees and those involved in the construction work, including engineers, electricians and plumbers, were being questioned separately. Initial accounts differed on number of suspects and entry route. One described three people breaking a rear wall and doors, others reported no such damage.

Property of Pak-based terror handler attached in J&K's Rajouri

Jammu: JAMMU AND Kashmir Police on Thursday attached immovable property worth Rs 81 lakh belonging to a Pakistan-based terror handler in Rajouri district, an official said.

Mohd Arshad, of Khablan village, was a local terrorist who had illegally crossed the Line of Control into Pakistan-occupied Kashmir 15 years ago, the official said adding that Arshad's 2.14 kanal village land, with a market value of Rs 81 lakh, was attached under sections of the Egress and Internal Movement (Control) Ordinance in connection with a case registered at the local police station in 2011. PTI

After month in detention, Siang activist says stir will go on

Premankur Biswas & Shinjini Ghosh
Yingkiong, New Delhi, Nov 12

AFTER NEARLY a month in detention, activist Adum Tayong has said protests against the proposed Siang Upper Multipurpose Project (SUMP) will continue, reiterating that the project is an existential threat to those living in the Siang Valley. This, even as authorities in the district said detentions were necessary to maintain law and order in the region.

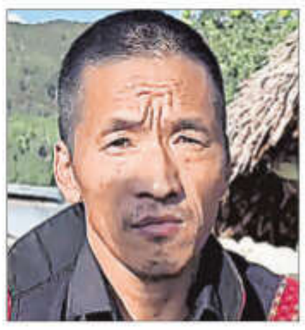
Tayong was among four activists detained under the Arunachal Pradesh Unlawful Activities (Prevention) Act (APUAPA) and released on November 7.

The four, including Omak Paron, Okut Paloh and Oson Paron, were detained on October 9.

Speaking to *The Indian Express*, Tayong claimed, "Initially we had no information, and it was only after detention that we were told that APUAPA had been invoked. For nearly a month, we were lodged in the same prison cells as murder convicts. Our phones were seized, and we had little information about what was going on. We were allowed to speak to our families only once in 15 days."

"We will continue with the protests," he said.

Protests have erupted across several districts in the state, with a section of residents along the Siang River opposing the proposed 11,200-MW SUMP. While the state government maintains that it has invited different stakeholders for dialogue, organisations like the Siang Indigenous Farmers' Forum (SIFF) have sought the release of all activists before talks resume.



Siang activist Adum Tayong

Tagori Mize, an advocate based out of Itanagar, said, "The four who were released are from Geku village. There are others from different districts who still have FIRs against them and remain in custody."

Urging the state government to release all activists, Mize, who is also the spokesperson of SIFF, said, "Our stand is clear, and we have listed out our demands to the Arunachal Pradesh government. All FIRs against the protesters and activists should be withdrawn without conditions. The government should also withdraw all paramilitary and armed forces deployed in the state."

Ashok Tajo, the Deputy Commissioner of Upper Siang, said APUAPA had to be invoked to maintain law and order in the area.

"APUAPA is basically preventive detention, and for the last few weeks, there were several incidents of houses being attacked and vehicles being torched. Despite repeated requests, a few people from the area had been mobilising people. The environment was quite tense, and in order to contain that, we had to pick up a few people."

"While they were detained initially, now they are free. The effect of detentions can be seen. Such incidents (of arson) have not been reported in the last few days. People have realised that there is a rule of law. As a district magistrate, it is my duty to maintain law and order and ensure it is peaceful, and I have done my part."

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Engagement of Retired PSU/Government Group 'A' Employees as Consultant in MTNL – For Delhi Unit

MTNL invites application on a short-term contract basis from retired PSU/Autonomous Body/Government/CPSE Group 'A' employees preferably from DDA/L&DO/Noida Authority to be deployed as Consultant in Asset Management Unit, MTNL, Delhi having minimum three years experience in dealing with land planning, engineering and are supposed to resolve issues pertaining to property documents/ Monetisation with various local bodies like DDA, L&DO, MCD, DUSIB, Delhi Govt., DSIIDC, Gram Panchayat, Noida Authority etc. in land matters and perform any other additional related work as deemed fit.

For details including number of posts, eligibility criteria, terms of engagement and application submission, log on to the company's website: **www.mtnldelhi.in / www.mtnl.in.**

Last date for submission of applications is – **27/11/2026 By 5:00 pm**

Applications received after due date will not be considered.

DGM (Admin) HQ, MTNL Delhi unit.

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'Didn't want to leave sick wife behind': Man who left a 'fake hijack note' in flight AI 2772

Sweety Kumari
Kolkata, November 12

A 56-YEAR-OLD man has been arrested for allegedly planting a hoax hijack threat onboard an Air India plane on Wednesday, delaying the Kolkata-Mumbai flight by over seven hours.

Police said the accused, Partha Pratim Nandi, a cancer patient, has confessed to planting the threat note. He told police he did not want to leave his ailing wife behind for a job abroad, and planted the note in the plane's lavatory so the flight would be aborted.

Air India flight AI 2772 was scheduled to take off from Kolkata's Netaji Subhas Chandra Bose International Airport at 10.30 am on Wednesday. But before take-off, a note saying the plane would be hijacked was found in the lavatory, according to airport director Vikram Singh. Following a search and questioning of the 105 passengers on board, the plane took off from Kolkata at 5.38 pm.



Flight AI 2772 was initially taken to isolation bay after the note threatening hijack was found, at Kolkata airport, Wednesday. PTI

Police said preliminary investigation found that Nandi was travelling to Mumbai. He was to take a connecting flight abroad for an overseas job.

But Nandi has told police that at the last moment, he realised he did not want to leave his ailing wife behind and wanted to return home. He then wrote the threat note on a white card and planted it in the lavatory hoping it would be aborted. He told police he was "not in the right state of mind". Police said forensic analysis has confirmed that the handwriting was Nandi's. Police found several white cards similar to the one on which the note was written with him.

The airport authority said in a statement on Thursday, "In connection with yesterday's incident involving Air India flight AI 2772 (Kolkata–Mumbai), one passenger was apprehended and handed over to the NSCBI Airport Police Station." The arrested accused lives in Kolkata's Sodepur area.

On Wednesday, the plane's pilot sent a hijack alert to Air Traffic Control after the threat note was found. The hoax triggered panic and disrupted operations at Kolkata airport.

Blast threat email warns BMC office, Bachchan's house

Mumbai: The Mumbai police stepped up security after a threat email warning of bomb blasts at the BMC office, PNB bank and actor Amitabh Bachchan's bungalow Jalsa.

Efforts had been made to trace the IP address of the user who sent the email: "We suspect the same user sent all the emails," the officer added.

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Empanelment of Special Public Prosecutor for Narcotics Control Bureau before various High Courts

Applications are hereby invited from Advocates for empanelment as Special Public Prosecutor (SPP) in Narcotics Control Bureau for handling NDPS Cases before Hon'ble High Courts of Gujarat at Ahmedabad, Karnataka at Bengaluru, Madhya Pradesh at Jabalpur, Orissa at Cuttack, Punjab & Haryana at Chandigarh, Madras at Chennai, Delhi at New Delhi, Allahabad at Prayagraj, Gauhati at Guwahati, Manipur at Imphal, Jammu, Kashmir & Ladakh at Jammu, Kerala at Ernakulam, Calcutta at Kolkata, Bombay at Mumbai, Patna at Patna, Jharkhand at Ranchi, Himachal Pradesh at Shimla, Goa bench of Bombay High Court, Lucknow bench of Allahabad High Court, Jaipur & Jodhpur benches of Rajasthan High Court and Jalpaiguri bench of Calcutta High Court.

The eligibility criteria and other details are available in the Terms & Conditions posted on the website of Narcotics Control Bureau, https://ncb.mha.gov.in/vacancies (direct link to document: https://tinyurl.com/mr3fw4s8).

The interested advocates may apply in the requisite proforma to the AD (Legal) of NCB over email **dlahq-ncb@nic.in** clearly mentioning 'the court/courts applied for' in their application latest by 21.12.2026.

CBC-19126/11/0108/2627

Dy. Director General (Special Wing)

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SPECIAL WINDOW FOR RE-LODGEMENT OF TRANSFER REQUEST OF PHYSICAL SHARES

Shareholder are hereby informed that SEBI vide its Circular No. SEBI/HO/MIRSD/MIRSD-PoD/P/CIR/2025/97 dated 2nd July, 2025 had opened a special window for a period of 6 months from 7th July, 2025 till 6th January, 2026, to facilitate re-lodgment of transfer deeds, which were originally lodged prior to the deadline of 1st April, 2019 and rejected / returned / not attended, due to deficiency in the documents / process / or otherwise.

In this regard, we hereby inform you that SEBI Vide its Circular no. HO/38/13/11(2)2026-MIRSD-POD/ I/3750/2026 dated 30th January, 2026 has opened another special window for a period of one year from 5th February, 2026 to 4th February, 2027 to facilitate transfer and dematerialization of physical share(s), which were sold/purchased prior to 1st April, 2019 and also to facilitate re-lodgment of transfer deeds as mentioned above.

For clarity with regard to applicability of this window, below matrix may be referred to:

Execution Date of Transfer Deed	Lodged for transfer before April 01, 2019?	Original Security Certificate Available?	Eligible to lodge in the current Window?
Before April 01, 2019	No (it is fresh lodgement)	Yes	✓
	Yes (it was rejected/ returned earlier)	Yes	✓
	Yes	No	✗
	No	No	✗

Further, the following cases will also not be considered under this special window:

- Cases involving disputes between transferor and transferee.
- Securities which have been transferred to Investor Education and Protection Fund (IEPF).

Note: All shares re-lodged during this period will be processed through transfer-cum-demat route, i.e. they will only be issued to dematerialized (demat) form after transfer and the same will be subject to a lock-in of one year.

For any further information/clarification in this regard, concerned shareholders can get in touch with the Company /RTA at any of the addresses given below-

SML Mahindra Limited	M/s MCS Share Transfer Agent Limited
1st Floor, T7 Tech Park C-119, Industrial Area, Phase 7, Sector 73, Mohali, SAS Nagar, Punjab-160055.	179-180, DSIDC Shed, 3rd Floor, Okhla Industrial Area, Phase 1, New Delhi-110020.
Phone: 0172- 2647700-02; 4155901	**Phone:** 011-41406149, 41406150, 41406151
Email: investors@smlmahindra.com	**Email ID:** helpdeskdelhi@mcsregistrars.com
Website: https://smlmahindra.com/in	**Website:** https://www.mcsregistrars.com/

Transfer requests submitted after 4th February, 2027, will not be accepted by the Company/RTA.

Place: Mohali, Punjab
Date: 12.11.2026

For **SML MAHINDRA LIMITED**
PARVESH MADAN
Company Secretary | ACS-31266

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If there are questions of current or contemporary relevance that you would like explained, please write to
explained@indianexpress.com

• CLIMATE

Why India's carbon emissions could rise amid global fall

Pratyush Deep
New Delhi, November 12

GLOBAL CARBON dioxide emissions from fossil fuels are projected to decline marginally in 2026 compared with last year. But India is expected to be the only major emitter set to record an increase.

According to a new study by the Global Carbon Budget, global fossil fuel emissions are projected to fall by 0.4% this year, with China, the US, the European Union and Japan expected to record declines. India's projected rise in fossil fuel emissions, meanwhile, has been pegged at 4.4%.

The projected global decline has been attributed to the expansion of solar and wind power and the energy shock triggered by the West Asia conflict.

Although geopolitical upheavals and economic disruptions — besides the Covid-19 pandemic — have previously led to temporary reductions in fossil fuel use, these were largely one-year aberrations. The study cautions that the projected decline in global emissions this year is also likely to be a short-term consequence rather than a sustained structural shift.

'No drop in road transport emissions'

The study shows India, which accounts for around 8% of global emissions, is projected to record higher emissions growth in 2026 than its average annual increase of 3.5% over the past decade. It attributes part of the increase to a rebound from relatively low emissions growth in 2025, when a wet pre-monsoon period reduced demand for cooling. In contrast, a drier monsoon and higher temperatures in 2026 increased cooling demand, pushing up electricity consumption.



A waste-to-energy plant near Delhi's Okhla landfill. FILE

SUMMER SURGE

- India witnessed an unusual surge in power demand this summer amid persistently high temperatures and deficient rain.
- Weather conditions influenced by the El Niño climate phenomenon added to the pressure.

Notably, India witnessed an unusual surge in power demand this summer amid persistently high temperatures and deficient rainfall, with El Niño-influenced weather conditions adding to the pressure.

This increased reliance on coal-based power generation, which increased by around 13.2% to 846,229.29 million units (MU) between April and November 10, 2026 compared with the corresponding period in 2025. The dependence was also reflected in declining coal stocks.

An analysis of government data shows that while domestic consumption of overall petroleum products declined by 2.24% in January-October 2026, consumption of transport fuels continued to increase. Petrol consumption increased by 6.61% to 37.15 million tonnes from 34.85 million tonnes, while diesel consumption increased by 5.76% to 80.86 million tonnes from 76.46 million tonnes over the same period.

India's industrial emissions

An analysis by the Centre for Research on Energy and Clean Air (CREA) found that India's CO2 emissions in the first half of 2026 increased 3.7% year-on-year because of an increase in emissions from steel, cement and other sectors.

CREA analyst Anubha Aggarwal told *The Indian Express* that the power sector's contributions to CO2 emissions remained flat for two years until June 2026. CO2 emissions from oil and gas fell 7% year-on-year, despite higher demand for diesel and petrol.

"For two years till June 2026, all of the growth in India's electricity demand has been met by clean energy, and that has halted the rise of coal power for the first time in half a century. The challenge now is industry, where coal dominates and electricity makes up a smaller share of energy use than in almost any other G20 economy, so unless steel and other energy-intensive manufacturers begin to electrify, rising output will keep pushing India's total emissions up even as the power sector stabilises," Aggarwal said.

• ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE

As Huang exits Nvidia, a test looms for AI boom

Nvidia's highly advanced chips power AI models. Its investments fuel the sector's circular financing. The fallout of Jensen Huang's resignation could upend it all



SOUMYARENDRA BARIK

JENSEN HUANG, the longtime face of Nvidia, has resigned as Chief Executive of the world's largest artificial intelligence (AI) chipmaker. This came amid reports that he had two extramarital affairs, one of which involved an alleged Chinese spy. The Nvidia board has named Chief Financial Officer Colette Kress as interim CEO as it searches for a long-term replacement.

Even before his resignation, the scandal and his expected ouster had sent shockwaves through global financial markets, wiping hundreds of billions of dollars off the chipmaker's valuation and prompting investors to turn towards rivals such as AMD and Broadcom.

But the implications of the crisis could extend well beyond the fortunes of Nvidia, given the company's central position in the AI industry, where it has emerged as the biggest supplier of computing infrastructure and an important financier of the technology's expansion.

The ouster, and the uncertainty for Nvidia, has come at a particularly delicate moment for the AI industry. Technology firms are committing hundreds of billions of dollars to building data centres and developing increasingly powerful AI models, which run on Nvidia's highly advanced chips. Much of this investment is flowing into the chipmaker. So, any prolonged disruption at the company could have consequences for the pace at which the industry expands.

Huang had two extramarital relationships — including one with Alice Huang, a businesswoman suspected by US intelligence agencies of spying for China. The controversy deepened after *The New York Times* reported that he had also been involved in a relationship with Kimberly Powell, the company's vice-president of healthcare, who reported directly to him.

Stock market's AI dependence

Nvidia shares have witnessed sharp volatility amid the controversy surrounding Huang. On Wednesday, the stock plunged over 8% in after-hours trading following reports that the company's board was considering removing him. At 8:30 pm India time Thursday, after Huang's resignation, Nvidia shares were trading at $162.58 per share, down 6.4% from Wednesday, having recouped some losses after falling as low as $148.80. These swings have unsettled investors already concerned about the sustainability of the AI investment boom.

The reaction reflects how AI has become one of the most consequential investment themes in global equity markets. Nvidia alone accounts for roughly 6% of the S&P 500, making movements in its share price significant for the index. The concentration means that even investors without direct exposure to Nvidia can be affected by its fortunes via index funds and other investments.

Perhaps the bigger concern is not what happens to Nvidia's immediate chip sales, but whether its crisis could affect the financing arrangements driving the AI infrastructure boom. Nvidia has increasingly evolved from a supplier of computing hardware into an investor and financial backer of the companies building infrastructure around its products.

For instance, the company has disclosed approximately $164.5 billion in financial commitments, including an obligation capped at $105 billion relating to an OpenAI data centre in Ohio, alongside more than $50 billion in lease and capacity guarantees.

Such investments have helped accelerate the expansion of data centre capacity. However, they have also raised questions about the extent to which spending across the industry is being supported by financial commitments between companies that are simultaneously suppliers, customers and investors — creating a circular economy.

The leadership change at Nvidia could now complicate this model if Huang's long-term successor decides to scale back investments, reconsider financial guarantees or adopt a more conservative approach towards supporting customers, given how central Huang, and his company, are, and have been, across the AI ecosystem stack.

Market intelligence firm Morningstar said before Huang's resignation: "We've long considered Nvidia and Jensen Huang to be at the center of the AI ecosystem; his departure could lead to less AI dealmaking and financing, greater regulation, and more political backlash around artificial intelligence".

Rival chipmakers eye gains

Not every company stands to lose from Nvidia's troubles.

Shares of AMD, Nvidia's closest rival, opened over 3% higher on Thursday (at press time). Broadcom, another AI chip supplier, was up more than 5%, as investors considered whether the companies could benefit from customers seeking to diversify their AI hardware suppliers.

AMD has been strengthening its position in AI accelerators, while Broadcom is a major supplier of custom chips and networking technology used by large cloud companies. In China, domestic GPU manufacturers Moore Threads, MetaX and Cambricon saw their shares surge nearly 10%, amid expectations that uncertainty surrounding Nvidia could create opportunities for local chipmakers.

However, replacing Nvidia is not straightforward. Its dominance extends beyond GPUs to software, networking and integrated systems, which form the technological backbone of many AI deployments.

Morningstar has maintained its Wide Economic Moat rating for Nvidia, reflecting the difficulty competitors face in challenging its position. It also retained its $310 fair value estimate despite the investigation. The research firm said demand for computing capacity continued to exceed supply and did not expect the controversy to materially affect Nvidia's near-term or medium-term revenue.

Can the AI momentum survive

The distinction between the Nvidia crisis and the underlying strength of AI demand could prove crucial. Nvidia's chips are deeply embedded in the infrastructure used to train and operate advanced AI models, meaning that a change in leadership would not immediately eliminate demand from cloud providers and AI developers.

But the company's role in identifying emerging technologies, cultivating major customers and financing infrastructure has been closely associated with Huang, who had led Nvidia since its founding in 1993. The immediate risk, therefore, may be to investor sentiment and valuations, while the longer-term risk concerns whether the industry can maintain its pace of expansion.

With Nvidia scheduled to report quarterly earnings on November 17, investors will be watching not only its financial performance, but also whether the company's strategy of aggressively supporting the AI ecosystem remains intact.

• THE RISE OF A.I. SPENDING

Worldwide AI spending was forecast to touch $2.7 trillion in 2026, a 49.5% rise over 2025, and climb to $3.6 trillion in 2027, according to a Gartner report from September. This forecast, of course, predates the Huang resignation.

Worldwide AI spending by market ($ billion)

Market	2025	2026	2027
AI services	434.05	576.48	745.66
AI cybersecurity	25.92	51.35	86
AI software	288.17	461.64	656.35
AI agents and assistants	16.48	29.22	65.47
Generative AI models	13.02	28.27	51.62
AI platforms for data science and machine learning	19.41	26.45	35.55
AI application development platforms	6.89	9.54	12.48
AI data	0.83	3.13	6.48
AI infrastructure	981.92	1,484.4	1,977.69

SOURCE: GARTNER



AP

Huang, the longtime face of Nvidia, has been under the lens over two extramarital affairs.



Funding goes round and round

Besides selling chips, Nvidia is a financial backer of companies building infrastructure around its products.

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This has raised questions about how the AI sector is propped up by financial commitments between firms that are suppliers, customers and investors — all at the same time.

• CORPORATE

Dhoot case: How bankruptcy is declared, what happens next

Dheeraj Mishra
New Delhi, November 12

THE NATIONAL Company Law Tribunal (NCLT) on November 5 declared former Videocon Industries promoter and director Venugopal Dhoot bankrupt. The tribunal found Dhoot liable as he was the personal guarantor for loans worth Rs 12,668 crore granted by the State Bank of India (SBI) to his companies. This was a rare move — very few loan default cases in India have reached the stage of bankruptcy.

Once a business titan, Dhoot now stands to lose control of his companies and assets held in his name, unless the order is stayed or set aside by an appellate tribunal or court. Even holding the position of a company director requires one to not be bankrupt.

The bankruptcy process

First, let's understand what the terms insolvency and bankruptcy mean. Insolvency occurs when a person or company is unable to repay debts when they fall due. Bankruptcy is the formal legal process through which an insolvent individual is declared bankrupt, allowing their assets to be distributed among creditors to repay outstanding debts.

In India, such matters are governed by the Insolvency and Bankruptcy Code (IBC), which came into existence in 2016. While banks use the law to recover their loans, the government sees it as a rescue ladder for a company in financial distress.

When a company fails to pay its loans, its creditors can approach the NCLT to initiate the Corporate Insolvency Resolution Process (CIRP) to recover their money. If this effort fails, the company is liquidated and its assets are sold to repay the loan.

Banks have one more option — to go after the person or promoter of a company who has provided a personal guarantee for the company's loans. This is called the personal insolvency resolution process (PIRP), which came into force in December 2019.

Now, the question that arises is, how do these different processes work? The answer: sequentially as well as simultaneously.

Say a company owes a bank Rs 100. The bank has two options. It can initiate CIRP and PIRP simultaneously, but its total claim in both processes cannot exceed Rs 100.

Alternatively, the bank can first initiate CIRP through the NCLT. Let's say it recovers Rs 70 through the resolution process. The bank can then file a PIRP petition to recover the remaining Rs 30.

The case

- Dhoot's case relates to SBI's loans to Videocon companies in 2010-12. Dhoot guaranteed repayment but failed.
- A resolution plan for his companies was set aside by NCLAT in 2022 as it offered creditors just Rs 2,962 cr, against the admitted claims of Rs 65,000 cr.
- Later, a repayment plan offered by Dhoot in a personal insolvency case was rejected by creditors as it offered Rs 600 cr — 0.42% of admitted dues. The PIRP was ended in July, leading to his bankruptcy.

It is when these two processes fail to ensure recovery of money by creditors that the third stage kicks in — bankruptcy. In other words, bankruptcy is the liquidation of the personal guarantor.

What now for Dhoot

Dhoot's entire estate will now be vested with a bankruptcy trustee appointed by the NCLT. What does this mean?

Essentially, Dhoot will have to submit details of all assets, sources of income and net worth held in his name to the trustee. These assets will then be sold, much like in a liquidation process, to repay creditors. Even in the case of Dhoot's residential properties, there are limits to what he can retain.

An analyst, however, said that this IBC provision has largely remained untested so far since very few cases reach the third stage and the recovery is very low.

"The bankruptcy of a personal guarantor has largely remained untested under the IBC. It takes a very long time to reach this stage and recovery is also very low. In the case of companies they have hard assets and business on the ground, through which the lenders can recover their loans faster. In the case of an individual, discovery of their actual net worth continues to be a challenge," said Prateek Kumar, a partner at corporate law firm Khaitan & Co.

Data from the IBC regulator, the Insolvency and Bankruptcy Board of India (IBBI), shows that bankruptcy cases are indeed few. Only 310 applications seeking to declare guarantors bankrupt have been filed since 2019.

On the other hand, 5,186 applications have been filed for the initiation of PIRP — a process that precedes bankruptcy. Of these, only 64 cases resulted in the approval of repayment plans, while creditors realised just 1% of their admitted claims.

In the case of company insolvency, the NCLT admitted 9,166 applications for the initiation of CIRP since 2016, according to IBBI. Of these, resolution plans were approved in 1,484 cases, while liquidation was ordered in 3,074 cases. A total of 1,333 applications were withdrawn under section 12A, 1,410 cases were closed on appeal or review or settled, and CIRP is ongoing in 1,865 cases.

Under resolution plans, creditors realised an average of 30.52% of their admitted claims, whereas in liquidation cases, the realisation was only around 4%.

The data shows that the recovery in personal insolvency has remained low, in comparison to the resolution of companies.

• LEGAL

Not birthright: How SC ruled on Hindu man's claim to grandfather's property

Amaal Sheikh
New Delhi, November 12

IF A man inherits property from his father, is his son automatically entitled to a share in it under the Hindu Succession Act of 1956? Not really. Continuing with the analogy, it is the man who becomes the absolute owner of the property and can deal with it as he chooses, including by excluding the son, according to a Supreme Court ruling last week.

Birth alone, therefore, does not mean a man can inherit his grandfather's property — if his father is still alive and is himself an heir. The question, then, is when can a man claim a share in his grandfather's property?

First, the facts of the case

The case in the Supreme Court dealt with the property of one N Ramakrishnan, which was divided among his heirs following a partition suit filed by his daughter in 1993.

Ramakrishnan's son, M Kumaran, received a plot under a compromise deed in February 1994 and sold it in April 1997. But Kumaran's son, Rajesh, later sued his father and the buyers, claiming that the plot was ancestral property and that he had acquired a coparcenary interest in it by birth.

In Indian law, coparcenary is the group within a joint family that holds ancestral property together, with each member getting a share in it by birth.

A trial court in Chennai, Tamil Nadu, granted a preliminary decree for partition in Rajesh's favour. However, an appellate court set the decree aside, holding that the property had become Kumaran's exclusive share following the partition among the grandfather's heirs. The Madras High Court upheld that decision — and so did the Supreme Court.

The legal framework

Hindu law has two main schools, Dayabhaga and Mitakshara. Dayabhaga is followed in West Bengal and Assam, and Mitakshara is followed across the rest of India.

Under Dayabhaga, a son does not get a right in the family property by birth. His right opens only when his father dies. Until then, the father owns the property and can deal with it as he chooses.

Under the Mitakshara school of Hindu law, a son acquires an interest in ancestral coparcenary property by birth. Unlike an ordinary inheritance claim, the right does not arise only when the father dies. The son becomes a coparcener, or joint owner, in the joint Hindu family and can even claim a share in the coparcenary property.

The Hindu Succession Act has a schedule that lists who inherits and in what order. Section 8 of the Hindu Succession Act states that when a Hindu male dies intestate — that is, without making a valid will — his property first goes to relatives specified as Class I heirs in that Schedule. Class I heirs include his son, daughter, widow and mother, among others.

The son of a predeceased son is included, but the son of a living son is not.

This is the distinction that lies at the heart of the present case — a man cannot claim direct succession to his grandfather's property under Section 8 while his father is still alive and himself an heir.

Section 6 of the Hindu Succession Act (prior to the 2005 amendment) dealt with the devolution of a male Hindu's interest in Mitakshara coparcenary property. A coparcener's share in the joint family property did not pass by succession when he died. It automatically passes to the other coparceners in the family. The exception was where he left behind a female Class I heir such as a widow or a daughter. In that case, the share went to his heirs under the Act.

Section 19 of the Act also says that where two or more heirs inherit the property of a man who has not left a will behind, they receive it as tenants in common and not as joint tenants. This means that each heir holds an individual share that can be dealt with independently.

What the Supreme Court held

The bench of Justices Augustine George Masih and Sunita Agarwal said: "The right of a son's son in his grandfather's property during the lifetime of his father which existed under the personal Hindu Law as enforced before the Act 1956, was not saved expressly by the legislature while enacting the Hindu Succession Act, 1956."

The court held that Ramakrishnan's property devolved upon his Class I heirs under Section 8 following his death. The bench noted that a grandson who is the son of a living son was not included in that category. "A son's son is not mentioned as an heir under Class I of the Schedule, and, therefore, he could not get any right in the property of his grandfather under the provision," the bench said.

The court also said that once the heirs partitioned the property, each became the exclusive owner of the share allotted to them. They inherited as tenants in common, rather than as joint tenants, and the joint coparcenary did not continue. As explained above, a tenant in common holds an individual, identifiable share in property which can be dealt with independently. The plot allotted to Kumaran under the compromise deed became his individual property, and he was entitled to sell it.

"There is no question of devolution of the property once partitioned and became exclusive individual property of the first respondent upon the appellant herein so as to recognise his right on the premise of attaining coparcenary rights with his birth," the court said.

The grandson also argued that he had acquired coparcenary rights upon birth, and that Section 29A of the Hindu Succession Act, which was added to grant coparcenary rights to daughters, did not preserve any coparcenary character of the property following the 1994 compromise decree.

The bench rejected this argument, noting that although the grandfather's exact date of death was not disclosed in the record, succession had opened upon his death long before the grandson was born and before the partition proceedings were instituted in 1993. The top court held that the grandson was not a surviving coparcener when succession opened.

'REVENUE, EMPLOYMENT DATA COLLECTION NEEDS URGENT STANDARDISATION ACROSS MINISTRIES'

6 years on, PLI schemes disbursal 18.5% of total outlay: NITI Aayog

Ravi Dutta Mishra
New Delhi, November 12

THE CUMULATIVE incentive disbursements of funds across 14 production-linked incentive (PLI) schemes notified in 2020 involving key sectors such as pharmaceuticals, textiles, automobile, steel, among others till March 2026 remains 18.51% of the total outlay of Rs 1.91 lakh crore, an impact assessment report released by the NITI Aayog and IIM Ahmedabad on Thursday revealed.

Data released by the think tank showed that as many as nine PLI schemes, including bulk drug, automobile and textile, saw disbursements of less than 10% of their respective outlays. But PLI schemes for drones and drone components, large-scale electronics and food products, which are also top-performing export sectors, saw disbursements in the range of 25% to 77% of the outlay.

All schemes did not come into effect in 2020, and therefore some schemes have a longer gestation period.

The report said that as of March 2026, cumulatively the scheme has attracted investments of Rs 2.40 lakh crore, generated production worth Rs 22.66 lakh crore and created employment for over 8.49 lakh individuals. The sector-wise assessment indicates that nearly 70% of targeted segments are broadly on track, with particularly strong outcomes seen in electronics, telecom and pharmaceuticals drugs, the report said.

"The relatively modest share of cumulative disbursement is consistent with the performance-linked design of the scheme, under which incentives are released only upon achievement of specified investment, production and other eligibility criteria, rather than being front-loaded. As participating firms expand capacity, scale up production and meet progressively higher performance thresholds, disbursements are expected to increase over the respective scheme tenures," the report said.

However, the assessment also suggested a need for reforms amid criticism that PLI schemes such as electronic manufacturing, considered a success, have also led to a sharp surge in imports and that a bump in manufacturing of mobile phones is largely due to assembly and is not adding to employment. The report said that although the PLI scheme has shown encouraging early results, the focus "now must shift from assessing its initial success to strength-ening its long-term effectiveness".

The way ahead lies not merely in continuing the scheme, but in refining its design so that it can deliver deeper and more sustained industrial transformation, the report said.

NITI Aayog suggested several broad reforms.

The varied performance of the PLI scheme across sectors requires more focused study.

While some sectors have responded strongly with visible increases in investment, production, employment, and exports, others have shown relatively modest progress, the report said. "This variation is often linked to differences in technology adoption, gestation periods, global competition, and capital requirements. A sector-specific understanding of these constraints is necessary so that policy design can move beyond a uniform approach and become more strategically targeted," it said.

The scheme, in its current form, is largely "supply-driven", and encourages firms to increase production and build capacity through financial incentives linked to output, the report said.

While this supply- push approach is crucial, long-term sustainability also requires strong demand-side support, it said, adding that the next generation of such schemes with similar nature should incorporate demand-pull mechanisms alongside existing supply-side incentives. "Data collection and reporting mechanisms across ministries need urgent standardisation," the report said.

FULL REPORT ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

• 14 PLI schemes and their disbursals

Sectors	Disbursement
Drones & Drone Components	77.50%
Large Scale Electronics Manufacturing	55.83%
Pharmaceuticals drugs	44.39%
Food Products	24.89%
Telecom & Networking Products	22.59%
White Goods (ACs & LED)	9.29%
Automobiles & Auto Components	9.20%
Manufacturing of Medical Devices	7.79%
Speciality Steel	3.73%
Textile Products: MMF segment and technical textiles	3.61%
Critical Key Starting materials/Drug Intermediaries and Active Pharmaceutical Ingredients (Bulk Drugs)	1.27%
Electronic/Technology Products (IT Hardware 2.0)	0.57%
Advanced Chemistry Cell (ACC) Battery	
High Efficiency Solar PV Modules	

SOURCE: NITI AAYOG; NOTE: DATA TILL MARCH 2026

Russian fossil fuel imports touch record €6.4 bn in Oct

Sukalp Sharma
New Delhi, November 12

INDIA'S FOSSIL fuel imports from Russia hit a record high of 6.4 billion euros in October, helping Moscow generate the most revenue from its fossil fuel sales in nearly four years amid elevated energy prices globally due to West Asia war, said an analysis by European think tank Centre for Research on Energy and Clean Air (CREA).

China, the biggest buyer of Russian energy, also made its highest monthly purchase of Russian fossil fuels since January 2022 in October.

India is the second-largest buyer of Russian hydrocarbons, primarily crude oil, and Moscow has been New Delhi's largest source of crude for about four years now.

"India was the second-largest buyer of Russian fossil fuels in October 2026, importing a total of EUR 6.4 billion of Russian hydrocarbons, its highest monthly total in data going back to January 2022. Crude oil constituted 91% of India's purchases, totalling EUR 5.8 billion. Coal (EUR 333 million) and oil products (EUR 232 million) constituted the remainder of its monthly Russian imports," CREA said on Thursday.

India's oil imports from Russia took off after the Ukraine war broke out.

With much of the West shunning Russian crude following its February 2022 invasion of Ukraine, Moscow began offering discounts on its oil to willing buyers.

Indian refiners were quick to avail the opportunity, leading to Russia — earlier a peripheral supplier of oil to India — emerging as the country's biggest source of crude, displacing traditional West Asian suppliers. India's imports of Russian crude rose 10% sequentially in October, as per the think tank.

"Russian crude imports rose at all three of India's largest importing refineries: Vadinar (up 12% month-on-month), Jamnagar (up 22%), and Paradip (up 28%). This increase has once again made the Jamnagar refinery the biggest importer of seaborne Russian crude," it said.

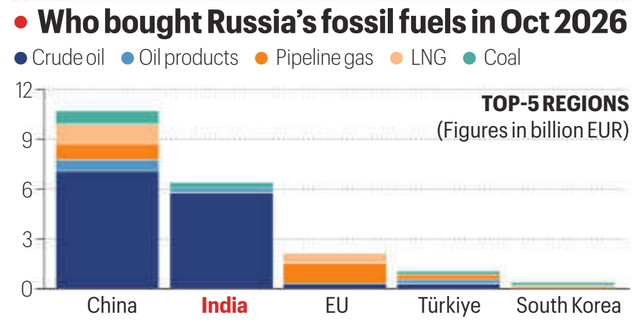
Vadinar refinery belongs to Nayara Energy, which is co-promoted by Russia's Rosneft, while the Jamnagar refinery is owned by Reliance Industries. Paradip refinery belongs to Indian Oil Corporation. "In October 2026, China remained the world's largest importer of Russian fossil fuels, and both China (EUR 10.7 billion) and India (EUR 6.4 billion) made their highest monthly purchases in data going back to January 2022. The EU (European Union) remained the third-largest importer, ahead of Turkiye," the think tank said.

The rise in revenues for Russia outpaced growth in its hydrocarbon export volumes, primarily due to elevated energy prices due to geopolitical conflicts — the West Asia war and Russia-Ukraine war.

In October, the average price of Russia's flagship crude Urals rose by 13% month-on-month to $101.7 per barrel, the highest monthly average since at least October 2021.

The energy crisis due to the West Asia war has delivered a substantial boost to Russia's fossil fuel export earnings. CREA estimates that in the six months since the US-Israel strikes on Iran began, higher oil and gas prices have increased Russia's seaborne export revenues by $35.9 billion. FULL REPORT ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

• Who bought Russia's fossil fuels in Oct 2026



SOURCE: CREA ANALYSIS BASED ON KPLER, MARINE TRAFFIC, ENTSOG AND CUSTOMS DATA

CAG begins audit of 39 state power discoms

Pratyush Deep
New Delhi, November 12

THE COMPTROLLER and Auditor General of India (CAG) has begun an audit of the operational and financial performance of 39 state-owned power distribution companies (discoms), with a special focus on consumer satisfaction and short-term power procurement practices, *The Indian Express* has learnt.

Unlike earlier audits, which examined individual discoms in different states in separate years, the current exercise brings 39 state-owned discoms under a single audit.

It also covers five departmental undertakings where electricity distribution is still handled directly by government departments rather than separate companies. The audit began in some states in July and is expected to be completed by middle of the next financial year, sources said.

The exercise is part of the CAG's plan to undertake an integrated audit of the power sector, which is expected to attract investments of around Rs 50 lakh crore by 2032 and Rs 200 lakh crore by 2047. The audit is being conducted by CAG's State Commercial Audit division, which was set up last year to focus on state-owned public sector enterprises.

The integrated audit is envisaged to cover all major segments of the power sector over the next four years — generation, transmission, distribution and renewable energy.

According to officials, distribution has been taken up in the first year because discoms are the direct interface between the power sector and consumers, and their financial health is connected to power supply, other segments of the sector and wider economy. State-owned discoms continue to face financial stress, with accumulated losses and mounting liabilities weighing on their balance sheets. FULL REPORT ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

Private equity firms to be barred from controlling multiple non-bank lenders

Reuters
Mumbai, November 12

THE CENTRAL bank is working on proposals that would prevent private equity firms from holding a controlling stake in more than one non-bank lender, two people with knowledge of the plans said.

It is concerned that financial stress at a global private equity firm or its affiliates could have a contagion effect across several non-bank lenders in which it has significant investments, they said. Authorities hope to encourage smaller financial investments that will be subject to lesser scrutiny, the people added, as the discussions are private.

Control is defined as a large stake, 25% in case of listed firms, though ownership can be smaller and still be considered a controlling stake if the investor has the right to appoint a majority of the directors.

Wall St recovers but Nvidia woes deepen

Reuters
Bengaluru, November 12

WALL STREET'S main indexes staged a turnaround Thursday after higher oil prices lifted energy shares even as Nvidia CEO Jensen Huang's exit stirred concerns about the future of the AI heavyweight.

The chip giant's shares were last down 4.2%, having bounced off session lows. Retail investors bought Nvidia shares worth about $111 million in the first half hour of trading, the biggest opening bid on record for the stock, according to data from Vanda Analytics. Eight of the 11 major S&P 500 sector indexes were in positive territory, with energy leading gains with a 1.3% jump. Still, some investors warned that questions will persist about the future of AI companies that have deep ties with Nvidia. The company has backed several firms, including its own customers, through financing arrangements that now face greater scrutiny after Huang's departure.

"Nvidia doesn't just sell chips. It also stands behind some of the financing that helps customers build the data centers those chips go into," said Matthew Tuttle, founder and CEO of Tuttle Capital Management. The Philadelphia Semiconductor index rose 0.2%. Neocloud company Nebius said its 2026 revenue would come in at the low end of its previous forecast, pulling its shares down 17%. Peer CoreWeave dropped about 6%.

Nvidia's rivals Advanced Micro Devices and Broadcom were up over 6% each.

• BRIEFLY

Murdoch's Bodhi Tree to invest $180 mn in A2B

New Delhi: Investment firm Bodhi Tree has agreed to invest $180 million for a majority stake in popular south Indian food chain Adyar Ananda Bhavan (A2B), its first bet on the food sector, the companies said in a joint statement. Bodhi Tree is led by media veterans James Murdoch, the younger son of media mogul Rupert Murdoch, and Uday Shankar, a top executive of the Reliance-Disney India joint venture. REUTERS

Vi revenue rises 6.2%, net loss widens

Mumbai: Vodafone Idea (Vi) has reported a 6.2% year-on-year increase in revenue from operations to Rs 11,884 crore for the September quarter of FY27, compared with Rs 11,195 crore in the corresponding period last year, as the telecom operator continued to expand its 4G and 5G network and improve customer realisations. The company, however, reported a higher net loss of Rs 5,975 crore for the quarter, against Rs 5,524 crore in the year-ago period. ENS

ZEEL announces Rs 600 crore share buyback

Mumbai: Zee Entertainment Enterprises Ltd (ZEEL) on Thursday said its board has approved a share buyback of over 6.5 crore shares for up to Rs 600 crore. The shares will be acquired at Rs 91 per share, ZEEL said. The buyback offer price of Rs 91 per share represents a premium of 23.8% over the company's closing share pr-ice of Rs 73.50 Thursday. Its stock hit a 52-week high of Rs 118.40 on June 23 and 52-week low of Rs 60.63 on November 4 on adjusted basis. PTI

• MARKETS

Sensex	NIFTY	Gold ▼	US Dollar ▲
81,911.01	25,299.35	₹1,37,692	₹94.04
31.61	44.30	Silver ▼	Oil ▲
0.04%	0.18%	₹1,81,040	$90.99

NOTE: GOLD, SILVER RATES AS PER INDIA BULLION AND JEWELLERS ASSOCIATION DATA GOLD PER 10G, SILVER PER 1 KG; CRUDE OIL (INDIAN BASKET) AS OF NOVEMBER 11, 2026

• KERALAM CM'S PITCH AT EIGHTH EDITION OF HUDDLE GLOBAL STARTUP EVENT

Don't have to leave Keralam to build something world needs: CM

Anil Sasi
Thiruvananthapuram, November 12

BILLED AS Asia's largest beachside startup festival, the launch of the eighth edition of Huddle Global at Kovalam beach offers a near perfect setting, melding Keralam's traditional revenue earner — tourism — with its new ambition to foster a vibrant start-up ecosystem.

Kovalam is one of southern Keralam's coastal tourism hubs located in the capital Thiruvananthapuram, famous for its three adjacent arch-shaped beaches, iconic lighthouse, and smattering of Ayurvedic wellness retreats.

The startup ecosystem, on the other hand, is the state's new frontier as it attempts to transition into a high-end service hub, even as it tries to shake off its redoubtable reputation for labour protests, patchy transport infrastructure and stringent environmental regulations.

Inaugurating the three-day event organised by the Kerala Startup Mission (KSUM), Keralam Chief Minister V D Satheesan signalled a qualitative push in the state's startup ecosystem. "Today, we are announcing a major shift in our startup strategy: from quantity to quality, from creating startups to building globally successful enterprises. Our ambition is to nurture more than 100 startups with annual revenues exceeding Rs 100 crore," he said here on Thursday. "Our message to every young entrepreneur is simple: You don't have to leave Keralam to build something the world needs."



Billed as Asia's largest beachside startup festival, the event is being pitched as the focal point for tech startups. EXPRESS

Satheesan said the state government would establish ten world-class, research-focused incubators through the Translational Research and Innovation Centre-Kerala (TRIC-K), an academic-industry incubator hosted at the University of Kerala. It also plans to strengthen startup funding, innovation grants, research and development support and seed financing, besides developing new debt-financing instruments through the Kerala Financial Corporation, Kerala State Industrial Development Corporation and banking partners, he said.

"Huddle global has brought the world to this beach. Now the endeavour should be to take these companies to the world."

The confluence of tourism and the startup ecosystem in Keralam is already visible, with travel and tourism startups having grown exponentially in the State, a state government official who attended the event said. As per the statistics available with the state's Tourism department, over 150 startups have been operating in just the hospitality sector of the state. Of these, over 100 came on stream in the last 36 months. Huddle is being pitched as the focal point for tech startups and other relevant stakeholders of the entrepreneurial ecosystem. It is designed to offer a platform for startups to showcase their products and interact with a clutch of technology and industry leaders in somewhat informal settings.

Keralam's startup journey started in 2014 with a simple idea to introduce innovation and entrepreneurship in colleges, after its government initiated Innovation and Entrepreneurship Development Centres to give students a platform to explore ideas, build products and start ventures. But over the past decade, the state has built one of the world's most inclusive and impactful startup ecosystems. Keralam is home to over 9,200 registered startups.

(*The writer was in Keralam at the invitation of the Kerala Startup Mission*)

भरतपुर विकास प्राधिकरण, भरतपुर

क्रमांक :- लेखा/भ.वि.प्रा./2026-27/15783 - 96 दिनांक :- 05/11/2026

अल्पकालीन ऑनलाईन निविदा सूचना सं. 57/2026-27

राजस्थान के राज्यपाल महोदय की ओर से भरतपुर विकास प्राधिकरण, में उपयुक्त श्रेणी एवं विभिन्न विभागों में एए श्रेणी/ए और (योग्यतानुसार) में पंजीकृत संवेदकों से निर्धारित प्रपत्र में ई–प्रोक्योरमेन्ट प्रक्रिया से कुल 01 कार्य हेतु ऑनलाईन निविदाएं आमंत्रित की जाती है।

उक्त कार्य का विस्तृत विवरण, निविदा शर्तें, अनुमानित लागत राशि, निविदा बेचने, प्राप्त करने एवं खोलने की दिनांक आदि सम्पूर्ण विवरण वेवसाईट **www.urban.rajasthan.gov.in/bdabharatpur** एवं **http://sppp.raj.nic.in portal** पर देखा जा सकता है। निविदा से संबंधित किसी भी प्रकार का संशोधन **www.urban.rajasthan.gov.in/bdabharatpur** एवं **http://sppp.raj.nic.in portal** का अवलोकन करें। **UBN विवरण :– WAQ2627WSRC00137**

अधिशाषी अभियंता
भरतपुर विकास प्राधिकरण, भरतपुर

राज.सवांद/सी/26/13109

GOVERNMENT OF ODISHA
DEPARTMENT OF WATER RESOURCES
OFFICE OF THE CHIEF ENGINEER
RENGALI RIGHT IRRIGATION PROJECT, DHENKANAL
DIST-DHENKANAL, ODISHA, PIN: 759001

32001/1321/2627

Email Id - cerripdkl@gmail.com

'e' Procurement Notice

Bid Identification No. CERRIP-01/2026-27

The Chief Engineer, Rengali Right Irrigation Project, Mahisapat, Dhenkanal on behalf of the Governor of Odisha invites on line percentage rate bids in double cover system for construction of the work as detailed below:

1.	Name of the work	:	Improvement to canal service road from RD 44.00 km to 77.6 km on left bank of RBC including Bank strengthening, Construction of side drain, toe wall with slope protection work under RRIP, Dhenkanal.
2.	Estimated cost	:	Rs. 30,19,00,719.00
3.	Bid Document Cost	:	Rs. 10,000.00 (on line)
4.	Bid Security	:	Rs.30,19,000.00 (on line)
5.	Class of Contractor	:	'Special' & 'Super' Class
6.	Period of Completion	:	18 calendar months including rainy seasons
7.	Date and time of availability of Bid document in the portal	:	From 16.11.2026, 10.00 AM to 10.12.2026 up to 5.30 PM
8.	Date and time and place for Pre-Bid Conference	:	25.11.2026 at 11.00 AM O/o the CE, RRIP, Dhenkanal
9.	Last date and time for receipt of bids in the portal	:	10.12.2026 up to 5.30 PM
10.	Date of Opening of Technical Bid (Cover-1)	:	11.12.2026 at 11.00 AM
11.	Name and address of the Officer inviting Bid	:	Chief Engineer, Rengali Right Irrigation Project, Mahisapat, Dhenkanal, PIN-759001

Further details can be seen from the e-procurement portal "**https:// www.tendersodisha.gov.in**" Any addendum/ Corrigendum/ Cancellation to the above notice will be published in the Govt. website **www.tendersodisha.gov.in**

Sd/-
Chief Engineer
Rengali Right Irrigation Project, Dhenkanal

OIPR- 32001/32351/1/26-27/0006

GOVERNMENT OF ODISHA
OFFICE OF THE CHIEF CONSTRUCTION ENGINEER, CENTRAL RURAL WORKS CIRCLE, BHUBANESWAR

25001/1537/2627

No. 6862 / Date. 05.11.2026

"e" Procurement Notice for Bridge Works

1.	Name of the Work	:	Bridge Works under Setu Bandhan Yojana (SBY) for the year 2024-25
2.	Total No. of works:	:	02 Nos. of Bridge Works
3.	Estimated Cost of the work:	:	Varies from Rs.322.00 lakh to Rs.447.87 lakh
4.	Class of Contractor	:	
	a) Estimated cost more than Rs. 20.00 lakh up to Rs. 3.00 Crores.		B Class (of Odisha PWD) or relevant class of other licensing authorities
	b) Estimated cost more than Rs. 1.00 Crore up to Rs. 20.00 Crores.		A Class (of Odisha PWD) or relevant class of other licensing authorities
	c) Estimated cost more than Rs. 6.00 Crore up to Rs. 50.00 Crores.		Special Class (of Odisha PWD) or relevant class of other licensing authorities
	d) Estimated cost more than Rs. 20.00 Crores		Super Class (of Odisha PWD) or relevant class of other licensing authorities
5.	Period of completion	:	**As mentioned in Column-7 of Annexure**
6.	Offered rates by bidder	:	The offered rate by the contractor shall be excluding GST.
7.	Other details	:	

Procurement Officer	Bid Identification No.	Availability of Tender on-line for bidding		Date & Time of opening of tender	
		From	To	Technical Bid	Financial Bid
1.	2.	3.	4.	5.	6.
Chief Construction Engineer, Central Rural Works Circle, Bhubaneswar	Tender - Online - C.C. 31 of 2026	16.11.2026 at 11.00 A.M.	04.12.2026 up to 5.00 P.M.	05.12.2026 at 11.00 A.M.	To be intimated later on

Further details can be seen from the website www.tenderodisha.gov.in

Sd/-
Chief Engineer
Central R.W. Circle, Bhubaneswar

OIPR 25001/25194/1/26-27/0009

KARNATAKA INDUSTRIAL AREAS DEVELOPMENT BOARD
(A Government of Karnataka Undertaking)
2, 2/1 and 2/3, Kalidasa Marg, 1st Main Road, Gandhinagar, Bengaluru – 560 009. Phone No. 080-22265383. Website: www.kiadb.in

No. IADB/ENGG/ETND-EP-12/1716/2026-27 Date:12.11.2026

SHORT TERM NOTICE INVITING TENDER
(Through GOK Karnataka Public Procurement Portal Only)

Item rate Tender is invited as per the Karnataka Transparency in Public Procurement Act 1999 and Rules 2000 through electronic procurement from eligible Contractors registered in KCEI who have got adequate financial resources & sufficient past experience for the following work as per the schedule given below:

Name of Work : Shifting of HT/LT Lines and Transformer centres existed in plot no.1 allotted to M/s.Reliance and other plots in Mulwada Industrial Area, 2nd Phase, Vijayapura Taluk and District.

The last date and time of receipt of tender is : **01.12.2026 upto 04:00 pm**

Applicants May Download Bidding Documents from the E-Procurement Portal **https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in**

Sd/-
Chief Engineer - 2

DIPR/CP/JA/3661/2026-27

Classifieds

PERSONAL

I, Ram Adheen Yadava S/O. Shiva Ram Yadava R/O. H N-TF 304 Shaberi-1 Sai Garden-2, Greater Noida, PO: Greater Noida, Dist: Gautam Buddha Nagar, Uttar Pradesh-201308 have changed my name From RAM ADHEEN YADAVA to RAM ADHEEN YADAV for all future Purposes
0071071080-1

I,MEENAKSHI W/o Sanjay Goel R/o 134, Savita Vihar, Delhi-110092, have changed my name from MEENAKSHI to MEENAKSHI GOEL permanently.
0040888663-5

I,Rumki Anand W/o Ritesh Anand R/o P-254, Jalvayu Vihar, Sector-21, Noida(U.P) have changed my name to Rumki Sengupta for all purposes.
0040888569-1

I NASIRUDDEEN s/o RAMAJANI r/o B-44,Shalimar Garden Main, Sahibabad, Ghaziabad,Uttar Pradesh-201001 has changed my name to NASRUDDIN permanently 0040888660-4

I, DINESH SHARMA S/O DHARMVEER SHARMA R/O F 167 BETA 2 NEAR RYAN PUBLIC SCHOOL GREATER NOIDA RAMPUR JAGIR GAUTAM BUDDHA NAGAR UTTAR PRADESH - 201306 have changed my name DINESH KUMAR for all future purpose
0071071106-1

It is for general information that I,AMAN,S/o-SANJAY SINGH CHAUHAN,R/o-F-188,Balmiki-Basti,Katwaria-Sarai,DIST:South West-Delhi, Delhi-110016,declare that name of my father and my mother have been wrongly written as SANJAY PATTHAR CHOUHAN and MAMTA DEVI in my 10th class educational documents and that the name of my mother has been wrongly written as MAMTA CHAUHAN in my 12th class educational documents and that the name of my father has been wrongly written as SANJAY in my Schedule Caste Certificate.No.90510000862482.The actual name of my father and my mother are SANJAY SINGH CHAUHAN and MAMTA SANJAY SINGH CHAUHAN respectively, which may be amended accordingly
0040888663-15

I, SHUBHAM SHARMA S/o PRADUM SHARMA R/o 278-A, Shri Ram Nagar,Shahdara, East Delhi, Delhi-110032, have changed name of my minor daughter MISHIKA SHARMA, aged 02 years and she shall hereafter be known as NITYA SHARMA. 0060148596-1

I,Ishrat W/O Ashraf Ilahi,R/o H NO.E-82,Near Sunheri Masjid,New Seelampur,Delhi-110053,Have Changed My Name To ISHRAT JAHAN. Permanently.
0040888659-7

I, Manoj Pathak, son of Jamuna Pathak, resident of P-6B, Sanjay Nagar, P-Block, Sector-23, Sanjay Nagar, Ghaziabad, Uttar Pradesh, Pin Code-201002, hereby inform that I have changed my name from Manoj Kumar Pathak to Manoj Pathak and I would like to be known by this name in future.
0071071083-1

I Brij Mohan Tiwari S/o Ish Narayan Tiwari R/o H.no.E-287 Gali.no.5, Sonia vihar Delhi-110094.Have changed my name from Vrij Mohan Tiwari to Brij Mohan Tiwari for all purposes.Both name belongs to one and same person.
0071071116-1

I, Manjeet Maan S/o Sh. Prem Chand, R/o Gali No.9, Tilak Nagar, Rohtak, declare that my minor son Kiaan, DOB 28.10.2019, shall henceforth be known as Kiaan Maan, vide affidavit dated 12.11.2026 sworn before Notary Public, Rohtak.
0040888641-1

I,MUTHU ARUMUGAM S/O Arumugam R/o A-257,Moti Bagh, Chanakya Puri,New Delhi-110021 Have changed my name to A Muthu. 0040888660-6

I,Shreya Dhawan W/o Siddharth Arora R/o B-82,Rampuri, Near Surya Nagar, Ghaziabad, U.P.,have changed my name to Shreya Arora.
0040888663-7

I hereby known as Nishil, S/o Sh. Virender Kaushal, R/o H-1/ 123-124, Sector-11, Rohini, Delhi-110085, have changed my name and shall hereafter be known as Nishil Kaushal. 0040888556-1

I,Rajeev Kanotra s/o-Arjun Dev Kanotra R/O-IInd Floor,regal Home stay,shimla by pass road,Bansal home chowk Dehradun UK-248171 Inform that the educational certificate of my doughter,namely Sonali Kanotra my name has been erroneously entered as Rajiv Kanotra that both names Rajeev Kanotra and Rajiv Kanotra are same person 0040888650-1

I,Badarul Hasan,S/O Karrar Hussain,R/O H.NO.P-16,Street no.17,Holi-Chowk Brahampuri, North East,Delhi-110053,have changed My Name to Badlu Hasan for all purposes.
0040888659-9

I, Anurag S/o Gulshan Kumar R/o-218, Kautilya Apartment, Sec-6, Vasundhara, Ghaziabad have changed my name to Anurag Arora for all purposes.
0071071085-1

I,Khushabu D/o Sh.Sahdev Mishra,R/o H.No.530/31, Vard.No. 30,Vishnu Garden, Tikam pur,Gurugram, Haryana-122017,have changed my name from Priti Mishra to Khushabu for all,future purposes.
0040888663-10

I,JAYANTI POKHARIA,W/O-C.S. POKHARIA,R/O-1210 MILANO MAHAGUN MANSION-2,VAIBHAV-KHAND INDIRAPURAM GHAZIABAD, U.P.201014,HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO JAYA POKHARIA ,FOR ALL FUTURE PURPOSES
0040888663-9

I,Shamima Praween, W/O Shri Mohammad Faiyaz Ahmad, R/O Unit No. 3,Upper Ground Floor,House No. E-15/9,Janakpuri Colony,Village Pasonda,Ghaziabad Uttar Pradesh, hereby declare that my former name was NASIR KHATOON, which I have now changed to SHAMIMA PRAWEEN. Both names belong to one and the same person. Henceforth,I shall be known and identified as SHAMIMA PRAWEEN for all purposes.,
0071071128-1

I,ABHISHAKE,S/o-VIPIN SWAROOP,R/o-RZ-1122,Gali No-14/5,Sadh-Nagar Part-1,Palam-colony,New-Delhi-110045,have changed my,date.of.birth 31/07/2002,and shall hereafter be known as-31/07/1998.
0040888659-2

I,Aryan,S/o Chiranji Lal,R/o-P-1/28,Sultan Puri,Delhi-110086, in my 10th Class Marksheet,my father name wrongly mentioned as Chiran Ji Lal but his Correct name is Chiranji Lal.
0040888660-8

I,Pooja Yadav /Vedhika Yadavi,D/O-Bechan Prasad Yadav,R/O 22,Sector-8,Near-Post Office,R K Puram,Delhi-110022,Have Changed My Name To Vedhika Yadav,For All Future Purposes 0040888663-2

I Geeta Verma D/o Vinod Singh R/o 5, Ravindra Nagar, Palasiya, Indore, Madhya Pradesh-452018, have changed my name to Geeta Singh
0071071153-1

I,HITESH AHUJA, HOUSE. NO.2/22B,1ST FLOOR, JANGPURA-A,SHAHI HOSPITAL ROAD,DELHI-110014,HAVE CHANGED MY MINOR SON NAME DAIWIK AHUJA TO DEVIK AHUJA. 0040888660-1

I, Suman, W/o Kamal Singh, R/o hno 152 molarband New Delhi, declare that my name was recorded as Sushma in my daughter Prachi singh's birth certificate and class 10th standard marksheet. My true and legal name is Suman. Both Sushma and Suman refer to one and the same person.
0071071071-1

I, Anju W/o Atul Singhal R/o-705, Block-A2, Navkar Vatika Ganganagar, Defencecolony, Meerut have changed my name to Anju Singhal.
0071071088-1

I, Krishn Kumar Yadav S/o Bhagavat Prasad Yadav, 8775/4, SF, Multani Dhanda, Pahar Ganj, Delhi-55 have changed my name to Krishan Kumar Yadav. 0071071133-1

I,Vijay Kumar Mishra,S/o-Shiv sewak mishra,house.no-62,gali no-37,challera sector-44,noida sector-37 Gautam buddha-nagar,Uttar Pradesh-201303,have changed my name to Vijay Kumar. 0040888659-4

I,SHASHI SHARMA,W/o-Tirupuri Singh,R/o-H.No.475,Near-Yadav Choupal, Kapashera,South-West Delhi,Delhi-110097,have changed my minor son name from UTKARSH TRIPURARI SINGH to UTKARSH SINGH.
0040888660-10

I,Chandra Prakash Mishra,S/o-Vijay Pratap Narayan Mishra,R/o-B-72/F-3,First Floor,Dilshad-Colony,Delhi-110095,have changed the name of my minor daughter AHANA to AHANA MISHRA,for all future purposes. 0040888663-4

I, Pooja Sikka W/O Shitij Paul, R/o P-5, Malviya Nagar, South Delhi, Delhi- 110017. have changed my name and shall hereafter be Known as Stuti Paul 0071071159-1

I, KHUSNUMA,w/o-MANSOOR AHMED,r/o-A-24,Gali.no-2, Jawahar-park, Chikambarpur, Sahibabad, Ghaziabad,Uttar Pradesh,-201006, has changed my name to KHUSHNUMA permanently. 0040888660-3

I TANVI D/O OM PRAKASH PARASHAR R/O HOUSE NO. 167,BAADH MOHALLA , FARIDABAD -121001. THAT NAME OF MY FATHER WRONGLY WRITTAN AS OM PRAKASH PARASHAR IN MY CBSE SECONDARY SCHOOL CERTIFICATE NO 0335202 WAS ISSUED ON 03/06/2017. THE ACTUAL NAME OF MY FATHER IS OM PRAKASH SHARMA i.e. WRITTEN IN MY ALL OTHER DOCUMENTS ,WHICH HAS TO BE AMENDED ACCORDINGLY FOR ALL FUTURE PURPOSES.
0071071076-1

I,Shailender Kumar,S/o-Shyam Parkash R/o B-1-B/46, Janakpuri,New Delhi-110058, have changed my name to Shailender Kumar Kapoor.
0040888660-12

I, AKSHAY BHARDWAJ S/O Mohan Lal R/O 487/64, Peera Garhi Village, Paschim Vihar, Sunder Vihar 8.0, West Delhi-110087 have changed my name AKSHAY KUMAR for all future purposes 0071071091-1

I, SAHEEN ANSARI W/O MOHD RAHEES R/O, 2/32 MANIHARI FARRUKHABAD UTTAR PRADESH 209625 , have changed my name to SHAHEEN BEGAM Permanently.
0071071141-1

I,GARIMA,W/O-DUSHYANT KUMAR,R/O-A-58, A-BLOCK FIRST FLOOR INDERPURI DELHI-110012,have changed my name to GARIMA CHOPRA Permanently for all future purposes. 0040888659-3

It is for general information that I,PRAVEEN KUMAR PANDEY,S/O-BHOLA NATH PANDEY,R/O 36-A,Near Lovely Public School,Krishna Kunj Colony,Laxmi Nagar,PO-Laxmi Nagar,Dist-East Delhi, Delhi-110092.declare that name of mine has been wrongly-written as PARVEEN PANDEY in my 10th and 12th class educational documents and as PARVEEN KUMAR PANDEY in my Graduation educational documents and service records.The actual name of mine is PRAVEEN KUMAR PANDEY respectively which may be amended accordingly.
0040888663-14

I,Mohd Ashraf S/O Abdul Razak,R/o H NO.E-82, Near Sunheri Masjid,New Seelampur,Delhi-110053,Have Changed My Name To ASHRAF ILAHI. Permanently.
0040888659-6

I, SATYAWATI w/o DHARAM VIR SEHRAWAT, VILLAGE TILANGPUR KOTLA, NAJAFGARH, New Delhi-110043, have changed my name to SATYA WATI.
0071071082-1

I,Zubair Ahmed khan,S/O Zunnoor khan,R/o-H.No.150/9 Gali No.9, 4th-Floor,Zakir Nagar,Jamia Nagar,Delhi-11025,have changed my name to Zubair Ahmad Khan.
0040888663-6

I, Pramod Kansal R/o BE-356A, Gali No.1, Hari Nagar, Delhi-110064 have changed my son's name from Lakshya Kansal to LAKSHAY KANSAL
0040888571-1

I, Naraj Khan, S/o Hasmuddin Khan, R/o-Plot No.52, Kh.No-6/23, Ground-Floor,Block-A, Rajeev Nagar, Begumpur, Delhi,have changed my name to Meraj Khan. 0040888577-1

I,JYOTI DEVI D/O BHEEM SINGH,R/O PIPALSHAH, MUZAFFARNAGAR,MUZAFFAR NAGAR,UTTAR PRADESH-247772. have changed my name to JYOTI PUNDIR for all purposes. 0040888660-5

I, Neeraj Kakkar, S/o Sanjay Kumar kakkar, R/O K-2112, Gaur Green City, Vaibhav khand, Indirapuram, Ghaziabad, Pin- 201014, UP, have changed the name of my minor daughter from "Laira" to "Laira Kakkar" for all future purposes. 0071071103-1

I,Shalini W/O Rajeev Kanotra R/O-F-24/3,Third Floor,Sec-7,Rohini,North West Delhi Delhi-110085 Inform that the educational certificate of my doughter,namely Sonali Kanotra my name has been erroneously entered as Shalini Kanotra that both names Shalini Kanotra and Shalini are same person 0040888647-1

I,BHARGAVI TYAGI,D/O-RAJEEV KUMAR TYAGI,R/O-TOWER-I,FLAT NO.101,KDP GRAND SAVANNA, RAJ NAGAR EXTENSION,Ghaziabad, Uttar Pradesh-201017,HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO JAYSHREE TYAGI.
0040888659-8

I, Atul Kumar S/o Jag Mohan Lal R/o-705, Block-A2, Navkar Vatika, Defencecolony, Ganganagar, Meerut have changed my name to Atul Singhal. 0071071084-1

I,Parul Jindal W/o Samir Agrawal R/o,F-1, First-Floor, 27 Block-B, Ramprastha Colony, Chander-Nagar, Ghaziabad, Uttar Pradesh-201011,have changed my-name to Parul Agrawal. 0040888663-8

I,PRIYANKA SHRIVASTAVA W/o AMIT SINHA R/o F-419,Sector - 23, Sanjay Nagar,Kavi Nagar,Ghaziabad, Uttar Pradesh-201002,have changed my name to PRIYANKA SINHA.
0040888659-1

I,NASREEM BEGUM,W/O FAHIMUDDIN SAIFI,R/O K-129,ABUL FAZAL ENCLAVE,NEAR KADRI, MASJID JAMIA-NAGAR OKHLA,NEW DELHI-110025,HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO NASREEN SAIFI.
0040888660-7

I,SHA BIBI W/O SADDAN KHAN,R/O-H.NO-1012/B GALI.NO-32 JAFRABAD,INDRA CHOWK NORTH EAST-DELHI-110053,HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO SHAHBIBI KHANAM.
0040888663-1

I hereby known as Nilay, S/o Sh. Virender Kaushal, R/o H-1/ 123-124, Sector-11, Rohini, Delhi-110085, have changed my name and shall hereafter be known as Nilay Kaushal.
0040888556-2

I Shahnaj Khatoon W/o Sainul Miyan R/o 1,1,Gram Post Khuthan Thana Imadpur, Khutaha, Bhojpur, Khutahan, Bihar- 802222, have changed my name to Sehnaj Khatoon
0071071151-1

I,ASHWANI KUMAR SHUKLA,S/o Prem Dutt Shukla,R/o 302-SF, Block-50,HIG-Apartment, Sector-Omicron-1,Greater Noida-201310,Gautam-Budh-Nagar,U.P.,have changed my name from ASHWANI KUMAR SHUKLA to ASHWANI SHUKLA for all future purposes,vide Affidavit dated 07/11/2026 sworn before Notary Public,Ghaziabad.
0040888659-10

I Tayyaba W/o Fazley Elahi R/o 7609, Quresh Nagar, Near masjid Ghante Wali, Sadar Bazar Delhi -110006 have changed my name to TAIYABA
0071071070-1

I, Kafil Ahamad S/o Kallu R/o-Peerwali Gali, Muradnagar, Ghaziabad have changed my name to Kafeel Ahmad for all purposes. 0071071086-1

I,VINAY SAHNI S/o-Shiv Lal Sahni, R/o-A-260, New Friends Colony, New Delhi-25, declare that name of mine and my father have been wrongly written as VINAY KR SAHNI and S L SAHNI in my Driving Licence No-DL0319920263120. The actual name of mine and my father are VINAY SAHNI and SHIV LAL SAHNI respectively, which may be amended accordingly.
0040888557-1

I,TRIPURARI JITENDER SINGH,S/o-Jitendra Pratap Singh,R/o-House.No. 755-10-14,B Wing,Flat.No.G-2,Peace-Heaven,Opp.Corporation-Bank,Near Devashree Garden,Porvorim,North-Goa,Goa-403521,have changed my name to TRIPURARI SINGH,for all future purpose.
0040888660-9

I,SAGEER AHEMED,S/O Qadeer Ahmed,R/o D-70,Street No.9,Mohanpuri, Maujpur, Delhi-110053,have changed my name,from SAGEER AHEMED to SAGIR AHMAD permanently.
0040888663-3

I, RAMACHANDRAN PADMANABHAN NAIR S/O LATE M. T. PADMANABHAN NAIR, R/O 163-F, TOP FLOOR, POCKET-1, MAYURVIHAR PHASE-1, DELHI-110091. HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO RAMACHANDRAN NAIR FOR ALL PURPOSE.
0040888558-1

I, Ranjana W/o Onkar Nath Choubey, R/o House No-395, Block No-I, Sector Beta-II, Greater Noida, G.B. Nagar, U.P. changed my name from Ranjana Choubey to Ranjana for all future purposes.
0071071154-1

I,AYYUB alias AYUB MALIK,s/o-ALLA NOOR,r/o A-219,Gali.no-7, Jawahar-Park, Chikambarpur,Sahibabad,Ghaziabad, Uttar Pradesh-201006,has changed my name to AYYUB MALIK, permanently
0040888660-2

I,MANGEL SEN GUPTA,S/O-Vinod Kumar Gupta S.H.35 D-1 Block Jhuggi,Nand Nagri Delhi,have changed my name to MANGAL SAIN GUPTA
0040888663-12

I, SANA D/O Anil Kumar Suyal, R/O RZF-988/6 Ambedkar Marg, Raj Nagar-II, Palam Colony, Dwarka Sector-08, New Delhi-110075 Have Changed My Name From Sana to Shreya Suyal Vide Affidavit Dated 10/11/2026 Sworn Before Notary Public Gurugram. Both Names Belong to One and the Same Person.
0040888588-1

I,Ashraf Ali S/O Abdul Razak, R/o H NO.E-82,Near Sunheri Masjid,New Seelampur,Delhi-110053,Have Changed My Name To ASHRAF ILAHI. Permanently.
0040888659-5

I,KUNDAN BISHT,C/O Sharda Devi Bisht H-153,sector-12 Ghaziabad,Vijai Nagar I,have changed my name to KUNDAN SINGH
0040888663-11

I, RAHEES ANSARI S/O MO HANIF R/O, 2/32 MANIHARI FARRUKHABAD UTTAR PRADESH 209625 , have changed my name to MOHD RAHEES Permanently.
0071071073-1

I, Praful Babarao Mungle S/o Babarao Dabaji Mungle, R/o A-205, Ajpa Dronagiri, Plot.No.11, GH-1, Sector-11, Vasundhara, Ghaziabad, U.P.-201012, hereby declare that my names Prafulla Babarao Mungle, Prafull Babarao Mungle and Praful Babarao Mungle refer to one and the same person, i.e., myself. Henceforth, I shall be known as Praful Babarao Mungle for all purposes.
0071071089-1

I,SHASHI TRIPURARI SINGH,W/o,Tirupuri Singh,R/o-H.No.475,Near-Yadav Choupal,Kapashera, South-West Delhi,Delhi-110097,have changed my name to SHASHI SHARMA,for all future purpose. 0040888660-11

LOST & FOUND

WE, VINOD Bhatia,(S/o-Late Harbans Lal Bhatia),and Sundeep Kumar Malik,(S/o-K L Malik),have lost,original Allotment Letter of our property Plot.No.740, Indraprastha Colony,Ghaziabad (U.P.).,If anyone found,pls contact at:-9810300399
0040888663-16

Sale Deed 10049/2022, Vol. I Jild 6546 Pages 169-190, dated 29-10-2022, Sale Deed 11105, Vol. I Jild 6327 Pages 353-378 dated 16-10-2024 registered Sub-Registrar Vikas Nagar Dehradun lost. Return to Yash Khurana 25/26 East Patel Nagar Delhi 110008 9899258699
0050301424-1

PUBLIC NOTICE

PUBLIC NOTICE

KNOW ALL MEN THAT MY CLIENT Shri Kuldeep Singh R/o House No. 134, Village Tatesar, P.O. Jounti, Delhi-110081 M. 9540150019 is owner of the property/ land bearing by virtue of Will of Khasra No. 18/20, measuring 2 Bigha 8 Biswa, situated at Village Tatesar, Delhi-110081 executed by Late Smt. Gyano Devi. Late Smt. Gyano Devi expired on 01.06.2015.
Notice is hereby given that Late Smt. Gyano Devi executed a Registered Will dated 07.01.2011, Regn. No. 48, Book No. 3, Vol. No. 233, Pages 169-170, in favour of her son Sh. Kuldeep Singh, S/o Late Sh. Surat Singh.
The Will relates to agricultural land bearing Khasra No. 18/20, measuring 2 Bigha 8 Biswa, situated at Village Tatesar, Delhi-110081. Late Smt. Gyano Devi expired on 01.06.2015.
Sh. Kuldeep Singh intends to get the said property mutated in his name on the basis of the aforesaid Registered Will. Any person having any objection, claim or right in respect of the said property may submit the same with supporting documents to the undersigned within 15 days from publication of this notice, failing which no claim/objection shall be entertained.
Sd/-
DALIP MISHRA
Advocate
Ernl . No. D-1937/99
Resi. A-115/3/ Dilshal Colony Delhi-95

PUBLIC NOTICE

The public at large is hereby informed that my clients Mr. Bijender Kumar S/o Sh. Gopi Chand Mittal and Smt. Bharti W/o Mr. Bijender Kumar Both R/o 206A, DDA Flat, G/F, Satyam Enclave, Jhilmil, Shahdara, Delhi-110095 have debarred and disinherited their son Akash Mittal and his wife Smt. Priyanka from their movable and immovable properties due to their bad conduct and disobedient towards my clients and my clients have no control in any manner over them, If anyone deals with them will be at his/her/their own risk then my clients will not responsible in any manner.
Manoj kumar (Advocate)
Ch. No. 734A, Tis Hazari Courts

PUBLIC NOTICE

My client Ms. Shaveta Kataria D/o Late Shri Mahesh Kumar Kataira Resident of A-7/83, Sector-15, Rohini, Delhi, do hereby notify for public at large that She is executing the will deed of Late Smt. Suman Kataria wife of Late Shri Mahesh Kumar Katara, after her death, who expired on Dated 27.08.2026 at Delhi, as per her will made on Dated 26.12.2025, in favour of Ms. Shaveta Kataria, any person/s have any objection/claim(s) interests for this will deed of registration of aforesaid will of Late Smt. Suman Kataria, may contact the undersigned within 07 days from the publication of this notice, failing which the claim of any such person will be considered to have been waived and/or abandoned and the will Deed shall be registered and applicable with immediate effect.
Sd/-
SACHIN KUMAR (Advocate)
Enrl. No. D/2092/08

PUBLIC NOTICE

Public at large hereby informed that **Freehold DDA Built up MIG Flat No.228, Third Floor, Block-C-7, Safdarjung Development Area, New Delhi** (hereafter refer to be scheduled property) is owned by Sh. Nixon Sethi S/o Late Gulshan Rai Sethi by virtue of Relinquishment Deed vide Doc No.1495 Vol No.2712 Pages 50 to 55 dated 07.03.2019.
Original Allotment Letter dated 30.01.1970, Original Handing Over Possession Letter dated 10.03.1971, Original NOC dated 03.03.1971 for Water and Electric connection, Original Possession Letter & Original Conveyance Deed Allottee dated 30.10.1979, all issued by DDA in favour of Sh. Gulshan Rai Sethi, in respect of the captioned property is informed as lost and lost report filed with P.S. Crime Branch vide LR No. 787710/2026 dated 10.11.2026.
It is hereby notified that any person or entity, firm/ company, Bank, financial institution having claim any charge, interest or lien or claim on the basis of documents mentioned above or otherwise and /or objection thereof, he/she/they may lodge/notify the same to the undersigned with documentary proof, failing which the title shall be deemed to be clear and marketable without any defect, encumbrance, flaw and impediment.
Sh. Nixon Sethi
Mobile: 9810392002
Email: Nixon.sethi@gmail.com

PUBLIC NOTICE

Public at large hereby informed that Freehold DDA Built up MIG Flat No.228, Third Floor, Block-C-7, Safdarjung Development Area, New Delhi (hereafter refer to be scheduled property) is owned by Sh. Nixon Sethi S/o Late Gulshan Rai Sethi by virtue of Relinquishment Deed vide Doc No.1495 Vol No.2712 Pages 50 to 55 dated 07.03.2019.
Original Allotment Letter dated 30.01.1970, Original Handing Over Possession Letter dated 10.03.1971, Original NOC dated 03.03.1971 for Water and Electric connection, Original Possession Letter & Original Conveyance Deed Allottee dated 30.10.1979, all issued by DDA in favour of Sh. Gulshan Rai Sethi, in respect of the captioned property is informed as lost and lost report filed with P.S. Crime Branch vide LR No. 787710/2026 dated 10.11.2026.
It is hereby notified that any person or entity, firm/ company, Bank, financial institution having claim any charge, interest or lien or claim on the basis of documents mentioned above or otherwise and/or objection thereof, he/she/they may lodge/notify the same to the undersigned with documentary proof, failing which the title shall be deemed to be clear and marketable without any defect, encumbrance, flaw and impediment.
Sh. Nixon Sethi
Mobile: 9810392002
Email: Nixon.sethi@gmail.com

COURT NOTICE

In The High Court of Delhi At New Delhi
(Civil Appellate Jurisdiction)
Notice Under Order V Rule 20 Code of Civil Procedure
RFA 626/2025 & CM APPL. 41443/2025 & 41444/2025
Appeal against the Order dated : 20.03.2025
Passed by : Ms. Richa Gusain Solanki, DJ-02, South-West District, Dwarka Courts, New Delhi
In CS DJ ADJ No. 63/2020
BIJENDER SINGH APPELLANT(S)
VERSUS
KULDEEP SINGH & ANR RESPONDENT(S)
Notice to: Respondent 1: Sh. Kuldeep Singh Son of Devender Singh Village Samaspur Khalsa, PO Ujjwa, New Delhi-73
Whereas the above-noted appellant has presented an appeal under Section 96 CPC along with the above-mentioned application which was listed before the Court on 16.07.2025 and the Court ordered issuance of notice to you. And whereas it has been proved to the satisfaction of the Court that you cannot be served in the ordinary manner, Notice is hereby issued that, if you wish to defend the above-mentioned application, you may cause an appearance to be entered on your behalf either personally or through an advocate duly appointed by you for the purpose before **the Court of Worthy Registrar (Appellate) on 08.12.2026 (actual) at 11:a.m.**
If no appearance is made on your behalf, by yourself, your pleader or someone by law authorized to act for you in the above mentioned appeal and pending application on the aforementioned date, no further notice of the subsequent date of hearing of the said application will be given and the same will be heard and determined ex-parte in your absence.
Given under my hand and the seal of this Court on this 27th day of October, 2026
Assistant Registrar (Appl.) (Civil) for REGISTRAR GENERAL

"IMPORTANT"

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NORTH EASTERN RAILWAY

E-TENDERING NOTICE

Divisional Railway Manager (Electrical/General), North Eastern Railway, Varanasi for and on behalf of President of India, invites Online (E-Tendering) "Open/Single Tenders" for the following work. **S.N. 1. Tender Reference No:** E-Tender-L-45-26-27; **Tender Type:** Single; **Name of work:** Annual Maintenance Contract of 04 Nos. of Johnson Make Lift installed on FOB (G+1) at BNRS (02 Nos.), CPR (01 No.) & SV (01 Nos.) Railway stations through OEM for 05 Years.; **Approx. Cost (in ₹):** ₹32,33,652/-; **Earnest money (in ₹):** ₹64,700/-; **Completion Period:** 60 Months; **Date & time of Closing Tender:** 04.12.2026 at 14:30 Hrs.; **Date & time of Opening Tender:** 04.12.2026 at 14:30 Hrs.; **S.N. 2. Tender Reference No:** E-Tender-L-46-26-27; **Tender Type:** Open; **Name of work:** Electrical work connection to provision of lifts at SRU, THE, CPJ & BTT stations and allied works of BSB Division. **Approx. Cost (in ₹):** ₹26,48,323.66; **Earnest money (in ₹):** ₹53,000/-; **Completion Period:** 04 Months; **Date & time of Closing Tender:** 04.12.2026 at 14:30 Hrs.; **Date & time of Opening Tender:** 04.12.2026 at 14:30 Hrs.; **S.N. 3. Tender Reference No:** E-Tender-L-47-26-27; **Tender Type:** Open; **Name of work:** Electrical work connection to provision of Auto Relay hut in block section of BCY-CPR section (34 Nos.) under PRRB-CPR section work. **Approx. Cost (in ₹):** ₹66,24,842.20; **Earnest money (in ₹):** ₹1,32,500/-; **Completion Period:** 06 Months; **Date & time of Closing Tender:** 04.12.2026 at 14:30 Hrs.; **Date & time of Opening Tender:** 04.12.2026 at 14:30 Hrs.; For full details of above E-Tender work and to participate in tenders please visit Indian Railway website **www.ireps.gov.in.**
Sr. Divisional Electrical Engineer/ General, Varanasi
CPRO/EL-261
DO NOT SMOKE BIDI/CIGARETTE IN TRAINS

OFFICE OF THE EXECUTIVE ENGINEER TRANSMISSION LINE MAINTENANCE DIVISION II SRINAGAR PAMPORE.

Subject: Extension of e-NIT No. TLMD-II/ 06 of 2026-27 dt: 19.10.2026.

No: TLMD II/2779-81 **dt:10.11.2026.**
(Extension-I)

In view of requests received from prospective bidders, the fresh dates for e-filling of e-NIT No.TLMD-II/ 06 of 2026-27 dt: 19.10.2026 for the work **"CONSTRUCTION OF CONTROL ROOM BUILDING AT 190 MVA 132/33 KVA GRID SUB STATION AT WANPOH ON EXISTING BUILDING "** are hereby extended as detailed below:-

Last Date of online filling of e-bids	16.11.2026 up to 02:00 pm
Date of opening of e-bids	17.11.2026 at 02:00 pm

Sd/-
Executive Engineer
TLMD II Pampore

DIPK-NB-2094/26 – DATE 11 NOV 2026

OFFICE OF THE CHIEF CONSTRUCTION ENGINEER
RURAL WORKS CIRCLE, BERHAMPUR
(At/Po- Ambapua, Near Income Tax office, Berhampur-760011, Ganjam, Odisha)
25001/1539/2627
E-mail:- serwbpr2004@yahoo.com, Tel No.:-0680-2404287)

No. e-tender /6506/RWC/ BAM / Dated 10.11.26
1st Corrigendum to Bid Identification No. Online Tender/23-2026-27/BPR

1) The partial modification of Road works under **MMSY-TRIP & MMSY-CUVDA for the year 2025-26 and MMSY-IMPROVEMENT TO EXISTING RD ROAD** for the year 2026-27 vide above identification has been made as follows.

1	**Date of availability of tender**	:	20.11.2026 to 04.12.2026 upto 5.30 PM instead of 03.11.2026 to 13.11.2026 upto 5.30 PM.
2	**Last Date & Time of seeking tender clarification.**	:	02.12.2026 at 5.30 PM instead of 02.11.2026 at 5.30 PM
3	**Date of opening of Technical Bid.**	:	05.12.2026 at 11.00 AM instead of 16.11.2026 at 11.00 AM
4	**Date of opening of Financial Bid**	:	Will be intimated later on.

All other contents will remain unchanged.

Sd/-
Chief Engineer
R.W.Circle, Berhampur
OIPR-25001/25071/1/26-27/0047

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA TENDER NOTICE

SR. No.	NAME OF BOARD/CORP./ AUTH	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE (TIME)	AMOUNT / EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE BOARD CORP./AUTH	NODAL OFFICER/CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	HPGCL	NIT NO. CH-20/MP-7064/PRESSURE PARTS/2026 SUB:- OVERHAULING OF BOILER FURNACE PRESSURE PARTS AND HP VALVES FOR 250 MW, UNIT- 7, PANIPAT	10.11.2026 26.11.2026	Rs. 1,01,56,124/-	www.hpgcl.org.in	01802566015 wrmtcpkj13@gmail.com

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT : www.haryanaeprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hry.nic.in No. 50975/HRY

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA CORRIGENDUM

SR. No.	NAME OF BOARD CORP./AUTH	OLD REFERENCE/NIT NO.	NATURE OF CORRIGENDUM	WEBSITE OF THE BOARD CORP./AUTH	NODAL OFFICER/CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	HPGCL	NIT NO.67/(NGTP)/MM(I)/TOE-13506 DATED 23.10.2026 TENDER ID 2026_HBC_556269_1	CORRIGENDUM-1ST DUE DATE OF BID SUBMISSION 16.11.2026 UP TO 15:00HRS/OPENING DATE 17.11.2026 UP TO 15:30HRS. SUPPLY OF SULPHURIC ACID FOR ALL THREE POWER GENERATING STATION FOR RGTPP PTPS AND DCRTPP	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9315164637 nm1.rgtpp@hpgcl.org.in

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT : www.haryanaeprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hry.nic.in No. 50949/HRY

OFFICE OF THE MUNICIPAL CORPORATION SATNA, DIST - SATNA (M.P.)

Notice Inviting e-Tenders

No. 10/PHE/e-tendering/2026-27 **Satna, Dated: 10/11/2026**

Online tender through e-tendering is invited by **Satna Municipal Corporation (SMC)**, Satna, (M.P.) for the works of given in the table below.

S. No.	Tender No.	Name of the work	Probable amount of contract	Earnest Money Deposit (EMD) (In Rs)	Cost of Bid Document (In Rupees)	Time of Completion/ Supply
01	2026_UAD_548631_1	Operation and Maintance Works of 18 MLD, 40 MLD & 3 MLD zero liquid discharge (ZLD) existing Water Treatment plant facilities for 4Years in Satna, Madhya Pradesh (Balance work)	5,50,00,000/-	5,50,000/-	20,000/-	48 Months

1. Interested Bidder can view the NIT on website http://www.mptenders.gov.in. and www.mpurban.gov.in
2. The Bid Document can be purchased only Online 15:30 of 11.11.2026 to 17:30 of 11.12.2026.
3. Amendment to NIT, if any, would be published on website only, and not in Newspaper.

Executive Engineer
MUNICIPAL CORPORATION SATNA (M.P.)

UTTARAKHAND POWER CORPORATION LTD.
(A Govt. of Uttarakhand Undertaking)
Corporate Identity No. UA40109UP2001SGC025867/2358
Victoria Cross Vijeta Gabar Singh Urja Bhawan, Kanwali Road, Dehradun-248001
Telephone-0135-2763672-75, Fax No.0135-2760289 Website: www.uktenders.gov.in

No. 908/EE(CM)/UPCL/A-2 **E-TENDER NOTICE (NIT)** Date:- 12.11.2026

Uttarakhand Power Corporation Ltd., Dehradun invites e-tender for following as detailed below:-

S. No.	Name of Item	Tender Specification No.	Tender Qty.	Estimated Cost (in ₹)	Average yearly Turn over of Preceding three Financial Year i.e. 2023-2024, 2024-2025 & 2025-2026 (in ₹)	Earnest Money (in ₹)	Cost of tender document including GST (in ₹)	Last date & time of online request for Tender and submission of tender in online & Offline mode	Date of opening of bid Part-I in online and offline mode
1

Tamil Nadu Power Distribution Corporation Ltd.
NOTICE INVITING TENDER (NIT)

TNPDCL / LTOA / OT-Spec. No. 1 / 2026 - 2027

TNPDCL invites e-tender through Tamil Nadu Government E-Procurement Portal for Engagement of Consultant for Transaction Advisory Services and Bid process management for Long Term Power Procurement. The link for bid submission is **https://tntenders.gov.in.** Specification will be available in TN Tender National Informatics Centre (NIC) and TNPDCL website on 14.11.2026 from 11 A.M.

Chief Engineer / PPP
TNPDCL

DIPR/3578/Tender/2026

Pharmaceuticals & Medical Devices Bureau of India (PMBI)
(Under Department of Pharmaceuticals, Govt. of India)
B-500, Tower-B, 5th Floor, World Trade Centre, Nauroji Nagar, New Delhi-110029
Telephone: 011-49431800 / 49431811 / 49431834 / 49431830 / 49431874
Websites: janaushadhi.gov.in & pmbi.co.in

e-TENDER FOR SUPPLY OF ADULT AND BABY DIAPERS ON RATE CONTRACT BASIS FOR TWO YEARS

e-Tender no. **PMBI/SURGICAL/RC-241/2026** dated **31/10/2026** for supply of **Adult** and **Baby Diapers** for "Pradhan Mantri Bhartiya Janaushadhi Pariyojana (PMBJP)" are invited by PMBI. Last date and time for submission of online bids is **27/11/2026** up to **17:00 hours.** For detailed eligibility criteria, terms & conditions of the tender, please visit the websites **https://eprocure.gov.in/eprocure/app, https://janaushadhi.gov.in & pmbi.co.in.**

SD/-
CEO (PMBI)

Haryana Government Gazette
EXTRAORDINARY
Published by Authority

No. 168-2026/Ext.] CHANDIGARH, MONDAY, NOVEMBER 2, 2026 (KARTIKA 11, 1948 SAKA)

HARYANA GOVERNMENT
TOWN AND COUNTRY PLANNING DEPARTMENT
Notification

The 2nd November, 2026

No. CCP(NCR)/1779/ACA-III/Ganaur/2026/2243. Whereas, in the opinion of the Governor of Haryana, the area specified in the Schedule given below and shown in the plan appended hereto has the potential for the building activities, industrial, commercial, institutional or recreational estates/activities and uses subservient to the above.

Now, therefore, in exercise of the powers conferred under sub-section (1) of section 4 of the Haryana Scheduled Roads and Controlled Areas Restriction of Unregulated Development Act, 1963 (Punjab Act 41 of 1963), the Governor of Haryana hereby declares the said area, as specified in the Schedule given below and shown in the plan appended hereto, to be a controlled area for the purposes of the said Act, namely:-

Schedule

The schedule of boundaries of the Additional Controlled Area III, Ganaur, District Sonipat shall be read with Drawing Number DTP(S)1724/26 dated the 10th March, 2026/8th September, 2026.

North: Starting from point **'A'** i.e. the north-west corner of rectangle number 1 of village Pugthala (Hadbast Number 124) which is located on the common district boundary of district Sonipat and Panipat towards east along the common district boundary of Sonipat and Panipat upto the point 'B', where it meets the Sonipat Metropolitan area boundary already notified vide notification number 1/47/2023-1TCP dated 15th March, 2024.

East: Thence moving from point **'B'** towards south along the above said boundary of Sonipat Metropolitan area already notified on 15th March, 2024 upto point 'C' i.e. the southernmost corner of rectangle number 85 of village Naina Tatarpur (Hadbast Number 151), which is located on the southern revenue boundary of the said village.

South: Thence moving from point **'C'** towards west along the southern revenue boundary of village Naina Tatarpur (Hadbast Number 151), village Salarpur Majra (Hadbast Number 182), village Pinana (Hadbast Number 149) upto point 'D' i.e. south-west corner of rectangle number 104 of village Pinana (Hadbast Number 149), where it meets the boundary of controlled area already declared vide notification number CCP(NCR) SNP-Gohana/CA/2014/852 dated 23rd May, 2014.

West: Thence moving from point **'D'** towards north along the boundary of above said controlled area notified on 23rd May, 2014, upto point **'E',** where it meets the boundary of controlled area already declared vide notification number CCP(NCR)/SNP/Ganwari-Khanpur Kalan/ACA/2013/1673 dated 5th July, 2013. Thence, moving towards north along eastern boundary of above said controlled area notified on 5th July, 2013 upto point **'F',** which is the tri-junction of revenue boundaries of village Bajana Kalan (Hadbast Number 126), village Shamri Sisan (Hadbast Number 55) and village Shamri Lochab Barren (Hadbast Number 54). Thence moving towards north along the revenue boundaries of village Bajana Kalan (Hadbast Number 126), village Bajana Khurd (Hadbast Number 125) and village Pugthala (Hadbast Number 124) upto point 'A' i.e. the point of start.

ANURAG AGARWAL,
Additional Chief Secretary to Government Haryana,
Town and Country Planning Department.

Note: The controlled area drawing, relating to above notification, may be referred from the website **(https://www.tcpharyana.gov.in)** of the Department under **'Controlled Area'** section. Further, the said drawing can also be inspected on any working day during working hours in the office of District Town Planner, Sonipat.

No. 50962/HRY

KERALA WATER AUTHORITY e-Tender Notice

Tender No: KWA/SP-07/2026-27/LIME(RT1)
Supply and delivery of Hydrated Lime Grade C on running contract basis to various Divisions in Southern, Central and NorthernRegions of Kerala Water Authority for the year 2026-27 **EMD:** Rs. 555400 **Tender fee:** Rs. 25000 **Last Date for submitting Tender:** 19-11-2026 03:00:pm **Phone:** 8547638078 **Website:** **www.kwa.kerala.gov.in, www.etenders.kerala.gov.in**

Sd/-
Chief Engieer (HRD&GI.)
Jalabhavan
Thiruvananthapuram

KWA-JB-GL-6-427-2026-27

The Brihanmumbai Electric Supply & Transport Undertaking
(OF THE BRIHANMUMBAI MAHANAGARPALIKA)

E-Auction Notice

The E auction will be conducted in 02.12.2026 through the authorized Auctioneer Global E-Auction PVT. LTD. for the items:

Transformers, Auto Parts, C.I. Brake Drums, Various Types of Oils, Batteries, Meters, Tyres etc. will be auctioned between 9.30 am to 1.30 p.m.

Note: For more details, log on to website **https://globaleauctions.in** Tel. **9967972994 / 8286025959.**

PRO/AAM(M)/87/2026 **GENERAL MANAGER**

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 82 Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Niranjan Sah, S/o Nand Lal Sah, R/o H. No. 02, Ghewra Village, Delhi.** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 03/2025, U/s-33 Delhi Excise Act. P.S. Mundka, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Niranjan Sah** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Niranjan Sah** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Niranjan Sah** accused of **FIR No. 03/2025, U/s-33 Delhi Excise Act. P.S. Mundka, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **21.12.2026.**

By Order - Ms. Nandini Sharma
Judicial Magistrate First Class, North West
Room No. 355, Tis Hazari Court, Delhi

DP16314OD2026

"IMPORTANT"

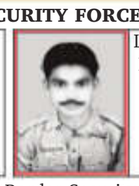
Whilst care is taken prior to acceptance of advertising copy, it is not possible to verify its contents. The Indian Express (P) Limited cannot be held responsible for such contents, nor for any loss or damage incurred as a result of transactions with companies, associations or individuals advertising in its newspapers or Publications. We therefore recommend that readers make necessary inquiries before sending any monies or entering into any agreements with advertisers or otherwise acting on an advertisement in any manner whatsoever.

SALUTE THE SOLDIER

BORDER SECURITY FORCE



LANCE NAIK KALIPADA MURMU, PMG 77 BN BSF 30.06.1946 – 13.11.1971



LANCE NAIK AMAL KUMAR MONDAL, VIR CHAKRA 77 BN BSF 03.06.1945 – 13.11.1971

Director General and all Ranks of Border Security Force remember its gallant Jawans, Lance Naiks Kalipada Murmu and Amal Kumar Mondal on their Balidan Diwas. On this day, they sustained fatal bullet injuries during 1971 Indo-Pak war in area of enemy BOP Khanpur, East Pakistan and made ultimate sacrifice in the line of duty. Their sacrifices and gallant actions have been aptly recognized by GOI by awarding them with PMG and Vir Chakra (Posthumously) respectively.



SH S VINOD SHARMA, COMMANDANT, PMG 60 BN BSF 24.10.1954 – 13.11.1998



SUB INSPECTOR BIR SINGH, PMG 60 BN BSF 05.07.1951 – 13.11.1998



CONSTABLE T JOHN KENNEDY, PMG 60 BN BSF 31.07.1969 – 13.11.1998

Director General and all Ranks of Border Security Force remember its gallant Officer Sh S Vinod Sharma, Commandant, Subordinate Officer Sub Inspector Bir Singh & Constable T John Kennedy on their Balidan Diwas. On this day, they sustained fatal bullet injuries while fighting militants in Srinagar area, J&K and made ultimate sacrifice in the line of duty. Their sacrifice and gallant action have been aptly recognized by GOI by awarding them with PMG (Posthumously).



CONSTABLE RAN SINGH 19 BN SSF 25.06.1970 – 13.11.1992

Director General and all Ranks of Border Security Force remember its gallant Jawan, Constable Ran Singh on his Balidan Diwas. On this day, he sustained fatal bullet injuries while fighting militants in Pulwama area, J&K and made ultimate sacrifice in the line of duty.



SUB INSPECTOR RAKESH DHOBAL, PMG 1011 ARTY MARTYED ON-13.11.2020

Director General and all Ranks of Border Security Force remember its gallant Subordinate Officer, Sub Inspector Rakesh Dhobal on his Balidan Diwas. On this day, he sustained fatal bullet injuries in counterpart firing in Handwara area, J&K and made ultimate sacrifice in the line of duty. His sacrifice and gallant action have been aptly recognized by GOI by awarding him with PMG (Posthumously).



SH V R K NAIR, COMMANDANT 90 BN BSF 02.03.1952 TO 13.11.2000

Director General and all Ranks of Border Security Force remember its gallant Officer Shri V R K Nair, Commandant on his Balidan Diwas. On 12th November 2000, he sustained fatal injuries while on operational duty in Sir-Creek area, Gujarat and later succumbed to his injuries on 13th November 2000.

CENTRAL RESERVE POLICE FORCE



Veer Balidani Constable Shishupal Singh Bhadauria 179 Bn 10-1-1987 To 13-11-2007

DG and all Ranks of #CRPF pay solemn tribute to Constable Shishupal Singh Bhadauria of 179 Bn, who made the supreme sacrifice on 13 November 2007 after sustaining grievous injuries during a fierce encounter with militants in Sopore, Baramulla, J&K on 11 November 2007. CRPF salutes the braveheart and pledges never to let his sacrifice go in vain.



Veer Balidani Shri Bhupinder Singh Dy. Comdt. 8 Bn 17-8-1975 To 13-11-2009



Veer Balidani Constable Sunil Kumar 8 Bn 1-9-1979 To 13-11-2009



Veer Balidani Constable/Driver Narendra Singh 8 Bn 1-4-1980 To 13-11-2009

DG and all Ranks of #CRPF pay solemn tribute to three valiant troopers of 8 Bn, who made the supreme sacrifice while valiantly retaliating against a Maoist ambush in dist. Malkangiri, Odisha, on 13 November 2009. CRPF salutes the bravehearts and pledges never to let their sacrifice go in vain.

AP POWER GENERATION CORPORATION Ltd.,
VS, VIJAYAWADA - 520004
(A Govt. of A.P. Undertaking)

Notification for AP e-Procurement TENDER ID.No.1005861

APGENCO invites open tenders "R&M of HVAC System for Units 1 & 2 (2x210 MW) of Stage-I at Dr.NTTPS, Ibrahimpatnam" through AP e-procurement. EVC Rs. 2,76,60,407/-
Schedule available Date & Time : 10.11.2026- onwards
Bid submission Closing Date & Time: 11.12.2026- 13:00 Hrs
For further details visit **https://tender.apeprocurement.gov.in**

R.No.- 5554PP/CL/ADVT/1/1//2021-22 Dt: 12.11.2026

BENGALURU SOUTH CITY CORPORATION
Office of the Executive Engineer, Electrical Division,
BSCC, 4th Floor, Jayanagara Shopping Complex Building,
9 Main, Jayanagara 4th Block, Bengaluru - 560 011

No: EE/ELE/BSCC/PR/286/2026-27 Date:12-11-2026

CORRIGENDUM

Sub: Corrigendum pertaining to change in Date of closure and opening of Tender BIDS.

Ref: Tender Notification No: EE/ELE/S/TND/04/2026-27, Dt: 05-11-2026.

Corrigendum is hereby issued indicating change in scheduled closure and opening Dates of tender bids for the works vide reference tender notification. Modified Date shall be read and construed as below.

Modified Date : Tenders must be submitted online through KPP portal on or before **4:00** pm on Date: **25-11-2026** and Technical Bid / Tender shall be opened on Date: **26-11-2026** at **4.30** pm. The financial bids will be opened on **30-11-2026** at **4:00** pm

Sd/- Executive Engineer (Ele), BNCC

GOVT. OF N.C.T. OF DELHI
DEPARTMENT OF FOREST & WILDLIFE
OFFICE OF THE DEPUTY CONSERVATOR OF FORESTS
WEST FOREST DIVISION, MANDIR LANE, NEW DELHI-60
E-Mail: dcfwest.gnctd@gov.in

NOTICE INVITING E - TENDER

An e-tender has been invited for "Supply of Nursery Input Materials For raising 8.00 lakh saplings for the year 2027-28 under West Forest Division **(Tender Id 2026_DYCFW_301183_1)"** In case the tenderer/Bidder has any doubt about the meaning of anything contained in the tender document, he shall seek clarification from the office of the Dy. Conservator of Forests, West Forest Division, Deptt. of Forest & Wildlife, GNCT of Delhi, Mandir Lane, Delhi-110060.

The tentative cost of the tendered work is estimated as be is Rs. 7,40,32,537/-(Rupees Seven Crores Forty Lakhs Thirty-Two Thousand Five Hundred and Thirty-Seven Only).

The details of submission of bid are as follows:

Date of release of Tender through e-procurement portal of Delhi Govt	12.11.2026 at 06:00 PM
Start date/time for downloading of tender	12.11.2026 at 06:00 PM
Date of Pre-bid meeting	17.11.2026 at 01:00 PM
Start date/time for submission/ uploading the tender documents	18.11.2026 at 06:00 PM
Last date/time for submission/ uploading the tender documents	26.11.2026 at 10:00 AM
Date and time of opening of Technical Bid	26.11.2026 at 11:00 AM
Date and time of opening of Financial Bid	Will be intimated

The last date of submission of bids is 26.11.2026 up to 10:00 AM. For any further query, contact the O/o Dy. Conservator of Forests, West Forest Division at Mandir Lane, Delhi - 110060.

Website link :- **https://govtprocurement.delhi.gov.in/**

Sd/-
DEPUTY CONSERVATOR OF FORESTS
DIP/Shabdarth/Classified/0288/26-27 **WEST FOREST DIVISION**

UP Rajya Vidyut Utpadan Nigam Ltd.
Anpara Sonebhadra

E-Tender Notice

E-Tender Notice and scope of work

1. **E-Tender- GEM/2026/B/8253310,** Complete operation and maintenance of CHP and other works of 2x500MW, DTPS, Anpara." EMD Rs. 35,00,000.00, Last date of tender: 07.12.2026 (14:00 Hrs).
2. **E-Tender- GEM/2026/B/8220336,** Repairing of damaged seal trough plate, fixing of s.s. net and seal plate in position by application of required fasteners in unit #6 during opportunity shutdown at DTPS, Anpar." EMD Rs. 5,000.00, Last date of tender: 26.11.2026 (18:00 Hrs).
3. **E-Tender- GEM/2026/B/8239039,** Construction of R.C.C. road of Anpara thermal power station." EMD Rs. 20,96,500.00, period: 06 Months, Last date of tender: 25.11.2026 (16:00 Hrs).
4. **E-Tender- W-ANP/A/OGD/6000012298,** Repair and re-rubber lining of DM plant equipment, acid storage tanks, pipelines, neutralizing pits and alkali area flooring & mastic lining works of DM plant ATPS, Anpara." EMD Rs. 65,000.00, Last date of tender: 28.11.2026 (19:00 Hrs).
5. **E-Tender- GEM/2026/B/8254191,** Installation of in house brick manufacturing unit at Anpara thermal power station." EMD Rs. 36,300.00, Last date of tender: 27.11.2026 (16:00 Hrs).

For information regarding addendum corrigendum rejection of Bids kindly regularly visit website **https: etender.up.nic.in** or **https://gem.gov.in.**

पत्रांक: 3331/मु०अभि० (स्तर–1)/अ०ता०/कला अनु० Date: 12.11.2026

"Save Electricity for Nation"

SUGARFED PUNJAB
(The Punjab State Federation of Cooperative Sugar Mills Ltd.)
Plot No. 53, Phase-II (Opposite Bassi Cinema), S.A.S Nagar (Mohali)

E-tender Notice-2026-27

Supply, Erection and Commissioning of :-

1. Hydraulic Rotating Truck/Trolley Tippler 50 Ton Capacity for Batala and Bhogpur Coop. Sugar Mill.
2. IC Sugar Grader alongwith Other Units i.e, Sugar Bin, Automatic Weighing System, Sugar Elevator, Dry Seed Conveyor, and Sugar Bag Conveyer System for Godowns etc., Fluidized Bed Dryer (FBD) Etc. Including Complete Civil Works for Morinda (2500 TCD), Budhewal(1250 TCD) and Nakodar (1250 TCD) Coop. Sugar Mills.
3. Engineering, Procurement and Construction (EPC) for Supply, Erection and Commissioning of Machinery and Equipment's in the Boiling House for upgradation and Modernization at existing crushing capacity of 3000 TCD of Sugar Factory (Incl. Complete Civil Work) at Bhogpur Coop. Sugar Mill Ltd.
4. Design, Construction of RCC Foundation, Supply, Fabrication, Erection, Installation, Testing and Commissioning of a New 6000 m^3 Molasses storage Tank at Gurdaspur Coop. Sugar Mill Ltd.

All Other Technical and Commercial Terms as per Tender Document.

Details are available on website: https://eproc.punjab.gov.in
For participating in the above e-tendering process, the bidders shall have to get themselves registered with https://eproc.punjab.gov.in and get user ID, Password. Class-3 Digital Signature is mandatory to participate in the e-tendering process. For any clarification/difficulty regarding e- tendering process flow, enrollment please contact help desk of NIC on 0172-2970263, 0172- 2970284.

Managing Director

MUTHOOT FINCORP LTD. | GOLD AUCTION NOTICE

Regd. Office: Muthoot Centre, TC No 27/3022, Punnen Road, Thiruvananthapuram, Kerala, India - 695001. CIN : U65929KL1997PLC011518, Ph: +91 471 4911400, 2331427.

Notice is hereby given for the information of all concerned that gold ornaments pledged with under mentioned branches of the company , which were overdue for redemption and which have not been redeemed so for in spite of repeated notices will be auctioned on 15.12.2026 from 10 am onwards.

Auction Date: 15.12.2026 - BIJNOR DISTRICT - CIVIL LINES-BIJNOR: 4370001943, 4370001981, 4370002035, 4370002093, 4370002132, 4370002163, 4370002223, 4370002231, 4370002235, 4370002246, 4370002249, 4370002253, 4370002262, 4370002274, 4370002356, 4370002383, 4370002474, 4370002525, 4370002536, 4370002595, 4370002646, 4370002718, 4370002728, 4370002737, 4370002777, 4370002780, 4370002896, 4370002901, 4370002938, 4370002944, 4370002973, 4370002996, 4370003018, 4370003034, 4370003045, 4370003053, 4370003121, 4370003124, 4370003135, 4370003182, 4370003183, 4370003235, 4370003338, 4370003343, 4370003373, 4370003405, 4370003431, 4370003455, 4370003603, 4370004869, 4370004871, 4370005028. **NAJIBABAD:** 4384001023, 4384001030, 4384001063, 4384001164, 4384001191, 4384001218, 4384001344, 4384001349, 4384001407, 4384001409, 4384001410, 4384001432, 4384001479, 4384001518, 4384001538, 4384001553, 4384001653, 4384001658, 4384001685, 4384001698, 4384001714, 4384001728, 4384001729, 4384001739, 4384001740, 4384002508. **Auction Date: 15.12.2026 - HAPUR DISTRICT - FREEGANJ HAPUR:** 4319001617, 4319001664, 4319002446, 4319003095, 4319003381, 4319003571, 4319003631, 4319003701, 4319003708, 4319003737, 4319003759, 4319003774, 4319003854, 4319003902, 4319003914, 4319003939, 4319003966, 4319003970, 4319003997, 4319004004, 4319004006, 4319004008, 4319004016, 4319004032, 4319004040, 4319004086, 4319004116, 4319004126, 4319004202, 4319004213, 4319004254, 4319004256, 4319004281, 4319004357, 4319004368, 4319004404, 4319004435, 4319004487, 4319004490, 4319004499, 4319004510, 4319004516, 4319004527, 4319004528, 4319004534, 4319004550, 4319004553, 4319004579, 4319004581, 4319004591, 4319004607, 4319004641, 4319004691, 4319004716, 4319004749, 4319004807, 4319004809, 4319004836, 4319004839, 4319004869, 4319004882, 4319004887, 4319004888, 4319004898, 4319004899, 4319006151, 4319006180, 8000724319, 8000794319, 8000834319, 8001134319, 8001164319, 8001394319, 8001744319, 8001784319, 8001794319, 8001874319, 8001884319, 8001894319, 8001904319. **Auction Date: 15.12.2026 - MEERUT DISTRICT - BAGPAT ROAD-MEERUT:** 1868000309, 1868000432, 1868000438, 1868003765, 1868003858, 1868004046, 1868004167, 1868004193, 1868004267, 1868004279, 1868004297, 1868004317, 1868004327, 1868004335, 1868004348, 1868004366, 1868004369, 1868004379, 1868004398, 1868004447, 1868004449, 1868004490, 1868004493, 1868004498, 1868004526, 1868004532, 1868004535, 1868004543, 1868004545, 1868004551, 1868004563, 1868004566, 1868004567, 1868004568, 1868004621, 1868004625, 1868004630, 1868004632, 1868004642, 1868004654, 1868004660, 1868004671, 1868004706, 1868004708, 1868004738, 1868004741, 1868004744, 1868004771, 1868004796, 1868004802, 1868004803, 1868004809, 1868004823, 1868004861, 1868004863, 1868004865, 1868004875, 1868004885, 1868004893, 1868004900, 1868004904, 1868004940, 1868004944, 1868004970, 1868005051, 1868005064, 1868005081, 1868005090, 1868005103, 1868005125, 1868005127, 1868005173, 1868005174, 1868005208, 1868005226, 1868005233, 1868005239, 1868005243, 1868005271, 1868005273, 1868005283, 1868005306, 1868005319, 1868005331, 1868005341, 1868005352, 1868005366, 1868005383, 1868005408, 1868005410, 1868005415, 1868005443, 1868005450, 1868005664, 1868005665, 1868005666, 1868005671, 1868005674, 1868005704, 1868005714, 1868005736, 1868005759, 1868005760, 1868005790, 1868005799, 1868005802, 1868005817, 1868005823, 1868005825, 1868005850, 1868005866, 1868006415, 1868007013, 1868007051, 1868007060, 1868007077, 1868007130. **EVES ROAD-MEERUT:** 1867000875, 1867001983, 1867003551, 1867003559, 1867003605, 1867003623, 1867003656, 1867003682, 1867003734, 1867003742, 1867003753, 1867003783, 1867003785, 1867003799, 1867003803, 1867003854, 1867003867, 1867003868, 1867003889, 1867003892, 1867003913, 1867003915, 1867003938, 1867003949, 1867003955, 1867003971, 1867003986, 1867003996, 1867004003, 1867004009, 1867004083, 1867004154, 1867004159, 1867004174, 1867004187, 1867004188, 1867004220, 1867004231, 1867004247, 1867004254, 1867004269, 1867004292, 1867004305, 1867004348, 1867004357, 1867004369, 1867004411, 1867004433, 1867004452, 1867004464, 1867004468, 1867004497, 1867004499, 1867004508, 1867004547, 1867004570, 1867004605, 1867004624, 1867004662, 1867004694, 1867004708, 1867004710, 1867004737, 1867004739, 1867004748, 1867004752, 1867004777, 1867004783, 1867004802, 1867004805, 1867004809, 1867004810, 1867004811, 1867004823, 1867004832, 1867004840, 1867004848, 1867004871, 1867004872, 1867004880, 1867004890, 1867004916. **SHASTRI NAGAR-MEERUT:** 1852000502, 1852000505, 1852000517, 1852000518, 1852000526, 1852000554, 1852000558, 1852000563, 1852000564, 1852000565, 1852000695, 1852003754, 1852003777, 1852003812, 1852003834, 1852003846, 1852003864, 1852003869, 1852003924, 1852003925, 1852003927, 1852003929, 1852003980, 1852004035, 1852004040, 1852004082, 1852004090, 1852004118, 1852004155, 1852004163, 1852004166, 1852004209, 1852004210, 1852004212, 1852004214, 1852004230, 1852004231, 1852004242, 1852004249, 1852004267, 1852004300, 1852004312, 1852004328, 1852004330, 1852004377, 1852004412, 1852004422, 1852004423, 1852004470, 1852004486, 1852004539, 1852004643, 1852004714, 1852004735, 1852004898, 1852005105, 1852005116, 1852005136, 1852005147, 1852005180, 1852005188, 1852005210, 1852005216, 1852005224, 1852005253, 1852005271, 1852005273, 1852005274, 1852005298, 1852005304, 1852005316, 1852005317, 1852006463, 1852006492, 1852006514, 1852006521. **Auction Date: 15.12.2026 - SHAMLI DISTRICT - SHAMLI:** 4505000083, 4505000302, 4505000334, 4505000341, 4505000344, 4505000351, 4505000354, 4505000373, 4505000437, 4505000438, 4505000469, 4505000478, 4505000483, 4505000536, 4505000549, 4505000550, 4505000566, 4505000571, 4505000591, 4505000598, 4505000630, 4505000636, 4505000696, 4505000708, 4505000718, 4505000726, 4505000734, 4505000762, 4505001268.

Auction will be conducted at respective branches. please note if the auction does not get completed on the same day due to any reasons, the same will be conducted on 26.12.2026 at 10.00 am onwards at MEERUT DISTRICT - SHASTRI NAGAR-MEERUT: GROUND FLOOR, MUTHOOT FINCORP LTD , GROUND FLOOR NO C- 2/6 CENTRAL MARKET SHASTRI NAGAR MEERUT DIST-250002 UTTAR PRADESH, CENTRAL MARKET SHASTRI NAGAR OPPOSITE PANKAJ GARMENTS, NEARIDBI BANK , MEERUT, UTTAR PRADESH , 250004 .The bidders are requested to produce photo id card ,Pan card .The successful bidder should transfer the money through RTGS.

MUTHOOT FINCORP LTD

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA TENDER NOTICE

SR. No.	NAME OF BOARD/CORP./AUTH	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE (TIME)	AMOUNT / EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE BOARD CORP./AUTH	NODAL OFFICER/CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	MUNICIPAL CORPORATION FARIDABAD	ROUGH COST ESTIMATE FOR REPAIR, MAINTENANCE OF (MOTORS, PUMP, STARTER ETC.) BOOSTING STATION OF SECTOR 29,30 IN WARD NO. 30 FOR A PERIOD OF 1 YEARS, DIV. V. + 13 WORKS	10.11.2026 17.11.2026	1,96,31,491/-	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	01292411649 xenmcf5@gmail.com
2	MUNICIPAL CORPORATION FARIDABAD	ESTIMATE FOR PROVIDING AND LAYING RMC M-25 GRADE AT H.NO.894 TO 911, H.NO.1041 TO 1031, H.NO.1005 TO 1013, H.NO.977 TO 983, H.NO.975 TO 966, H.NO.943 TO 932, H.NO.1061 TO 1053,H.NO. 1030 TO 1020, H.NO.992 TO 987, H.NO.965 TO 964, H.NO.921 TO 925, H.NO.1042 TO 1045, H.NO.1045 TO 920, RAM KIRAT WALI GALI H.NO.1077/40 IN BLOCK C, SGM NAGAR IN WARD NO. - 18,(NEW WARD) BADKHAL CONSTITUENCY, FARIDABAD + 12 WORKS	10.11.2026 17.11.2026	3,55,49,371/-	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	01292411649 mcfamrut1@gmail.com

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT : www.haryanaeprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hry.nic.in **No. 50950/HRY**

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA TENDER NOTICE

SR NO	NAME OF DEPARTMENT	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE	AMOUNT / EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE DEPARTMENT	NODAL OFFICER/CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	PWD B&R, ROHTAK	FACILITIES FOR DIFFERENTLY ABLED PERSONS IN THE JUDICIAL COURT COMPLEX, JIND IN DISTRICT JIND (PROVIDING 15 PASSENGER LIFT ONLY) + 3 WORKS	11.11.2026 18.11.2026	27.90 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9034929655 pwdeeedrohtak1@gmail.com
2	PWD B&R, SIRSA	DNIT FOR SPECIAL REPAIR OF ROAD FROM JIWAN NAGAR TO SAINPAL VIA KARIWALA KM 0.00 TO 18.90 (ROAD ID:5899) IN SIRSA DISTT. IN RANIA CONSTITUENCY UNDER HEAD-3054 (GROUP-4) (WITHOUT GST) + 1 WORKS	11.11.2026 23.11.2026	821.61 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	01666222959 pwd-eepd2-sirsa@hry.nic.in
3	PWD B&R, SIRSA	DNIT FOR CONSTRUCTION OF TEHSIL BUILDING AT NATHUSARI CHOPTA IN SIRSA DISTT.(WITHOUT GST)	11.11.2026 26.11.2026	738.29 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	01666222959 pwd-eepd2-sirsa@hry.nic.in
4	PANCHAYATI RAJ, KURUKSHETRA	LAYING OF RCC PIPELINE FROM DISPENSARY TO POND UNDER DISTT. VILLAGE - DHANAGLI, BLOCK - SHAHABAD(M) DISTT. PLAN SCHEME. + 2 WORKS	11.11.2026 18.11.2026	34.16 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9896224357 prexeeng.krk@hry.nic.in
5	PANCHAYATI RAJ, FARIDABAD	CONSTRUCTION OF RAIN WATER HARVESTING SYSTEM IN SC CHAUPAL AT VILLAGE SIDHOLA BLOCK FARIDABAD DISTRICT FARIDABAD VANGY + 9 WORKS	10.11.2026 18.11.2026	106.30 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9467905067 prexeeng.fbd1@gmail.com
6	PUBLIC HEALTH ENGINEERING, HISAR	FOR HIRING OF HYDRA MACHINE AND JCB , TRACTOR TROLLY, AT VARIOUS LOCATION UNDER JURISDICTION OF PHESD NO.2 HISAR + 3 WORKS	CLOSING DATE 18.11.2026	37.78 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	01662-247033 eephisar@gmail.com
7	IRRIGATION & WATER RESOURCES DEPARTMENT HARYANA, ROHTAK	SUPPLY, ERECTION AND COMMISSIONING OF 03 NO. DG SETS OF DIFFERENT CAPACITY AS PER SITE CONDITION AT PERMANENT PUMP HOUSES AT RD 5750 OF PILANA MINOR, RD 169500 OF KAHANAUR DISTY., RD 8000 (SANGHI-I PUMP HOUSE) OF SANGHI MINOR AND RD 10000 OF JINDRAN PUMP HOUSE.	CLOSING DATE 18.11.2026	35.79 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9812111077 xenwsdnrtk@gmail.com
8	IRRIGATION & WATER RESOURCES DEPARTMENT HARYANA, ROHTAK	REPAIRING DAMAGED LINING PATCH AT VARIOUS RDS OF ASANDA MINOR YEAR 2026 - 2027.	CLOSING DATE 17.11.2026	1.43 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9464040970 xensampla@gmail.com
9	IRRIGATION & WATER RESOURCES DEPARTMENT HARYANA, FATEHABAD	CLEARANCE OF BUSHES AND VEGETATION OF KHERI DISTY FROM RD 69000-157500 + 2 WORKS	CLOSING DATE 16.11.2026	16.04 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9466751554 xenwsdivisionfbd@yahoo.com
10	HARYANA ROADWAYS, JHAJJAR	E- TENDER FOR HIRING OF ACTIVITY I.E 1 CLEANING OF BUSES WITH BROOM. 2 WASHING OF BUSES HARYANA ROADWAYS, JHAJJAR.	20.11.2026 08.12.2026	50,000/-	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9812676073 gmhrjjr@gmail.com

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT www.etenders.hry.nic.in **No. 50969/HR**

TAMILNADU MEDICAL SERVICES CORPORATION LIMITED
(A Government of Tamilnadu Undertaking)
No. 417, Pantheon Road, Egmore, Chennai - 600 008. Phone: 044-2819 1890, 2819 0259
Website: www.tnmsc.tn.gov.in E-Mail: gmdrug.tnmsc@tn.gov.in, mngrpurdrug.tnmsc@tn.gov.in

Online Tenders is invited by the Tender Inviting Authority, Tamilnadu Medical Services Corporation Limited, Chennai – 600008, from the bidders meeting the eligibility criteria indicated in the tender document for the supply of **Food for Special Medical Purposes for Rare Diseases** to TNMSC Ltd for one year from the date of acceptance of the tender.

Sl. No.	Description	e-Tender Reference	Tender Floating Period	e-Tender Submission Duration	Date and time of online opening of Technical Bids
1.	Online Re-Tender for the supply of **Food for Special Medical Purposes for Rare Diseases** to TNMSC Limited under rate contract system for one year from the date of acceptance	e-028/M(P)/ RE-FSMP-ICH/ TNMSC/2026, Dated. 13.11.2026	13.11.2026 at 4.00 PM to 15.12.2026 upto 3.00 PM	24.11.2026 at 10.00 AM to 15.12.2026 upto 3.00 PM	15.12.2026 at 4.00 PM

The tender document can be downloaded and the tender shall be submitted at **https://tntenders.gov.in/.** The tender document can also be downloaded at **www.tnmsc.tn.gov.in** for reference purpose.

DIPR/3557/Tender/2026

Tender Inviting Authority / General Manager (Drugs)

NPCL
NOIDA POWER COMPANY LIMITED

Noida Power Company Limited
Electric Sub Station, Knowledge Park-IV, Greater Noida-201310
(CIN: U31200UP1992PLC014506)

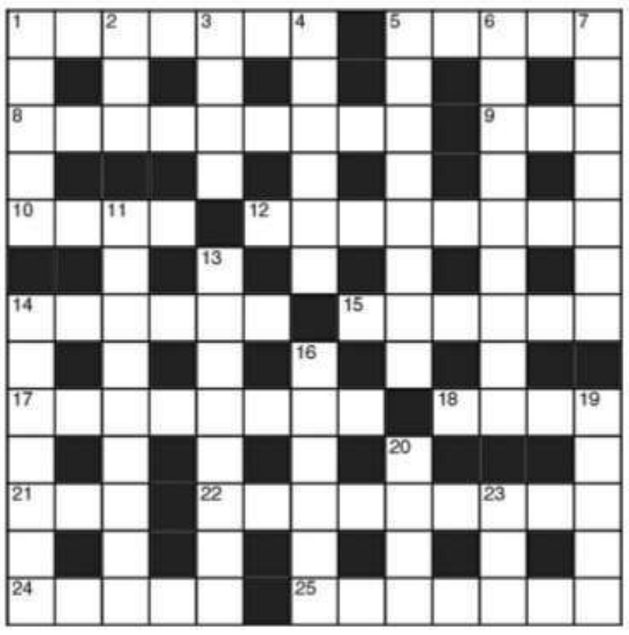
TENDER NOTICE **Date: 13-11-2026**

e-Tender (Commercial & Technical) are invited for following, from all interested bidders

NIT No.	Tender Description	EMD (Rs.)	Start and Due Date & Time of Submission
NIT No..: NPCL/FY26-27/ Fixed Asset Verification/041	Appointment of Consultant for Physical Verification and Reconciliation of Fixed Assets of NPCL	2.00 Lac	13.11.2026 & 04.12.2026 (up to 15:00 hours)

Cost of individualTender Document (Incl. GST) Rs 1180/-
For other tender details and further amendment/corrigendum, please visit our website **www.noidapower.com-

• CROSSWORD 6145



ACROSS

1 Small dining chairs (7)
5 She gets fruit by the pound (5)
8 In favour of seeing prior measures made (9)
9 Company has nothing to sound happy about (3)
10 Principal parts in a play (4)
12 Beats again and drives back (8)
14 Arrangement designed to bury the hatchet (4,2)
15 Go faster in the present though beaten in the past (6)
17 Incline to wither in general (8)
18 A shade depressed (4)
21 Add a little rum (3)
22 Non-stop flight (9)
24 Accepted types and not writing (5)
25 It causes a hold-up in some bottleneck (7)

DOWN

1 A pie's turned nice shade of brown (5)
2 Article on travel in the past (3)
3 One's repeatedly seeing a goddess (4)
4 He was instrumental in detecting radiation (6)
5 One suspended from the works for timekeeping (8)
6 Down the line from Lancaster (9)
7 Regards a paternal admonition (5,2)
11 Accept later that you are a chip off the old block (4,5)
13 Elizabeth includes us in commercial enterprise (8)
14 Not a stone upturned of enormous weight (7)
16 Seeks admission for strikes (6)
19 It's a mistake to be led astray over gold (5)
20 A number given to someone to sing (4)
23 A washer may need it and vice versa (3)

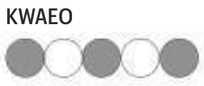
SOLUTIONS CROSSWORD 6144 ACROSS: 1 Farewell, 5 Trip, 9 Rumba, 10 Spooner, 11 Pressing need, 13 Hassle, 14 Inures, 17 Capital gains, 20 Implore, 21 Ellen, 22 Gist, 23 Vendetta DOWN: 1 Faro, 2 Remarks, 3 Weak solution, 4 Lassie, 6 Range, 7 Parodist, 8 Forging ahead, 12 Checking, 15 Ringlet, 16 Sleeve, 18 Pipes, 19 Anna

JUMBLED WORDS

Given below are four jumbled words. Solve the jumbles to make proper words and move them to the respective circles below. Select the letters in the shaded circles and jumble them to get the answer for the given quip.

A __ is a static thing that one moves through; a __ is a dynamic thing that moves past one. — Kenneth Tynan (5,.,4)

KWAEO



HISXNP



ETULL



CNOOVY



SOLUTIONS: Awoke, Tulle, Sphinx, Convoy
ANSWER: A **novel** is a static thing that one moves through; a **play** is a dynamic thing that moves past one. - Kenneth Tynan

• OVER THE HEDGE

BY MICHAEL FRY & T LEWIS



• CALVIN & HOBBES

BY BILL WATTERSON



• MARVIN

BY TOM ARMSTRONG



SUDOKU 6501

DIFFICULTY LEVEL 4s INSTRUCTIONS

To solve a Sudoku puzzle, every digit from 1 to 9 must appear in each of the nine vertical columns, in each of the nine horizontal rows and in each of the nine boxes.

DIFFICULTY LEVEL
1s = Very easy; 2s = Easy;
3s = Medium; 4s = Hard;
5s = Very Hard;
6s = Genius

			1					6
					3		8	
	7	5			8	9	4	
		3				4		
7	6						1	3
		8				6		
	1	7	4			8	5	
	2		9					
5					7			

SOLUTION SUDOKU 6500

3	7	9	1	4	2	6	5	8
4	8	1	6	9	5	3	2	7
5	2	6	7	3	8	1	9	4
6	5	8	4	7	3	2	1	9
2	1	7	8	5	9	4	3	6
9	3	4	2	1	6	7	8	5
8	4	3	5	2	7	9	6	1
7	9	5	3	6	1	8	4	2
1	6	2	9	8	4	5	7	3

• ROYAL STARS

BY GEORGIA NICOLS

ARIES (MAR 21 - APR 20): Today, both Venus and Mercury stop their retrograde motion, which will help clarify your dealings with partners and other people, as well as discussions about inheritances and shared property. Increased clarity will shine. Tonight: You're admired.

TAURUS (APR 21 - MAY 21): Mercury has been opposite your sign since, confusing matters and attracting people from your past back into your world. Starting today, you'll feel more confident when dealing with others as issues will be more straightforward. Tonight: Do something different.

GEMINI (MAY 22 - JUNE 21): Mercury has been retrograding for the last three weeks, creating goofy errors, delays and misplaced items. As of today, all of this will return to "normal." Tonight: Check your finances.

CANCER (JUNE 22 - JULY 23): Life will flow more smoothly now. Your home life will run more efficiently, you'll be confident in arranging social situations and going out to chat with others. Tonight: Listen and cooperate.

LEO (JULY 24 - AUG 23): For the last several weeks, home repairs and dealing with family matters made demands on your time. As of today, both Mercury and Venus will start to move forward, and you will feel this shift of energy as well. It's all good. Tonight: Work to get better organised.

VIRGO (AUG 24 - SEP 23): Your ruler Mercury is no longer retrograde as of today, which is extremely good news, as in the last three weeks, transportation delays, confused communications and silly errors in writing and negotiating have been irritating. Enjoy your day. Tonight: Socialise.

LIBRA (SEP 24 - OCT 23): Your ruler Venus has been retrograding, which indirectly created delays and difficulties in keeping track of everything. Too many loose ends started to fall off and you didn't care. You had to survive! This stress is over. Tonight: Relax at home.

SCORPIO (OCT 24 - NOV 23): Mercury has been retrograding in your sign for the last three weeks. Today this stops. This means you can move forward with your plans with more confidence. You'll also feel more like you're on top of your scene. Tonight: An interesting discussion.

SAGITTARIUS (NOV 24 - DEC 22): Starting today, your confidence will be more restored, which will benefit your dealings with friends, groups and organisations. You won't feel like things are "off." Things will more easily settle in place. Tonight: Maintain your belongings.

CAPRICORN (DEC 23 - JAN 20): It's been interesting hearing from old friends, as of today, this influence is over, which means you can feel more confident about moving ahead to achieve your goals.Helpful bosses and authority figures will be more forthcoming. Tonight: You win!

AQUARIUS (JAN 21 - FEB 19): You have felt like you've been taking one step forward and two steps back. The universe was not flowing with you. As of today, this stops, and you can feel more confident about what you do. Tonight: Enjoy privacy.

PISCES (FEB 20 - MAR 20): In the past six weeks, money delays and financial issues might have been a crunch. Even travel suffered from goofy mistakes and last-minute changes. Starting today, all of these areas will run more smoothly. Tonight: Be friendly.

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 CrPc / 84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Gaurav Chauhan S/o Prathvi Raj Singh R/o 226 Village Salahe Nagar, Loni, Distt. Ghaziabad, Uttar Pardesh** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case registered vide **Cr. Case 3017/2021 U/S 411 IPC, PS Wazirabad, New Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest their upon issued that the said accused **Gaurav Chauhan** can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Gaurav Chauhan** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Gaurav Chauhan** of **Cr. Case 3017/2021 U/S 411 IPC, PS Wazirabad, New Delhi** is required to appear before this court (or before me) to answer the complaint on or before the day of **14.12.2026.**

By Order,
Sh. Aakash Mohan Singh
Judicial Magistrate First Class - 12
Central, Room No. 264, 2nd Floor
Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi

DP/16316/N/2026(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Mohd. Ashiq @ Mohd. Ashish, S/o: Mohd. Murshid, R/o: H.No-115, F-7,W-49, Sultanpuri, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No.: 1296/2022, U/s: 380/411 IPC, P.S. Nihal Vihar, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Mohd. Ashiq @ Mohd. Ashish** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Mohd. Ashiq @ Mohd. Ashish** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Mohd. Ashiq @ Mohd. Ashish** of **P.S. Nihal Vihar, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **14.12.2026.**

By Order
Ms. Shruti Saraswat
Ld. JMFC-03, Room No. 292,
Tis Hazari Court, Delhi

DP/16320/OD/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr. P.C./84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Prashant @ Chotu Bangali** S/o Fool Prashad R/o 197, Nehru Market, Badarpur (East), Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence FIR No. 210/22 u/s 411 IPC at P.S. Kalyanpuri, Delhi and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Prashant @ Chotu Bangali** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Prashant @ Chotu Bangali** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proceeding u/s 82 Cr. P.C./84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita has been initiated in the case. Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Prashant @ Chotu Bangali** accused of FIR No. 210/22 u/s 411 IPC at P.S. Kalyanpuri, Delhi is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **17.12.2026.**

By Order: Ms. Prigya Gupta,
Chief Judicial Magistrate (East)
Room No: 29,
Karkardooma Court, Delhi

DP/16287/ED/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 CrPC / 84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Amit Mehroliya S/o** Mahipal Mehroliya **R/o** F-199, Gali No.-7, 3rd, 60 Foota Road, Molarband Extn, Badarpur, New Delhi, has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 54/2018, Dt.: 23.01.2018, U/S 379/411 IPC, PS New Friends Colony, South-East Distt., New Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Amit Mehroliya** cannot be found, and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Amit Mehroliya** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant);

Proclamation is hereby made that **Amit Mehroliya** the said accused of **FIR No. 54/2018, Dt.: 23.01.2018, U/S 379/411 IPC, PS New Friends Colony, South-East Distt., New Delhi,** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **18.12.2026.**

By Order
Sh. Vinod Joshi
Additional Chief Judicial Magistrate,
South-East Distt., Court No.-515,
Saket Courts Complex, New Delhi

DP/16392/SE/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C. / 84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Pawan, S/o Rajesh Kumar, R/o H.No. WZ-283/4, West Block, Vishnu Garden, New Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 210/2020, U/s 25/54/59 Arms Act, P.S. Desh Bandhu Gupta Road, New Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Pawan** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Pawan** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Pawan** accused of **FIR No. 210/2020, U/s 25/54/59 Arms Act, P.S. Desh Bandhu Gupta Road, New Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **16.12.2026.**

By Order - Ms. Harshita Mishra
Chief Judicial Magistrate, Central
Room No. 38, Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi

DP/15960/CD/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 CrPC

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Rajinder Singh @ Bittoo S/o** Surendra Singh **R/o** F-163, Sudereshan Park, Moti Nagar, West Distt., Delhi, has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 34/2025, U/S 506/406/509/498A/34 IPC, PS Moti Nagar, West Distt., New Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Rajinder Singh @ Bittoo** cannot be found, and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Rajinder Singh @ Bittoo** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant);

Proclamation is hereby made that **Rajinder Singh @ Bittoo** the said accused of **FIR No. 34/2025,U/S 506/406/509/498A /34 IPC, PS Moti Nagar, West Distt., New Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **14.12.2026.**

By Order
Ms. Deepika Goyal Shokeen
Judicial Magistrate First Class (West),
(Mahila Court)-03, Room No. 245,
Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi

DP/16151/WD/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 CrPC

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Dharmvir S/o** Ashok **R/o** Village-Udranpur, PO-Gunnari, PS Dhanari, Distt. Sambal (U.P.) has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 361/14, U/S 379/304A IPC, PS Lodhi Colony, South Distt., New Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Dharmvir** cannot be found, and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Dharmvir** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant);

Proclamation is hereby made that **Dharmvir** the said accused of **FIR No. 361/14, U/S 379/304A IPC, PS Lodhi Colony, South Distt., New Delhi,** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **18.12.2026.**

By Order
Ms. Deepakshi Rana
Judicial Magistrate First Class-09,
South-East, Court No. 206,
Saket Court Complex, New Delhi

DP/16172/SD/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **1. Aradna @ Pooja, W/o:** Sumit, **R/o:** Jhuggi Nangloi, near Metro Station Gate No. 4, Delhi; **2. Roshni @ Priti, R/o:** near Chameli Park, 2nd Floor, Raghuveer Nagar, Delhi have committed (or are suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 746/2023 U/s 379/411/34 IPC, P.S.: Kashmere Gate, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **1. Aradna @ Pooja, 2. Roshni @ Priti** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **1. Aradna @ Pooja, 2. Roshni @ Priti** have absconded (or are concealing themselves to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **1. Aradna @ Pooja, 2. Roshni @ Priti** accused of offence in case **FIR No. 746/2023 U/s 379/411/34 IPC, P.S.: Kashmere Gate, Delhi** and are required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **22.12.2026.**

By Order
Sh. Vaibhav Garg
Judicial Magistrate First Class-11 (Central)
Room No. 138
Tis Hazari Court, Delhi

DP/14990/N/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita-2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused person Namely **Pintu S/o Jai Prakash R/o G. No. 04, Ambica Vihar, Karawal Nagar, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **case FIR No. 7982/2018 U/S 379/411/34 IPC PS: Welcome, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Pintu** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Pintu** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Pintu** accused of **FIR No. 7982/2018 U/S 379/411/34 IPC PS: Welcome, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **29.01.2027.**

By Order
Sh. Rangat Ghirra
JMFC-03, Room No. 19
Karkardooma Courts, Delhi

DP/16258/NE/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr. P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused Person **Balram Sharma @ Ballu, S/o:** Mahender Sharma **R/o:** H.No. I-141, Gali No.-1 Shiv Ram Prak, Nangloi Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No: 25677/2017 U/s: 379/411 IPC, PS: Nangloi, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused person(s) **Balram Sharma @ Ballu,** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person(s) **Balram Sharma @ Ballu,** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused person **Balram Sharma @ Ballu,** of **FIR No: 25677/2017 U/s: 379/411 IPC, PS: Nangloi, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **06.01.2027.**

By Order
Ms. Renu
Judicial Magistrate First Class-10
(West) Room No. 345
Tis Hazari Court, Delhi.

DP/16339/OD/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF A PERSON ACCUSED

(See Section 82 Cr. PC)
84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita-2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person namely **Nazim S/o Soud Ahmad R/o H.No. A-144, Kabooter Market, Welcome, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 25/2017 U/s 27/61/85 NDPS at PS: Welcome, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Nazim** can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Nazim** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Nazim of FIR No. 25/2017 U/s 27/61/85 NDPS of PS: Welcome, Delhi is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before 29.01.2027.**

By order
Rangat Ghirra
Judicial Magistrate First Class-03
Room No. 10, 1st Floor. Shahdara Distt
Karkardooma Courts, Delhi

DP/16254/NE/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 (2)(ii) Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person, namely, **Raju@Ballan, S/o.** Pyare Lal, **R/o:** H.No. 59, Harkesh ka makkan, Pitampura Village, Delhi, **Also At:** Dagoli PS Matka Distt. Chhatarpur (MP) has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR: 81/2017, U/s: 379/411/34 IPC,** registered at **P.S.: Rani Bagh, Delhi,** and the warrant has been returned writing upon that the said accused person, **Raju@Ballan** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person, **Raju@Ballan** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said, accused person, **Raju@Ballan, FIR: 81/2017, U/s: 379/411/34 IPC,** registered at **P.S.: Rani Bagh, Delhi,** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **19.12.2026.**

By Order
Ms. Anuradha Jindal
Additional Chief Judicial Magistrate
North-West Court No. 101, 1st Floor
Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/16222/OD/2026
(Court Matter)

IPS officer behind '*12th Fail*' gives pep talk to Mumbai team



The film '*12th Fail*' was based on Manoj Sharma's (L) life. EXPRESS

Devendra Pandey
Mumbai, November 12

FOR MORE than an hour inside the Wankhede dressing room, Mumbai's cricketers listened to someone else's story. The speakers were IPS officer Manoj Sharma, the real-life hero of the film '*12th Fail*', and his wife, IRS officer Shraddha Sharma. The Mumbai Cricket Association (MCA) had organised the session a few days before the Syed Mushtaq Ali Trophy begins.

The idea was to give players a hero from outside sport. "It was a pep talk session for our players and support staff who are chasing a dream to excel in their life. The MCA does have a few off-field activities during the domestic calendar and this is one of them," MCA president Ajinkya Naik told The Indian Express. "We thought of calling Manoj Sir and Shraddha madam for their valuable input on how to overcome all obstacles in life and achieve their goals. We wanted players to understand that they can achieve anything in life if they are committed to it. Despite adverse situations in personal life one should follow their dream and keep trying. The session was on how Mumbai players can apply Manoj Sir's personal experience in their cricketing career to achieve their goal."

Manoj is currently posted as Joint Commissioner of Police, Law and Order, in Mumbai. Shraddha is posted at Mumbai Customs. The film made on him was a huge hit and was loved across India. Mumbai captain Suryakumar Yadav, Sarfaraz Khan, Shardul Thakur and other players were in the room.

Manoj spoke about the need to stay humble after success. The players were told to keep their heads grounded in bad times and not let their minds drift. "It was a very maazedaar session for us, we had seen the picture but to hear him in person was really inspirational. Manoj sir spoke about how to remain humble in life and how they should never change for the few people whom they have known since long," Mumbai batsman Musheer Khan said.

"Shraddha maam had the best line, which I will take for sure. She said that one can't get heaven until they sacrifice. Success demands lots of sacrifice and, to reach a goal, *har insaan ko jalnaa padega*," he added.

Mumbai have had a good run with the red ball, winning all their Ranji Trophy matches so far, and with domestic T20 around the corner they will hope to do well with a star-studded line-up. The MCA filmed the session for an upcoming documentary.

NEW ZEALAND VS INDIA ODI SERIES

Ishan's road to redemption in the lead-up to 2027 World Cup

Left-hander, out of the squad a year ago, gets two ODIs to show he belongs

Shankar Narayan
Mumbai, November 12

A YEAR ago, Ishan Kishan was outside the national setup. He had not played for India since the end of 2023. On Friday, at Bay Oval in Mount Maunganui, he will be Shreyas Iyer's vice-captain for the fourth ODI against New Zealand, and again for the fifth. Gill and KL Rahul have left for Test preparations, Iyer takes over as captain, and India have a chance to clinch the five-match series. Kishan will be one of the wicket-keeping options, alongside Kumar Kushagra.

The road back ran through domestic T20 cricket. A strong run for Jharkhand last year earned him a recall to India's T20I side, and a steady stream of scores in the shortest format opened the door to the ODIs. It is where he has done his best work, at the top of the order and in the middle.

Start with the top. His 210 off 131 balls against Bangladesh in Chattogram in 2022 is still the best case for Kishan as an opener, and was the fastest double century in men's ODI history, at the time. It was a dead rubber, India having already lost the series 2-1, and Kishan, then 24, became the youngest man to score an ODI double century. He hit 24 fours and 10 sixes in a 227-run win. He showed patience early before accelerating. He went cautiously at first, taking 49 balls to reach his fifty, then 36 more for his hundred. The next 50 took 18 balls. He used the pull shot to good effect, put away anything wide of off stump, used his feet to the spinners and swept. Once he settled in, the Bangladesh bowlers could not stop him, and India finished on 409/8.



Ishan Kishan has not featured in ODIs since July. CREIMAS

Those skills could help against New Zealand's pace attack, which includes Matt Henry, Jacob Duffy and Kyle Jamieson for the fourth ODI.

The opening slot may be open. When Shubman Gill was unavailable against South Africa last year, Yashasvi Jaiswal opened alongside Rohit Sharma, and the pair were used again in the last two ODIs against Afghanistan in June. The team management has shown a preference for a left-right combination when it can have one. With Jaiswal not in the squad, Kishan could partner Rohit, and it would give him a chance to strengthen his case for a place in future series.

Number Plate

210

Ishan Kishan's 210 against Bangladesh in 2022 was the fastest double-century in men's ODIs by balls faced until Shubman Gill and Harry Brook broke the record.

Other side

The middle order is the other side of him. India were 48/3 when he walked in against Pakistan in the 2023 Asia Cup game at Pallekele, with Rohit, Gill and Virat Kohli already back in the hut.

He did not attack straightaway. He took his time against the quicks, played the ball late, worked the singles and went at the spinners when they gave him a chance. His 82 off 81 balls came in a 138-run partnership with Hardik Pandya, and it showed he could put the team's needs ahead of his attacking instincts.

"That innings will give Ishan Kishan the confidence that he can bat anywhere in the batting order," the former Pakistan captain Wasim Akram said on Star Sports.

This June, against Afghanistan in Lucknow, he did it again, with more fire. Batting at No. 4, Kishan took 52 balls against Rashid Khan and the other spinners to reach his first fifty. Once his eye was in, the second fifty took 19 balls, and the century came off 71. He got to the pitch of the ball, made room to play through the off side and punished anything on his pads. His 125 came off 79 balls, with 14 fours and seven sixes, and ended a three-year wait for an ODI hundred.

It was his second, after the 210. He and Gill added 224 for the third wicket in India's 402, and India won by 170 runs. He swept the spinners and hit straight when they missed their lengths. These are skills that could prove useful against New Zealand's Mitchell Santner, Michael Bracewell and Dean Foxcroft.

The innings also made him the fourth-fastest Indian to 1,000 ODI runs. In 32 ODIs, Kishan has scored 1107 runs at an average of 42.57 and a strike rate of 107.05. More than the numbers, he has shown that he can handle the new ball as well as the older one, at the top or in the middle.

Two matches against New Zealand give him a chance to show it again, and his performances in the coming months could shape his chances of making the 2027 World Cup squad. He has shown that he can bat in different roles. The challenge now is to turn that into consistent runs. The next step is to hold on to his place.

NEW ZEALAND VS INDIA
4th ODI, Live on Sony Sports Network and Sony LIV, **7:30 a.m.**

Lakshya leads by example, sets up India-Pak final

Shuvaditya Bose
New Delhi, November 12

ON THE very ground where Pakistan had skittled them for 208 only four days earlier, India's Under-19 side corrected their course, recalibrated their range and produced a batting masterclass in the second semi-final of the Asia Cup. Chasing 228 on a surface that usually rewards bowlers, against an Afghanistan attack that had bowled out every opponent in the group stage, India crossed the line barely breaking sweat, securing an eight-wicket triumph with 79 deliveries to spare.

Aaryavir Sehwag, as in nearly every game, gave a good account of himself with a 57-ball 51. The larger story, though, was not that Sehwag junior's strokes echoed his father's, but how captain Lakshya Raichandani justified the faith placed in him in a side that is brimming with promise and potential. Leading by example, he made 93 off 90 balls, with his opening stand of 117 with Aaryavir making light work of a target that was not as feeble as it eventually turned out to be.



Lakshya Raichandani scored a 90-ball 93 against Afghanistan Under-19, hitting 13 fours and a six in the process. X/ACCMEDIA1

Caution ruled the first four overs. In the fifth, it was thrown to the wind. Raichandani struck two successive boundaries off Noor Ali Niazi, who had been all but unplayable across his last five fixtures, taking 19 wickets. First came a lofted square drive over point, then a cut threaded between point and gully with surgical precision, a stroke that would have made the non-striker's father proud.

Niazi plotted his comeback in the next over and was met with an even harsher reply from the 18-year-old Uttarakhand batter — an off-drive past a diving mid-off, a pull beyond the reach of fine leg, a back-foot punch between point and cover, and a square drive along the ground past point yielded fourteen runs in four deliveries, as in only seven overs, India had reached collective half-century.

Sehwag, meanwhile, spent the first nine overs in the unfamiliar role of spectator, his score reading 12 off 28 at the point. In the last over of the powerplay, though, he shook off his self-imposed shackles with a pair of boundaries off Bilal Salimankhil. Raichandani reached his half-century in the 14th over, off 39 balls, and as if in belated celebration, Sehwag lifted off-spinner Sohail Khan for a clean six seven deliveries later. India breached three figures in that same over, and all that followed was a footnote, the writing already on the wall.

A couple of incidents deserve recording. In the 17th over, Niazi staged a minuscule redemption. Sehwag hit a six off the fifth ball with minimal footwork, and while the lack of mobility made his shot look effortless and elegant on that occasion, it also resulted in his dismissal in the very next delivery.

The second-wicket partnership yielded 77, and its end was perhaps the only moment of the afternoon Raichandani would have rued, with only himself to blame. Seven short of a hundred, he tried to clear mid-off against Sohail and found fielder Mohammad Ali flying to hold the catch. Float like a butterfly, his namesake once said, and on that occasion, Ali did.

Earlier, seamer Ishan Sood, India's leading wicket-taker in the tournament, took three wickets and Aryan Savsani two, restricting Afghanistan to 227/8. The total does little justice to the Afghan top order, who had reached 140/3 after 35 overs. But with the run-rate at four an over and seven wickets in hand, Sohail's side chose to flirt with risk in the last fifteen. It came at a steep cost, as Afghanistan lost three wickets in seven deliveries — two to ill-judged attempts to clear the fence and the third to a Savsani arm ball.

The Afghan captain had trudged against the odds to build a total that seemed respectable, until Raichandani arrived.

To end a five-year wait for the crown, India must now beat defending champions Pakistan in the final — the only unbeaten side in the competition and the only one to have beaten India in this edition.

BRIEF SCORES: **Afghanistan Under-19** 227/8 in 50 overs (Shah Faisal Rahimi 51; Ishan Sood 3/41) lost to **India Under-19** 230/2 in 36.5 overs (Lakshya Raichandani 93; Aaryavir Sehwag 51) by 8 wickets.

SRI CAN

Srikanth scalps World No. 5 Naraoka, shows fire is still burning bright in him

Shivani Naik
Mumbai, November 12

IN HIS more candid moments, Pullela Gopichand often talks about the second medal that India could have won in 2016 at the Rio Games. When Kidambi Srikanth could have defeated Lin Dan in the quarterfinals and advanced into medal contention. It's been 10 years, but as gnawing at hearts goes, that one gives the coach the most pangs.

It's fairly well known that Srikanth didn't take the heartbreak too well either. But 2026 has been about 'What can be' in the future rather than what could've been. The desperation is replaced by the quiet determination in Srikanth - the game always had the dazzle.

Sample the point at 17-14 in the first set against World No 5 and World's finalist, Kodai Naraoka whom Srikanth defeated 21-15, 11-21, 21-18 at the Kumamoto Masters in Japan to reach quarters.

Long rally; and long rallies equate Advantage Kodai, given the Japanese and his endless retrieving. Midway through a fast clip exchange, Srikanth dives full stretch to his right, and stays in the game. He bounces back on his feet and continues to work the shuttle around, outrunning the Runner who sends the shuttle wide at the net - because he is late on the run. Score: 18-14.

Next point, Srikanth dives even further, sending the shuttle rolling over the net with a wrist flick as Kodai is once again late to reach it. 19-14. It's the diving defence that deflates Kodai's resolve.

Srikanth's attack was always formidable—the deft net play, the explosive net stomp, the regal smooth smashes when they landed in. But it's the defensive rigour—in those dives that indicate that the hunger is well and alive. Determination chips away at despair where disappointment once gnawed.

He was always good at defending the body smashes - the agility never waned. It used to be having to play that one stroke extra when his shots got retrieved that could bring him down. Not anymore. Not when his fitness backs up the fantastic stroke-play - makes it possible.

What that rigour did was push Kodai to smash on the lines, and he sprayed a fair few. Still, the mid-set went to the Japanese as Srikanth caught his breath.



Kidambi Srikanth defeated Kodai Naraoka 21-15, 11-21, 21-18 in the Round of 16 of Kumamoto Masters. BWF/BADMINTON PHOTO

The Japanese Top 10, who has sharpened a smash to bring flash to his staid, ultra defensive game, isn't one to give up. Even at 7-7 in the decider, he would've fancied his chances, hoping for Srikanth to fade out. But the net touch-play continued. Srikanth, now inside Top 35, has the capability to play the net so fine that the shuttle drops very close to the meshing —topples literally, like a spin serve in the middle of a rally. It's impossible to return those. Kodai needed medical attention having grazed his hands going for one of those returns at 7-10 down.

Guileful, minimalist

Srikanth 2.0 is not some addition of muscle power. His game remains delectable, brainy, skilled and as if returning to where it belonged -- the top bracket, never mind how long the knee took to heal. Not that it's shorn of power or speed either. At 11-7, he sent down two smashes back to back, with flooring-the-car amping up intensity. But the economy of his movements, the well rationed power in only chosen shots in a rally, have always set him apart from the slam-bangers. It helped him pull away to 15-11 in the decider, when the gear went up but he chose his moments. Kodai too was guilty of letting him attack at will from the net.

Earlier this year, Srikanth drew praise for telling the umpire his opponent had won a point awarded to him. It speaks of confidence, though on non-TV courts with no referrals he still gets a tad annoyed. But with men's singles in a flux with half a dozen in contention to finish the year at World No 1, Srikanth senses an opening.

His rhythm game is more attuned to consistency than most others. He is far from being washed up, given the quality of his attack.

But on Thursday at the Kumamoto Masters, he took down the World No 5, with Gopichand in his ear and confidence in his veins.

While Srikanth defeated Japan's biggest hope, Lakshya Sen, now ranked 13, downed the tall Dong Tian Yao of China, 21-8, 21-14. The Chinese ranked No 45 was leaden-footed but is seen as a prospect at 23 after his bronze at China National. Sen swatted him away like a big red bumblebee without a sting.

Sen next takes on Yushi Tanaka who beat Victor Lai, while Srikanth will need to play quicker against Koki Watanabe, also of Japan at the Super 500.

BRIEFLY



Saqib Khan recorded figures of 34-5-130-7. AP

Saqib takes 7 wickets on intl debut as Pak claw back in Test

NEW FAST bowler Saqib Khan's seven-wicket haul led Pakistan's comeback against Sri Lanka on a rain-affected day four of the first cricket test on Thursday. Saqib's dream figures of 7-130 on debut helped Sri Lanka collapse to 446 all out after resuming on a formidable 404-4. Sri Lanka eked out a first-innings lead of 12 runs. BRIEF SCORES: **Pakistan** 434/9 decl. and 57/1 (Mohammad Taha 24 batting) lead **Sri Lanka** 446 all out (Dhananjaya de Silva 167, Kusal Mendis 119; Saqib Khan 7/130) by 45 runs. AP

Anderson to continue county career at Surrey

ENGLAND'S HIGHEST wicket-taker James Anderson is set to continue his county cricket career with the 44-year-old fast bowler joining Surrey for the 2027 season, the club said on Thursday. Regarded as one of the greatest pace and swing bowlers of all time, Anderson took 991 wickets for England across all formats, a record for all fast bowlers. He retired from international cricket in 2024 and his 25-year spell at Lancashire came to an end last month. REUTERS

NZ call up pacer Randell for 4th and 5th ODIs

NEW ZEALAND on Thursday added unheralded pacer Brett Randell to their squad for the fourth and fifth ODIs against India here.
The fourth match of the series will be played on Friday while the series finale is scheduled for Sunday. India lead 2-0 in the rubber after the third match was washed out. The 31-year-old Randell has made 145 professional appearances, including five for New Zealand A. He recently returned from a County Championship stint with Derbyshire. PTI

Lawson, Arvid to continue with Racing Bulls

NEW ZEALAND'S Liam Lawson and Britain's Arvid Lindblad will continue with Racing Bulls next season, the Red Bull-owned Formula One team said on Thursday. The announcement ends speculation about Lawson's future. "I have no doubt that this is the best driver lineup for us, bringing a strong combination of experience and ambition," said team principal Alan Permane. Lawson has scored 75 of the team's 114 points so far. REUTERS

Sinner working to put on weight after operation

WORLD NO. 2 Jannik Sinner said he lost a lot of weight after having his tonsils removed and is now rebuilding muscle as he continues to work towards his return from a knee injury. The 25-year-old's knee issue has kept him out of action since he won his fifth Grand Slam title at Wimbledon in July, but he said earlier this week he was confident of being back in time for the Australian Open. Magnus Norman has joined Sinner's coaching camp. REUTERS

Crystal Palace sack coach Pierre Sage

CRYSTAL PALACE fired coach Pierre Sage on Thursday after a troubled five-month tenure left the club sitting last in the Premier League. Sage lost his job barely an hour after Michael Carrick was fired by Manchester United. They are the first two Premier League managers to be sacked this season. Palace has just two wins from 10 games in England's top flight and is bottom on seven points.
Thomas Frank is reportedly among the favorites to take over at Selhurst Park. AP

'Keeper's return uncertain after De Miguel's death

FC ANDORRA goalkeeper Jesus Owono is yet to decide whether he will return to competition, the club's manager Carles Manso said on Thursday, following the tragic death of Tenerife forward Jesus de Miguel on November 3. Owono was involved in a collision with De Miguel on the pitch last week and the 30-year-old died in hospital the following day.
He released a statement in which he described the ordeal as "the most difficult days of my life." REUTERS

New Zealand hammer India 5-0 in friendly



India's left-back Akash Mishra (R) jostling for the ball. AIFF

Press Trust of India
Auckland, November 12

THE INDIAN men's national team suffered a heavy 0-5 defeat to New Zealand in its first international friendly match of the November FIFA window here on Thursday. Both sides will meet again in Christchurch on Sunday. In what was the Blue Tigers' first-ever match in New Zealand, Jesse Randall struck a brace, while Chris Wood and Lachlan Bayliss found the net after a Bijoy Varghese own goal opened the scoring.

Making his first national team appearance since last June, India goalkeeper Vishal Kaith made a string of fine saves, including a second-half penalty to keep the scoreline from worsening. Leading India out as skipper for the first time since 2018, Anirudh Thapa anchored the visitors, as New Zealand pressed early. The 28-year-old had halted Randall's run down the left, but the hosts took the lead in the fifth minute following a scramble in the box.

Moments later, Kaith was called upon again, flying across to deny Matthew Garbett from distance. The Blue Tigers began to find their footing soon. Ryan Williams and wingers Liston Colaco and Jithin MS combined promising passes, culminating in their clearest opening in the 19th minute.

A neat interplay between Bijoy Varghese and Williams sent the latter surging down the right to deliver a cut-back for Manvir Singh. Well positioned inside the box, the striker was prepared to pull the trigger, but was denied by a timely block from Callan Elliott.

The All Whites continued to dictate the tempo, though Kaith ensured India remained in the contest for much of the opening half. He made an acrobatic save from a header in the 25th minute and bravely came off his line to deny Randall moments later. Kaith's most impressive intervention came around the half-hour mark. Randall burst into the box, where the India custodian blocked his initial effort before recovering quickly to palm away the rebound.

New Zealand's pressure eventually bore fruit before the interval, widening their cushion through a couple of Randall goals in the 34th and 43rd minutes. Khalid Jamil responded with five half-time changes, introducing Jay Gupta, Lalrinliana Hnamte, Mehtab Singh, Ricky Meetei Haobam and Muhammad Suhail, with the latter two making their debuts. Substitute Mehtab stepped up to produce a few key defensive blocks, while Kaith continued to weather the New Zealand shots to keep the score at five.

ANOTHER ONE BITES THE DUST

Carrick gets the sack but leaking roof needs to be fixed at Man Utd

Red Devils' management have gotten themselves into a death loop of managers

Sandip G
New Delhi, November 12



A solitary win in 10 games this season, the club's worst start in the Premier League era, didn't do Carrick any favours. AP

THE DEATH loop of managers rolled on in Old Trafford. The latest victim is Michael Carrick, whose inevitable ouster is a metaphor of the crumbling club's anarchic administration rather than the manager's incompetence. The miserable numbers of Carrick's troops expedited the marching orders. A solitary win in 10 league games, the club's worst start in the Premier League era, cannot go without backlash.

But as with most of the seven full-time managers the club had hired to resurrect its long departed glory, this was not so much a failure of the manager's tactics as a miserable proof of the malaise that has swallowed the club in 13 years since Sir Alex Ferguson departed. The proverbial camel's back was broken long ago.

Maybe, the Ferguson era was just the Noah Ark's that masked the filth the club had drowned itself in. Glazers, the majority owners, have little emotional attachment to the historic club. The family didn't buy the club out of love or loyalty, but as a high-profit business commodity.

Sir Jim Ratcliffe, part-owner and who now handles the sporting side, came with the self-hyped image of the messiah, only to ruthlessly fire staff, strip their benefits, spike ticket prices, and scrap traditions, estranging himself from the fans, killing the soul of the club. At all levels, clarity and compassion have existed as only illusions. The handling of Carrick's sacking was cruelly unprofessional and soulless. He continued training at the club's Carrington campus, while the management was busy negotiating a deal with Mauricio Pochettino, expected to appointed to the hot seat next.

It is less of a community institution it has always felt proud about, but more of a royal corporate mess. So much so that he has found his way to the protest flags and banners in the stands. His appointments, chief executive Omar Berrada and director of football Jason Wilcox, have shown little accountability in the club's episodic crisis. With baffling detachment, they have dodged from biting the bullet. Ratcliffe wants to fix the leaking roof, but there is a crumbling floor beneath his feet. None of them can exist in denial.

Not that the decay was sudden; or the former managers and players had not intimated the owners about the state of rot. Cristiano Ronaldo was shocked to see that the training facilities remained as when he departed in 2009. Interim manager Ralf Ragnick recommended open-heart surgery. Carrick's predecessor Ruben Amorim said the club "should be ready to suffer" before they become a force again. Erik Ten Hag blasted the "toxic work culture"; Ole Gunnar Solskjaer lamented the management's broken promises. No one listened. No one bothered.

The boardroom was either at odds with the managers' vision or forsake them impatiently. Spendings were wanton. An astonishing 2.4 billion pounds has been coughed for players in the post-Fergie era, with little tangible progress. Severance packages have cost them an estimated 100 million pounds. Young footballers wither into oblivion.

Pochettino in line

It's into the shambles that Mauricio Pochettino, or whoever gets appointed next, walks in. Into a broken club, with a reeling structure and decomposing soul. For Pochettino the task to restore the lost glory, which now only exists in the game's anthem, could make or break him. Either the death loop crushes him, or he becomes an immortal. It's the club's history. The story of the club's successful eras is the story of two great managers, Matt Busby and Alex Ferguson, both with an all-encompassing force of personality. The rest are archival fodder, not a memory.

The burdens would be many. The history and legacy, the immediate past, the present crisis and the promise of a future. The assessments would be immediate.

The players would be the same, unless there is a massive overhaul in the January transfer window. But the players on the market would largely be stopgaps or discards. Premium players would cost a fortune. He can't expect United's transfer strategists to suddenly discover wisdom and intuition that they did not show in the summer window. The FFP rules would kick in, leaving the club with little muscle to flex.

Fundamentally, Pochettino would have to wage his battles with a brittle backline. The lone specialist left-back, Luke Shaw, is injured, as he had been for most of his decade-long career at Old Trafford. He and the Argentine manager go back to Southampton. One half of the first-choice centre-back pair, Lisandro Martinez, is short tempered; the other, Harry Maguire, is ponderous and mistake-prone, although defiant and tenacious.

One right back, Noussair Mazraoui, is defensively reliable, but offers little progressive thrusts. The other, Diogo Dalot, is antithesis. The two 20-year-old centre-backs, Ayden Heaven and Leny Yoru, are yet not finished products.

Pochettino backers would fish out his impressive track record of polishing diamonds in the rough. The midfield composition would not excite him either. All his good teams had strong runners that suited his high pressing game.

His extreme obsession with fitness and training can leave a bunch of over-indulged footballers knackered, in mind and body. But for an ambitious manager searching for the job that defines his career, United is a seductive project.

Pochettino could leave the club old and content as an era-defining manager, or be dragged into the vicious death loop.

• Manchester United managers since Alex Ferguson

Among permanent managers, Carrick had the second-shortest stint

	David Moyes	Louis van Gaal	Jose Mourinho	Ole Gunnar Solksjaer	Erik ten Hag	Ruben Amorin	Michael Carrick
Matches	51	103	144	168	128	63	32
Wins	27	54	84	91	70	24	15
Losses	15	24	28	40	35	21	9
Win %	52.94	52.43	58.33	54.17	54.69	38.1	46.88
Trophies	1	1	3	0	2	0	0

*EXCLUDING INTERIM MANAGERS

COMING UP THE HARD WAY

Meetei becomes first Indian boxer to win Youth Olympics gold



Lairenlakpam Ambekar Meetei (C), with coaches Vijay Kumar Sharma and Geeta Chanu Oinam after winning the 50 kg gold. BFI

Nitin Sharma
Chandigarh, November 12

ON THURSDAY evening, in the village of Lamlai Mayai Leikai in Manipur, Lairenlakpam Madan Meetei and his wife Lairenlakpam Babita Leima watched their son's final on a mobile phone. Babita, who earns money by stitching traditional Manipuri attire, had not stitched that day.

In Dakar, the 17-year-old Lairenlakpam Ambekar Meetei lost the opening round and came back to beat Ireland's Kristian Jubani 3-2 on a split decision in the men's 50kg final. It is India's first boxing gold at the Youth Olympic Games. Shiva Thapa's silver in 2010 had been the country's best in boxing.

The couple were remembering the tough days.

Back in 2016, Ambekar asked his father to get him into the nearby Nongada Boxing Academy. Madan works other people's farmland on a daily wage. He and Babita sat down to work out how to save money in the next few days. They bought their son a second-hand cycle for Rs 200, and he rode it to the academy every day.

"I earn money working on other farmlands while my wife earns some money by doing stitching work. When Ambekar told us to get him enrolled at the academy, our first worry was how to sustain his training. There was never a day when he complained. Later when he gave the trials for the National Boxing Academy in Imphal, we spent our savings on travel and stay. To see him win the Youth Olympics Games title brings us all the memories of his hard work as well as days of eating simple dal rice," Madan said.

Babita chipped in. "Sometimes, we would save money to make him eat pork once in two weeks and to support his dream," she said.

His first coach, Pheiroijam Sanabiten, had put the boy into boxing to channel his energy. "He was very energetic and to channelise his energy, we put him into boxing. He used to swim in the village pond and he had very good upper body strength. Ambekar used to box with old gloves of other trainees but always believed in his ability and willpower," Sanabiten said. He was battling fever on Thursday and could not watch his ward's bout.

Ambekar was picked in the trials at the National Sports Academy at Khuman Lampak, near Imphal, in 2022, and trained under Jiten Singh. This year the Army Sports Company picked him up. He won multiple sub-junior titles in the state, then a bronze at the junior nationals in Rohtak last year, which put him in the Indian junior team.

Jiten, the elder brother of former Indian boxer Nanao Singh, remembers the first look. "*Himmatwala ladka*. That's how I remember telling myself when I first saw him in the trials. He was never afraid of hitting the opponent as well as getting hit. As we trained him, his hook as well as cut was something which came naturally to him.

Money got harder in 2023, during the unrest in Manipur. "During the unrest, I did not get work and my wife's stitching work also got less. But Ambekar would send us money from his stipend," Madan said.

National youth coach Vijay Kumar Sharma remembers when he first came to train at the Army Sports Institute in Pune.

"Ambekar is a strong physical boxer and he has good power. He would be very good in medium and close range. He had the mental aptitude as well as tactical ring IQ to use combination punches. His right straight and uppercuts and hook were always good and even in counter attacks, he would rely on them," Sharma said.

Gunjan, in 48kg, makes it a day to remember

HARYANA BOXER Gunjan Yadav became only the second Indian and first woman from the country to win an Youth Olympic title after a unanimous 5-0 win over Algeria's Bouthaina Bensalah in the women's 48kg final in Dakar, Senegal. A native of Dhana Kalan village near Hisar in Haryana, Gunjan had beaten favourite England's Lily Bassett, a competitor who had lost only one of her 48 amateur bouts, with a split 4-1 decision in the semi-finals on Wednesday. Gunjan had also won a silver medal in the Asian Boxing Championships and a silver in the U-19 World Future Cup. **ENS**

World Championships: Vivaan wins trap silver

Nitin Sharma
Chandigarh, November 12

IN A final, which saw the presence of Paris Olympic champion Nathan Hales, Paris Olympics silver medallist Qi Ying of China and reigning world champion and Rio Olympics champion Josip Glasnovic of Croatia, 24-year-old Vivaan Kapoor won the silver medal as well as the LA Olympics quota for India in men's trap at the ISSF World Championships in Doha.

Kapoor, hailing from Jaipur, won India's only fourth World Championship medal in shotgun after Dr Karni Singh's silver in 1962, Manavjit Singh Sandhu's gold in 2006 and Zoravar Singh Sandhu's bronze medal in last year's World Championships.

Kapoor, who was tied with Abdulrahman Al-Faihan of Kuwait on a score of 29, one shy of the world record of 30/30 hits by Italian Ermanio Frasca, lost in the third shoot-off for the gold.

"Well, it was almost the world title. Shoot-offs, anybody can win but then this silver is special. It was a field, which had the presence of multiple Olympic champions as well as world champions and I admire some of these shooters too like Qi Ying. When you compete against such shooters, you also believe that you too can win. My personal coach Giovanni Cernogoraz is the 2016 Olympic champion and India's foreign coach Peter Wilson too is the London Olympics champion. And the message always has been to stay calm and focus on my shooting. And I am glad that I could win the silver and win the Olympic quota for India," Kapoor told *The Indian Express* from Doha.



India's Vivaan Kapoor. NRAI

Hales finished 5th, while Glasnovic ended last.

A junior Asian champion in 2019, Vivaan's father Vikram runs a carpet export house in Jaipur. He had won a silver in World Junior Championships in 2021 before his rise at the senior level began. A World Cup final silver in New Delhi in 2024, where Ying won the title, was followed by Kapoor pairing up with Neeru Dhanda to win the trap mixed team bronze medal in the ISSF World Cup in Kazakhstan earlier this year. It was India's second medal in the format since the mixed team trap event made its debut in Tokyo Olympics.

As Kapoor won the silver in Doha, his coach in formative years and India's high performance manager Mansher Singh too watched from the stands. "Vivaan came when he was 13 and would train till the age of 18 with me. The formative years saw us working a lot on his fitness first and mental training before we concentrated on the technique of trap shooting. We worked on the gun fit, the vision and mounting technique as well as breathing techniques. All these things take a long time to come a long circle and Vivaan would always be patient," shares Singh.

Wilson rates Kapoor's final performance highly. "We are too good now. When Zoravar won the bronze last year, India had won its first world medal in 20 years. And now we are winning the silver here along with the LA Olympics quota. It was such a strong field with my former trainee and Paris Olympics champion Nathan Hales as well as the world champion Josip Glasnovic and Paris silver medallist Qing in it. Both Vivaan and Udayvir came through a tricky shoot-off and then to see Vivaan win the silver, where he was almost on the verge of winning the title, is tremendous," he said.

• OUT OF COMFORT ZONE

Power naps & surprise openings: Inside players' strategy to ace Total Chess challenge

Getting used to fast classical chess, games with 45 seconds on the clock with 30-second increaments, is not easy

Amit Kamath
Budapest, November 12

AS R Vaishali staggers out of the playing hall, one can see the fatigue on her face. Many of her colleagues are also feeling the burn after playing two fast classical games in a day at the pilot event of Total Chess.

"Today has been a very tiring day, much more tiring than I had expected," Vaishali tells *The Indian Express* after drawing the second game against Maxime Vachier-Lagrave, following a loss against the Frenchman on Wednesday.

It's the first time most of the 24-player field has dabbled in fast classical — games with 45 minutes on the clock with 30-second increments for each move. While the games end faster than regular classical games, playing two games in a day for five days at a stretch feels like a test of endurance. At the Total Chess pilot event, not just the organisers, but the players also are testing their strategies — both on the board and off it — to ace the format ahead of the full tour next year that will culminate in a World Championship.

"Playing two games in a day against the same opponent who's so strong is going to be pretty tough. It's going to test everyone's endurance," Vaibhav Suri, R Praggnanandhaa's coach, tells *The Indian Express*.

The 24 players have been divided into four groups of six each with double-headers against the same opponent for five days at a stretch. While rapid and blitz tournaments too see players playing multiple games in a day, those don't really count in their classical ratings — which is what every chess player is fiercely protective about — and adds pressure on them to do well in fast classical.

"It plays with your mind. The rating is also on the line. Every game, every move matters. The biggest trick that normally allows you to play many rapid or blitz games in a day is that it does not count for (classical) rating. So you take it slightly lightly. If you're not so well prepared for an opponent, that's okay. But when rating points are on the line, you realise that these fast classical games are equally important as any classical game for which you prepare for so many hours," says Peter Leko, the coach and mentor of Vincent Keymer.



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VAIBHAV SURI, PRAGG'S COACH

For regular classical games, players can spend six to seven hours on rigorous opening preparation. But with there being two games in a day at this tournament, many of the players have had to find a balance between preparing deep and resting.

Arjun, known to have a voracious appetite for prep, says he didn't go as deep as he normally would for his games.

"It's about being slightly smart with your preparation. You can't over-prepare also, because the energy levels will take a hit sooner rather than later in the tournament if you do that," adds Suri. "Everyone seems to have a brief plan, but I am pretty sure all plans are flexible. The format requires that."

Pragg reveals that in the break between the two fast classical games on Wednesday, he took a power nap of 15 minutes but also spent time brushing up on his opening prep.

A strategy that some players employed on Wednesday was to try and surprise their opponents in the opening, forcing them to lose some time overthinking their response since there is just 45 minutes on the clock. Pragg, for example, found himself in time trouble in the first game against German grandmaster Vincent Keymer as early as the 14th move, having just 6 minutes on his clock by the 15th. Levon Aronian was also caught off-guard by Jorden van Foreest's opening tactics.

"In the first game (on Wednesday), Vincent did surprise Pragg out of his opening because it was something he has not played for a while. Then Magnus Carlsen played the Dutch Defence against Anish Giri, which is an opening that you just do not see at this level against a player like Anish. But these games are data for us to figure out what others are doing," says Suri.

The writer is in Budapest at the invitation of Total Chess

Erigaisi stunned by Bibisara as Indians lose

THE SECOND day of the Total Chess' fast classical portion at the Budapest pilot event saw all three Indians lose their first games. Arjun Erigaisi was stunned by Bibisara Assaubayeva, Praggnanandhaa was taken down by Fabiano Caruana while Vaishali lost to Hans Niemann. All three Indians will play another fast classical game against the same opponents with colours reversed later in the day on Thursday. The most stunning result of the three was Bibisara defeating Arjun, a result she termed as the best results of her career. **ENS**

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